Trust Falls

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Trust Falls

by EmbeddedinAmber

Summary

Two and a half years ago Izuku committed suicide. His body was never recovered but the bridge he jumped from was high and the river deep enough that police figured it had been washed away in the time it took for anyone to realize he was missing.

That's what Katsuki had been told.

Except none of that can be true since Izuku just burst into the dank, musty, bar that the League of Villains is holding him in.

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The one where Izuku let everyone believe he was dead for almost three years before the LOV Kidnapped Bakugou Katsuki and he's forced to face his past. He's captured by UA and forced to play babysitter to 20 chaotic teenagers while figuring out his own place.

Notes

Hi guys! This is my first MHA fic ever and has been a long time coming! I hope you enjoy! <3

I have a discord now! https://discord.gg/USkzmf7Mu7
Make sure you follow me on TikTok @Embedded.Fiction!

Saw You Yesterday with an Old Friend

Katsuki thought his life was going to be so much easier when he started UA. He would finally be able to just put all of his focus on becoming a hero and not have to deal with all of the extra shit. He'd been looking forward to three years of putting his nose to the grindstone and only coming up to breathe when he graduated and had his license.

Sure, his therapist was a little concerned by how convinced that was going to be the case he was but it was fine. He was fine. So long as he got to leave most of the bullshit behind.

And then the fucking League of Villains happened.

And then the sports festival went sideways fast thanks to Half n' Half

And then Stain almost killing one of their classmates because he was stupid enough to go into a fight without backup.

All of it leading up to the fucked up situation he was in now, chained to a chair in a musty smelling bar surrounded by villains.

A part of him registered the bullshit coming from the leader's mouth but the rest of him almost refused to believe that this was his shitty lot in life. This was the exact opposite of every expectation he'd had at the beginning of the year. Or for his life in general.

A quiet voice in the back of his mind unhelpfully reminded him that he didn't even know if most of his classmates were alive right now and it was all his fault that this had happened. He hated that voice most of all.

Scratch that, he hated the bastard in front of him most of all. Shigaraki was droning on and on about how perfect he'd be as a villain and how it would be such a blow to UA and all Katsuki wanted to do was punch him in the face till he swallowed his teeth.

Katsuki's lip was curled up in a snarl, hands curling into claws within the confines of his shackles. Fuck that. Him? A Villain? Not a fucking chance. He had too much riding on being a hero. Too many things to atone for.

Before he could spit venom at the silver haired moron, though, the door of the bar was thrown open with enough force to rattle the frame. All of the assembled villains immediately were on the alert as a figure stormed into the room, stopping just inside the door and letting their eyes roam around the area. None of the villains attacked as they were sized up, most of them relaxing a little as if they knew the person.

So another villain, then. Lovely.

The snarl on his lips, though, froze completely when those eyes fell on him.

A familiar shade of green. Duller than he'd ever seen it but familiar nonetheless.

And fucking impossible.

His mouth hung open uselessly as he took in the sight of the kid he'd grown up with and had mourned for the past two and a half years.

His hair was shorter, the sides almost shaved, and he was a little bit taller than the last time Katsuki had seen him. There was also a deep, dark, rage simmering under the surface of his gaze. The way he held himself screamed that he was ready to spring into action at any moment, hands curling and uncurling at his sides as those green eyes lingered on him.

"Deku.." He breathed out, shifting in his seat to turn himself more towards the familiar stranger.

The teen shook himself out of whatever thoughts he was having, hands disappearing into the folds of his large, dark, hoodie as he whirled back to face the leader of the League of Villains without answering Katsuki.

Panic shot through Katsuki as he stalked towards the silver haired man. All his mind's eye could conjure was the picture of Aizawa during the USJ attack, broken and unconscious in a crater.

Said panic was replaced as his world once again flipped on his head as the green haired teen pulled a knife out of his sleeve and hurled it directly at Shigaraki's face. The only thing that saved the man child was the warp gate user intervening, the knife appearing a moment later out of a gate near the teen's feet and embedding in the wood of the floor.

"Are you fucking stupid?" The teen snarled, reaching back into his sleeve for what Katsuki assumed was another knife. "First USJ and now this? Really? I knew Stain didn't join up with you! You don't have two brain cells to rub together."

Katsuki could have sworn the teen's eyes shifted towards the scared face bastard's direction and he stored the info away for later, still too off balance to do much more than watch the situation escalating in front of him. Shigaraki was snarling as he stalked closer to Deku, hands outstretched.

Deku seemed more than willing to brawl with him, only stopped by the warp gate that had sprung up between them that was keeping them from meeting in the middle of the bar.

"Stain wanted hero society to fall and so do I! That's all you need to know." Shigaraki yelled, trying to sidestep the gate only to have it follow him. "When this kid joins up with us it'll show them all that it's all better off crumbling to dust!"

The green haired teen let out a bark of a laugh, face twisted with an emotion that Katsuki had never seen on the others face the entire time he'd known him. He couldn't pinpoint it was but the base emotion flashing in those green eyes was rage. Murderous rage. Katsuki didn't doubt that if the warp gate wasn't between the two, one of them would be bleeding by now.

He wasn't sure if he was happy about that or not. Especially when he wasn't sure who exactly would come out on top of that fight, if he was being completely honest.

“You did no research for this, did you?” Deku laughed, the sound so far removed from the laugh Katsuki remembered that it made him flich a little against his chair. It was so...dark.

“All you saw was the way he acted at the sports festival and just decided right off the bat that he’d be perfect without looking into anything else. God, you don’t even know what you’ve done. You’re lucky that the entirety of UA hasn’t descended on you by now!”

Deku carefully lunged to the side, snarling a little when the warpgate moved with him as it had with Shigaraki.

“Even if he doesn’t join it will be a blow to the heroes to have one of their prized students snatched away! Even now the sheep out there are starting to see how useless their precious heroes are!” Shigaraki snarled. “Either way, he’s useful for changing this disgusting society we live in!”

“Do you even fucking hear yourself spouting this bullshit or are you just that stupid?” Deku snarled right back, once again trying to duck around the gate between them. “What exactly are you going to do when the heroes fall? Step in and restructure society? You don’t have any kind of plan and all you’ll find from your way of going about this is dust and chaos!”

The crusty bastard didn’t seem to have an answer for that, instead reduced to just growling incoherently and trying to shove his hands through the warp gate.

“Such a lively reintroduction to our base, Deku! How wonderful.”

Everyone in the bar froze, though, as a new voice spoke up. The tone was pleasant but there was something about it that made Katsuki’s stomach twist violently. The way the villains seemed to turn to face the TV was also another huge red flag to the teen even if he hadn’t seen the way Deku’s face had paled.

From where he was sitting, Katsuki could see the way Deku’s fingers tightened around the hilt of his knife. He could see the way his knuckles were white and how the blade shook a little as if the teens hand was shaking.

No one spoke in answer, Shigaraki seeming to calm and the rest of the villains seemingly holding their breath to see how this new development played out.

This had to be the boss that was controlling everything, Katsuki thought to himself absently. That crusty bastard obviously took his cues from whoever this bastard was.

“Kurogiri, bring Deku to me. It’s been so long since we had a chat. I’m so curious about where he’s been.” Katsuki could see the blood drain even further from the other teen’s face and he felt dread build up in his own stomach. If Deku left, would Katsuki ever be able to track him down again?

He began to struggle against his chains as Deku seemed to droop in defeat, knife disappearing into the sleeve of his hoodie once more. The almost violent sound of his chains rattling seemed to remind Deku that he was still there, green eyes once more swinging around to pin him in place. The rage had been replaced with a sort of resignation, to the situation or

to something else Katsuki couldn't tell. Even while he wished to never break eye contact with the other teen again, his stomach twisted uncomfortably at just how dull and closed off his gaze was. What had happened in the last two years? None of this made any sense to Katsuki.

"Think about what I said, Kacchan." Deku said finally, his tone sharp and angry. "Shigaraki is an idiot with no foresight. All he can offer is chaos and death."

"Deku, no!" Katsuki yelled, struggling against his shackles still as Deku turned away from him and walked towards the warp gate. The teen didn't look back at him, even as he continued to scream his name, and vanished into the swirling mist of the warp gate. Silence fell onto the bar once more once the gate closed, all eyes swinging to the blonde teen once more as he slumped down into his chair.

The scarred bastard had an odd, pinched, look on his face that set Katsuki's teeth on edge. He was distracted from it, though, as the creepy chick bounced towards him with her knife in her hand.

"Awww! Kacchan! Can I call you that? I'm going to call you that!" She cooed, giggling maddly when he snapped at her and shifted as far away as possible. The rest of the villains seemed to relax and he snarled at them as they shifted closer once more.

"Let him out of his restraints, Dabi. How can we show him we're serious if he's locked up like an animal?" Shigaraki drawled, seeming to pull himself together once more now that Deku had exited.

"We have so much to discuss."

Exit Light, Entire Night

Chapter Summary

Izuku comes face to face with the boogeyman of the underwold.

Chapter Notes

I have no self control when it comes to this, it seems. This is the most I've written in years so absolutely let me know what you think!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

There were a lot of things Izuku wanted to say to Kacchan before he stepped through that portal.

It's okay, the heroes will be here soon.

I'm sorry for not coming home

It wasn't your fault.

None of which he could say with the entirety of the League watching him. Not when the boogeyman could hear him. There was no telling what either of them would do if they knew who Katsuki was to him.

Shigaraki probably would kill him in front of Izuku just to take one more thing from him. To prove that he could finally hurt the thorn in his side. No, none of the League could find out how badly Izuku wanted to have Bakugou Katsuki out of that bar and back on his way to UA. The entire situation was dangerous and volatile in ways Izuku was not prepared to handle at the moment.

Mentally shaking himself from his thoughts, he focused on the task at hand.

All for One wanted to *chat*

Sticking his shaking hands in the pockets of his overlarge hoodie, he forced himself to focus. Taking a deep breath he stepped through the warp gate and into the familiar room where his biggest nightmare resided.

The man himself was relaxed, leaning back in his chair as if everything were a mildly interesting show on the tv. Which, Izuku supposed, was true for the 200 year old monster

sitting in front of him. The villain had on more than one occasion told Izuku how boring he found the routine squabbles of heroes and villains once he'd seen them a few hundred times.

Izuku swallowed his anxiety at the sight of the man, fighting down the urge to take a step back when his head turned from the direction of the TV set monitoring the bar to where he stood. It'd been months since Izuku had stood in this room and he had no idea if the man had added new quirks to his arsenal or not. It was always a safe bet to assume he had, honestly.

"Deku! How good to see you." All for One hummed, leaning his chin on his fist. At least he seemed...amused instead of angry. "It's been so long. What have you been doing, hmm?"

If you asked Izuku how he'd ended up having 'chats' with the biggest boogeyman of the underworld he honestly could not tell you the exact sequence of events. It seemed like he was just a simple information broker one minute and then next he'd been swept into a warp gate and into the lair of the beast.
A monster that seemed amused by him more often than not. Even when he fought with his prized student.

Izuku honestly could say he hated Shigaraki more than he thought possible. He was everything Izuku despised.

Stupid.

Cruel.

Childish.

Too short sighted to see anything past his shallow want to hurt and destroy. Their very first interaction had shown him as much as he needed to see of the silver haired man and he'd been very vocal about his dislike ever since.

It didn't matter to All for One, though. No. He seemed a little disappointed that they didn't get along but in the long run had seemed to be content with just talking to Izuku about his opinions on things and how the world ran.

Which was...disturbing to the teen. Because it gave him way too much of an insight into how All for One thought and how he planned. That monster's mind was not something Izuku wanted to know and the fact that he did was the source of some of his worst nightmares.

Chiding himself for getting lost in his head again, Izuku shrugged a little and rocked forward a little on the balls of his feet.

"Trying to lay low, honestly." He answered evenly, betraying none of his nerves at being stuck in front of his man when he'd never had any intention of ever stepping foot in this place again. "As always, something made harder by your psychotic protégé out there."

All for One laughed, amused by the dislike evident in the teen's tone.

“Of course, of course, but Tomura has big plans that I’m sure you’ll be interested to see play out. He’s come along quite nicely. It’s a shame you haven’t been here to see it.” The man’s tone was amused, almost proud even, and it made Izuku’s stomach roll with anxiety.

It was rarely a good thing for someone like him to be so jovial.

“So, what do you think of his current plan? Do you think the young hero out there will switch sides?”

Izuku had to fight back the urge to snap at the idea of it, already knowing this little plan came from Shigaraki himself. It reeked of the stupidity of the villain.

“I don’t think he will. His convictions are too strong.” Izuku said after a moment of struggling to keep the rage out of his voice and posture. It was simmering under the surface but he couldn’t let it out. Not now. Not here. It would raise too many questions. “Shigaraki only saw how unnecessarily aggressive he was during the sports festival and didn’t look any further into why that might have been the case.”

All For One let out a small hum of approval and leaned further back in his throne, face moving back towards the screen showing the bar where Izuku could see Katsuki unchained and causing problems. A part of him wanted to grin but he suppressed it, knowing that while the man couldn’t see he would somehow be able to sense it.

“I came to the same conclusion when Tomura told me of his idea. However, it is an improvement and I would never want to discourage that in the boy.” It was almost as if the man was speaking to himself for a moment before he shook his head. “No matter, the boy will serve a purpose to us one way or the other. Which brings me to why I am so glad to see you today. I have a proposition for you.”

Ice slid down Izuku’s spine as the man sat forward in his throne, a grin spreading across his face underneath the breathing mask he wore. Never had those words boded well for anyone in Izuku’s experience. Especially not coming out of the mouth of one of the literal devils of the world.

When Izuku didn’t speak, couldn’t really, the man laughed and continued on. He motioned towards the tv with one hand, bringing Izuku’s attention back to the scene playing out in the bar.

“As I said, he can serve a purpose one way or the other. Tomura will likely kill him once he continues to refuse to join and makes a mess but I could have another use for him.” The man turned back to face Izuku. Cold dread filled Izuku’s stomach at the phrasing of his words. “You could have another use for him. It would be...poetic justice don’t you think? I could give you the quirk that caused you so much heartache and pain in your childhood and leave the boy quirkless. Just deserts. What he deserves.”

Izuku jerked as if he had been slapped by the words, taking a step back almost instinctively. All For One knew.

Somehow this monster knew who he was. Knew the biggest secret he'd tried to hide and bury for the last two and a half years. Suddenly all he wanted to do was throw up, his stomach revolting at the idea of how much this man could know about him already if he knew about Kacchan's bullying.

"Oh yes, Midoriya Izuku, I know who you are. Have for quite some time." All For One said this like he was talking about the weather or a passing interesting piece of gossip. Izuku hunched in on himself and tried not to cry. "What do you say? I could have Kurogiri bring him here right now and you would have what you've always wanted. A quirk that you could use however you like."

A quirk that would come with so much anguish. Even just the thought of taking Kacchan's quirk for his own made him want to vomit again. Even if he did want to take from his childhood friend, from his former tormentor, the entire process would put him even more under All For One's thumb. Something he'd been careful to avoid up until this point. Any resources he used or borrowed were paid for with information. He'd purposely never put himself in a place of owing the man in front of him a goddamn thing.

But if he was to take a quirk from him he'd be bound to the man for probably the rest of his miserable life.

"No. Absolutely not." Izuku grit out, taking another step back and towards the door he knew was hidden along the wall. Screw this. He'd find a way to get Kacchan out of that bar but he was not staying here a moment longer than he absolutely needed to. He was not going to be a puppet for this man.

All for One just laughed at him, the sound awful, as he turned and ran for the door. He made no move to stop him, instead sinking back into his throne with a satisfied smile.

"I look forward to our next chat, Izuku!" He called at the retreating teenagers back, laughing at how it made him run all the harder.

Izuku burst out of the room and into the warehouse, trying his best not to look into the tanks of Nomu that stretched across most of the space. He didn't let himself think, didn't let himself do anything other than run.

It wasn't until he was out of the warehouse that he let himself stop and his revolting stomach get what it wanted. He leaned against the side of the building and vomited up everything that had been in his stomach. It was only then that he let the entire situation sink in.

The League had Kacchan. And would probably kill him once they figured out his convictions would never for a second let him become a villain.

All For One knew who he was. He knew his history. Knew what Kacchan was to him, at least on the surface. The man probably knew where his mother was and every single detail about his life for the past few years.

The Heroes were coming, soon. The press conference was oddly timed to begin with when they announced it but Izuku's gut told him it would be some kind of diversion. Either for the

heroes to go in and save Kacchan or to give false information.

Letting out a shaky breath, Izuku leaned his whole body weight onto the building and fought the urge to slide down it and have a tiny bit of a breakdown. He deserved it, he thought. But he couldn't do that. He needed to either get as far away from All for One as possible or find his way back to the bar to see if he could get Kacchan out.

Pushing himself back to his feet, he froze when the sounds of shuffling reached his ears from the alleyway beside the warehouse. Was All for One sending a Nomu after him? No, all of the current nomu were too big for that cramped alleyway. His mind raced as he inched closer and closer to the opening of the alley.

Instead of coming face to face with a monster or a villain, Izuku came face to face with four UA Hero students.

They spotted him at the same time he recognized them, terror creeping up their faces as they realized they'd been caught. How had they even found this place? No one except for the League knew about this operation.

"Who are you?"

Pulling himself from his thoughts, he frowned at the brown haired girl that addressed him. She looked like, even within the tight quarters of the alley, she was ready to fight him on the spot. He couldn't help but roll his eyes at her as he took a step back away from the mouth of the alleyway and held up his hands.

"Shouldn't I be asking you that? Why are four hero course students skulking about a warehouse in the middle of the night, hm?" He drawled, trying to muster up enough sass to not let them think they had the upper hand here. He had better things to do than babysit some kids who thought they could do whatever they pleased.

They never got the chance to answer him, though. The ground felt like it was shaking as something collided with the front of the warehouse and Izuku reached for the building to steady himself.

It looked like the heroes were here after all.

Chapter End Notes

So! I've you've watched my series on tiktok you kind of know where this is going to head. Sort of. I have a lot of stuff planned!

Heads up, though, this is absolutely a AU so some things are going to be changed. Like Uraraka joining the rescue mission! I hope you enjoyed!

He was looking for a soul to steal

Chapter Summary

Shouta just wants to check on his student in the aftermath of rescue. What he gets, instead, is a gateway for chaos.

Chapter Notes

This chapter kicked my ass, really and truly. Originally, it was supposed to be Izuku's POV but he refused to tell this part of the story himself. Anyway! I hope yall enjoy!

As always, no beta and minimal editing. Hopefully there's no glaring errors lol

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Aizawa Shouta was a lot of things. Patient was usually one of them. You had to be when dealing with teenagers. Especially dealing with 1A. An ounce less of patience on his part and he might have expelled them all already.

After tonight, he might just do it anyway.

His patience has run its course at the moment, though. He doesn't have even an ounce of it left. Not when he's already had to deal with the media and watch the quite frankly horrific battle between All Might and All for One.

Not when after waiting what felt like all night, he finally got word that his student was confirmed safe and in police custody. Along with word that at least four of his other students had shown up at the police station with him.

Expulsions were on the horizon, he could practically feel it.

Which is why he did not complain once when Hizashi demanded he drive him to the station, stating that Shouta was in no state to do it himself. That was bullshit and Hizashi knew it. The blonde just wanted an excuse to go with him instead of staying home and waiting for a phone call that Bakugo was unharmed.

Shouta didn't call him on it. Instead acquiesced to the decision and wisely kept his mouth shut at the speed his husband used getting them to their destination.

In return, his husband didn't say a word to him about how he practically tucked and rolled out of the car once they did arrive at the station. Hizashi would later complain that he hadn't

even slowed down yet before Shouta's door was open and the underground hero was gone.

Shouta hadn't even opened the door yet when he heard the yelling. It sounded like Bakugou was having a fit about something and there were several voices answering his. The hero didn't even pause or slow his stride as he moved towards the door and threw it open.

If he paused for just a second to soak in the fact that Bakugo barely even had a scratch on him and let himself feel relieved over it, that was between him and whatever deity was watching over him.

Hearing the door open, the blonde teenager turned to face him with a wild look on his face. Seeing who it was, he took several strides away from the officers that were blocking his way from wherever he was trying to go and latched onto Shouta's sleeve.

"Sensei, you have to make them let him go. He didn't do anything. They're holding him without cause." The explosive teen ground out, knuckles white from the strength of his grip on the older man.

That was...definitely not something he was expecting to hear out of the teenagers mouth. His eyes flickered away from his student and to the officers for a moment, all of which looked apologetic and as confused as Shouta was beginning to feel.

Luckily for his sanity, Detective Tsukauchi pushed his way past the officers and beckoned Shouta to follow him. As he did, Bakugo trailed after him with a thunderous look on his face. When the detective turned around to see that he'd followed he sighed and Shouta had to wonder what exactly had happened in the time it took for him to get to the station for the man to be put out already by the teen.

"Bakugo came to the station a little after sunrise with several of your students." The Detective started, handing over the file in his hands. Shouta was definitely expelling some students damn it. The man's next words, though, pushed the already fuming thoughts out of his brain for a moment. "He was also dragging a known and wanted criminal with him."

"Bullshit! Deku is not a damn criminal." The teen exploded, finally letting go of his teacher to let his palms spark. Something he only did, Shouta noticed, when he was stressed these days.

"This 'Deku', Midoriya Izuku, is a ranked Villain." Tsukauchi raised his voice over the teen's, brows pinched as he ignored Bakugo in favor of staring Shouta down like this was all his fault. "We're holding him currently until we decide what to do."

"Decide what to do?! He hasn't done shit! He helped me escape those bastards!" Bakugo yelled again, taking a step towards the detective before Shouta's hand shot forward to grab him by the back of the shirt.

This….was obviously a strange occurrence. Ranked villains weren't exceedingly rare but it was rare for a department not to send them to the commission immediately to be dealt with. Tsukauchi, seeing the quirked brow Shouta sent his way, sighed and rubbed a hand through his hair.

“It’s...complicated with Midoriya. We know he wasn’t involved with the kidnapping, it’s a known fact that he’d rather cut Shigaraki into pieces than help him, and we’re pretty sure he helped Bakugo escape. Hell, he’s given the department info before seemingly just to help.” The man glanced uneasily towards the hallway the officers were still guarding. “But the commission wants him. Bad. He’s just a kid and I’m at a loss for what to do here.”

Shouta stared down at the file in his hands, flipping it open for the first time to see the picture of a smiling preteen staring back up at him. The words underneath his picture, though, drew his eyes next.

Presumed Dead. Suicide at age 13. No Body Recovered

Fuck.

Shouta let his eyes close briefly, closing the file and finally letting go of Bakugo. He had hoped that this was going to be an easy in, easy out, kind of thing. Make sure the kid was okay, escort him home, and then go pass out for the next couple of days.

“I’ll call Nezu and see what we can do.” The unsaid ‘before the commission finds out he’s here’ was loud and clear, though, by the way Tsukauchi’s shoulders relaxed a little. “Bakugo, go with Present Mic and call your parents to let them know you’re alive.”

At least the teen had the sense to look a little guilty at that before he turned to walk back towards the entrance of the station where Hizashi was waiting.

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Izuku Midoriya was not anything like how Shouta expected him to be. Honestly, he wasn’t sure what to expect considering how thin the file on him was that Tsukauchi was able to put together.

All the file told him was that the kid was Quirkless and had presumably committed suicide two and a half years prior. His things had been found on a local bridge along with a note. However, no body ever surfaced from the river and since it was just another quirkless kid no one ever bothered to look any further than the note and his things.

The Midoriya in front of him no longer looked like the child in the file, either. Gone was the wide smile, replaced with a carefully blank mask. His hair was cut close to his head on the sides, wild curls left to grow on top.

The overlarge hoodie he’d been wearing when he was arrested had been confiscated, along with an almost frightening amount of knives. This left more of the teen exposed than he seemed comfortable with, Shouta thought.

His hands and arms were covered in scars as far up as Shouta could see. The t-shirt he was wearing was too big on his small frame, slipping a little down his shoulder to reveal a scar against his collar bone that looked almost like a handprint.

The kid sitting cuffed to the table in front of him was nothing like he expected, yes.

But he suspected that the kid wasn't exactly expecting Shouta and Nezu to walk through the door to speak with him, either.

The momentary flash of surprise that flickered through those green eyes was filed away in Shouta's brain for later examination. Midoriya clearly knew who they were at first glance which was interesting.

The kids eyes also lingered on him for a moment longer before focusing on Nezu. Interesting.

"What do I owe the pleasure of a personal visit from Principal Nezu himself?" Midoriya rasped, apparently trying to keep his tone level and hide away all of the anxiety he was feeling.

The kid was good at hiding it, true, but he couldn't erase the signs completely. Not when Shouta could see the areas of the kids fingers that looked like they'd been picked raw during the time the kid had been alone in the room. Or the fact that his knee was subtly bouncing under the table in an attempt to exercise some of the anxious energy out of himself.

The kid was definitely good enough to hide most of the signs from, say, the common street thug or someone like Shigaraki. But he wasn't good enough to hide them from someone who dealt with anxious and unpredictable teenagers day in and day out.

He couldn't fool Shouta.

"I had to meet the one of the youngest ranked Villains in the country in person when I found out you were here!" Nezu trilled, walking across the table top to stop right in front of the teenager, paws clasped behind his back. "You must be very smart to have garnered such attention by just knowing too much, young man!"

The teen's brows furrowed a little, clearly confused and off balance. Shouta held back a snort at the growing bewilderment of the teenager in front of them. This was clearly not the way the kid had thought today was going to go.

"I...don't think I follow." Midoriya said finally, eyes flickering uneasily between the two of them.

Nezu just laughed and clapped his hands happily, swaying on his feet in a way that only ever meant a headache for Shouta.

"We both have problems that need to be solved, Midoriya Izuku. You, presumably, don't want to go to prison for the rest of your life just because you know more than the average thug and I need help keeping my students safe from one Shigaraki Tomura. I think we can find a mutually beneficial solution here."

Nezu let the words hang in the air for a moment, his grin taking on a feral glint as he moved to lean into the teen's space. Midoriya, to his credit, didn't flinch away from him and met the chimera's gaze evenly.

“What do you say, my boy? Unless of course, you want to rot in whatever place the commission decides to send you to once they find out you’re here?”

“No, Sir, I think we can come up with something that will work.”

Shouta watched the teen lean forward into Nezu’s space and reached out one of his cuffed hands for a handshake, a feral light in his eyes shining bright in his eyes to rival Nezu’s own.

At that moment, not for the first time in his career, Shouta wondered exactly what he’d signed up for when he’d agreed to teach under Nezu. He trusted the rat but gods did he wonder if the principal planned things for the sake of chaos alone.

Chapter End Notes

Please let me know what you think! If you aren't already, come follow me on TikTok at @EmbeddedTarot! I post a lot of videos of this au and give updates there as well!

I'm hoping to get into a good rhythm and upload schedule soon! I'm looking at hopefully uploading on Saturday or Sunday every week!

Next Chapter should be in Izuku's POV if he decides he wants to work with me lol

I can see you're out of aces (Part One of The Talk)

Chapter Summary

Aizawa and Izuku have a 'get to know you' kind of talk.

Chapter Notes

This chapter took forever and I'm having to break it up because I can't stand to look at it any longer. This is Part One of the conversation that Aizawa and Izuku are going to have! I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Izuku pictured how rescuing Kacchan from the league was going to go, he was prepared for things to go sideways quickly. They always did when his luck met Shigaraki's particular brand of stupidity. However, he did not expect things to go this far sideways.

Not in a million years did he ever expect to be standing on the U.A Campus watching Eraserhead putter around a small apartment with two cats following him, yelling for food.

He let himself drop down onto the sofa in the living area and watch the entire thing with wide eyes. The whole situation was bizarre, honestly.

Sure, when Nezu had said 'Come protect my students from Shigaraki and I'll keep you from disappearing quietly at the hands of the commission' he knew rationally that he'd end up at U.A at some point but…

No, at no point did he really think he'd end up here.

He was still half expecting some shadow government agent to come swooping out of nowhere and grabbing him up.

Look, you didn't get to be as good at information gathering as he had without making some enemies. Knowledge was power, after all.

But honestly, what was he going to do with the information? It wasn't like the public was going to believe that the commission had groomed and abused a top ten hero since childhood when it came from the mouth of a quirkless nobody.

But apparently even knowing about the program in question was too dangerous in their eyes. Bullshit, is what it was.

Shaking himself out of that depressing thought process, he turned his eyes back towards the underground hero currently trying to caffeinate

Eraserhead glared down at the cats at his feet, stepping over them with practiced ease as he moved towards the coffee pot. From the bags under his eyes, Izuku would hazard a guess that the man had gotten between zero and none hours of sleep since the whole League ordeal had begun.

The little apartment was silent for the most part, aside from the noise of the cats and the man in the kitchen, so Izuku let himself relax back onto the sofa with a small sigh. They were on the ground floor of the newly built 1A dorms, presumably so Eraserhead could keep an eye on the students during the night without sacrificing his own privacy.

Students that Izuku was going to have to meet very soon. A tiny bit of anxiety curled at his cut at the thought of it. It wasn't often these days that he interacted with people his own age and the glaring difference in their life experience was going to be pretty damn obvious to all of them once the situation was explained.

Not to mention what they'd think of him once they found out he was quirkless.

No, he didn't have high expectations for how this entire experience was going to go honestly.

The shuffling footsteps of the adult whose sofa he was sitting on drew him out of his thoughts, gaze lifting to the man once more as he made his way back into the room and set his coffee down on the table between them before dropping into the chair positioned across from Izuku.

He didn't immediately look at him, instead focusing on the file he'd brought with him. He laid it on the coffee table and flipped it open and Izuku caught a glimpse of his own face.

"So, Midoriya, I have a few questions for you before we go over what you're going to be doing here. They're mostly for me, to better gauge how much you can handle right now and what we need to work on." He man rumbled, still not looking at Izuku as he reached for his coffee. "We have a therapist on staff who we can make an appointment for you with a little bit later on but with classes starting in a couple days I need some of these answers immediately."

The man looked up then and met the teenager's bewildered gaze, only breaking eye contact with Izuku once he nodded his understanding.

"I'd be more comfortable if you just called me Izuku." The teen mumbled out, glancing away from the adult to stare at the cat that was now perched at his feet.

Midoriya was his mother. Midoriya was his father. Izuku didn't want to associate himself with that name ever again.

The underground hero didn't say anything but marked down the request before flipping to the questions he'd prepared.

“Okay, Izuku. Since we’re going to be in close proximity together, call me Aizawa.” The hero met his gaze once more to confirm with him before looking back down at the paper. “I need to know what you’ve been doing for the past two and a half years. The police didn’t actually have a lot of information on you.”

The teen nodded, fingers fiddling with the sleeves of his hoodie nervously. He’d been very careful during his career to make sure as few people as possible had any info on him at all. As far as he knew only two total people knew everything.

Seeing the teen’s nod, the hero sat up a little bit and set aside the paper. It wasn’t like there was much useful information on it, anyway.

“Where did you go after you faked your death?”

Izuku couldn’t stop his leg from bouncing at the question, hands disappearing into his hoodie once more. He didn’t have any of his knives, of course, but it was a comfort thing at this point. One that he was sure the hero in front of him picked up on.

“Uh...technically I didn’t fake my death. I fully intended on dying that night.” Izuku ignored the way Aizawa’s eyes were honed in on his face, fully willing to ignore the troubled expression on the adult's face. “Someone pulled me out of the river and by the time I was coherent enough to correct the assumption everyone had already written me off as gone. I just figured it was easier to let sleeping dogs lie, you know?”

The teenager fiddled with his sleeves carefully avoiding the adult's gaze, growing more and more restless as the silence that followed his words stretched on and on. It felt like forever before Aizawa drew in a deep breath and leaned forward, trying to catch the other’s gaze.

“You thought it was better to let your mother think you were dead?”

There was something lingering in the teacher’s words that Izuku couldn’t quite put his finger on. The man didn’t sound angry, at least, but rather….hurt? No. Worried, maybe. Which made no sense because there was nothing to worry about. Not anymore, at least.

“I mean, I made her life worse just by being born, you know? As it was, I didn’t see her very often because of how much she had to work so I didn’t think she’d be very upset to see me go.”

He did look up after that statement because of the noise that Aizawa made, low and angry like one of the cats Izuku used to feed in the alley behind his safehouse. Aizawa wasn’t looking at him, though, he was scribbling something into the notepad of questions. Izuku’s first instinct was to think that the man was upset with him but the man’s body language said otherwise.

Upset for him? But that was ridiculous. This was the reality a lot of homeless kids went through. Surely an underground hero like Eraserhead had run across parents like Midoriya Inko before? Izuku had met his fair share of people with stories like his, anyway.

“Kid, there is more wrong with that entire statement than I have time to unpack right now. We’ll be sure to discuss it with her when we contact her..”

Contact her? No! Absolutely not.

“You can’t!” The words exploded out of him without his consent, eyes wide and panicked as he leaned across the coffee table to grab Aizawa’s sleeve. “She can’t know. Just leave it, please!”

It was an irrational reaction, he knew, but he couldn’t go back into that house. Not after all these years and absolutely not after everything that had happened. It would feel too much like becoming that stupid, useless, Deku all over again. And knowing his mother, she’d wrap him in bubble wrap and make sure he never left her sight again. Or, even worse, what if she didn’t actually care like everyone had suggested over the years. He couldn’t handle the unknown right now.

“You’re a minor, we’re going to have to inform her at some point.” The adult tried to argue logic, brows furrowed at the teen’s reaction.

“A minor who is still legally dead. You don’t have to tell her jack shit!” Izuku tried for logic and overshot it into hysterical. He knew, though, that his reaction was giving the older man pause. “Please, don’t tell her. I can’t go back there.”

He could tell he’d won the argument when Aizawa’s shoulders slumped and he rubbed his hand over his eyes. Only when he nodded did Izuku relax and release his wrist, retreating back onto his sofa and curling up into a tight ball.

Boy was this a hell of a get to know you conversation.

“Fine, kid, but I have another question you’re not going to like. Who pulled you from the river?”

“No.” Aizawa was not going to like that answer and Izuku didn’t really want to get thrown to the commission so soon.

“You have to work with me here, kid. I can’t help if I don’t know key details.” Damn the adult and his logic. Curling up tighter into himself, he peeked at the man over the tops of his knees.

“You know him as Dabi.” He said shortly, glancing away from the hero before he could see the look on his face. “He must have seen me jump and pulled me out. On top of that, he used a shit ton of favors with a local healer to keep me alive and speed up my healing.”

Aizawa was going to be able to read between the lines, he knew. Never in his entire life was Izuku going to be able to pay that kind of act back. Even if Dabi refused to talk about it or even mention it after that day, Izuku literally owed the man his life. Even more so for everything he did for him after the fact.

“Did you know about the attack on the summer camp before hand?” Izuku decidedly did not flinch from the ice in the hero’s tone. Nope. He didn’t care what anyone thought of him or his past. This was a means to an end, that was all.

“I did not. We had a falling out when he joined The League and I haven’t spoken to him since.” He said shortly, still refusing to lift his eyes and meet the other’s gaze. “He wanted me to join with him and I refused to have anything to do with Shigaraki and his boogeyman of a mentor.”

There was a shuffling of paper as the man wrote something down and the room was otherwise silent for a moment.

“Do you know his or the league’s whereabouts now?” The ice was gone from the man’s voice, replaced by something Izuku couldn’t and didn’t have the energy to place.

“No.”

“Do you not know or are you just unwilling to tell me?”

Izuku lifted his gaze at that to glare at the man, fury igniting and blazing behind the green of his eyes for the first time since meeting the pro hero.

“I. Don’t. Know.” He bit out, fingers curling into fists around the fabric of his pants. “If I had any info on Shigaraki, I’d tell you and let the bastard rot in Tartarus. I’d rat out the whole League if I had any information to give.”

He met Aizawa’s gaze steadily, searching for whatever the man was trying to gain from this line of questioning. There was a flash of satisfaction for a moment before it was buried under the man’s mask of interference again.

So a test, then. Izuku hated him, just a little, for that.

“I’m done with this. Choose a different subject.” Izuku huffed, looking away finally.

Chapter End Notes

First things first, there is a prequel in the works right now for this story covering the night Izuku attempted to unalive himself and how he met Dabi. Keep an eye out for that! Dabi and Izuku's friendship is an interesting one that I really enjoy exploring in this au!

I hope everyone enjoyed the chapter! Izuku is a little shit and makes this harder than necessary so next chapter will likely be from Aizawa's perspective.

Let me know what you thought and have a wonderful day <3

For a taste of your whiskey, I'll give you some advice

Chapter Summary

> The second part of The Talk featuring a conversation with the Bakugo household. Shouta just wants to sleep.

Chapter Notes

> This got away from me rather quickly. It was just supposed to be the second part of that conversation but then Bakugo and his parents wanted to talk, too. I am as tired as Aizawa right now of these shenanigans.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Midoriya Izuku was nothing like Shouta expected.

Sure, he was expecting to be met with a traumatized teenager. It wasn't anything outside of his normal scope of operations. Hell, he dealt with 20 traumatized kids on a daily basis. He hadn't thought that this was going to be any different.

And he couldn't have proved himself more wrong if he'd tried, at this point.

What kid had to beg someone not to tell their parents that they were alive?

What kid tried to take their own life at such a young age?

"I'm done with this. Choose a different subject." Izuku had intoned, voice so blank and controlled that it almost broke Shouta's heart. How did an almost 16 year old even know how to mask their emotions this well?

Sighing, Shouta nodded and glanced back down at his list of questions. There were a lot more that he needed to mark out for the moment since this line of questioning was doing nothing more than *losing* him the trust he needed to build with the kid.

“Okay. How comfortable are you with hand to hand combat? I know you’re good with your knives, which I have by the way and might give back depending on how you do this week.”

The kid blinked at him, surprised and more than a little confused if the way he’d uncurled from his ball just a little to peer at the hero over his knees was any indication.

“I….am okay with hand to hand, I guess, but I’ve kinda built my skills more towards talking my way out of situations and analysis?” He mumbled, fingers twisting at the fabric of his pants again, brows furrowed over his eyes. “I guess the answer is I know enough to keep me alive?”

Shouta hummed, marking it down and tapping his pen against the paper as he thought. He’d have to train the kid himself if he wanted him to be able to take over that part of the lessons, then. It was do-able at the very least.

“I’ll need a sample of your analysis before I make any decisions on that, one way or the other, but I’m sure Nezu will cover that with you during his lessons.” He nodded a little to himself before marking something else down on the paper. By this point he could feel the confusion practically rolling off of the teen across from him.

“Uh...okay? What’s this all about?” Shouta lifted his gaze from where he was scribbling out the beginnings of a lesson plan and let his lips pull up into a grin.

“Did you think ‘protecting the students from Shigaraki’ meant you were going to sit at the back of the classroom all day and do nothing? No. I need help getting these kids to the point where they can protect themselves and you’re going to help me.” Shouta pointed the pen at the teen, holding back his laugh at the completely bewildered look on Izuku’s face. “In the meantime, we’re not going to neglect your education, either. So you’ll be having private lessons with Nezu in the mornings while the hero course has their core classes.”

It was a testament to how smart the kid already was, though, that he didn’t seem to flinch. Instead, one of his hands came up to cover his mouth as he started to mumble a little.

The kid's grades in that first year of middle school had been nothing to sneeze at but for him to have survived the way he had, there had to be some brain power behind those green eyes. Not many people could make a survivable way in the world on information trading alone and from what he and Nezu were able to dig up, the kid had been doing pretty well for himself.

Not that he should have *had* to learn that particular skill set in the first place but Shouta was going to give credit where credit was due.

“All Might teaches Heroics, though, doesn’t he? Why would you have me teach things that he obviously can?”

The question snapped Shouta out of his thoughts and he refocused, meeting the kids' gaze steadily. If his brow twitched a little in annoyance at the mention of the former number one here, then that was his business.

Because honestly? His kids were far behind where they needed to be right now *because* of that idiot.

“You would be a sort of teaching assistant for him when he has other things to attend to.” Which happened often and left his lesson plans thin and not up to Shouta’s standards. Something he’d brought to Nezu over and over again.

Something about the way Izuku’s gaze sharpened told Shouta that he’d picked up on what he *wasn’t* saying in this situation. There was also an ugly light behind the kids eyes that didn’t bode well and Shouta couldn’t for the life of him figure out what part of their current conversation was feeding it.

“You will also be helping me grade and other assorted other duties.” He continued on, tearing his gaze away from the teen and glancing over his notes once more. There really wasn’t anything else he *could* ask about at the moment considering the metaphorical minefield he’d stepped into at the beginning of the conversation.

He closed the notes he’d made and leaned back in his chair, taking note of the fact that Izuku had relaxed minutely now that they’d moved away from sensitive topics. This was going to be more complicated than anticipated but that was fine.

Now he just had to find a way to keep his gremlin class from purposely poking those mines with a stick.

Rubbing a hand over his face, he let his eyes close for a moment as he went over everything in his head that needed to be done in the next few days. He just wanted to sleep and cuddle his husband. Neither of which was going to happen any time soon.

“You’re going to be staying here with me, your room is right down the hall. It’s bare right now but either me or someone else on staff will bring you to the mall to get decorations at some point.” Izuku looked surprised at that and Shouta had to stamp down the ugly feeling in his chest directed at every adult that had allowed this kid to get to this point. “Nezu said something about the support department making you a phone so you should have that by tomorrow or at the very latest before classes begin. *I* have to go start making the rounds to talk to students' parents about the dorm system.”

Shouta pushed himself to his feet, groaning a little as his joints protested, and grabbed the file off of the coffee table. He was going to have to submit all of this to Nezu before he left so the principal would know how to structure the program.

“Feel free to hang out here if you want but don’t leave campus. I’ll be back around 5 or so with dinner so try and be back around then if you leave.”

He met the teen’s gaze and only shuffled towards his room to get dressed properly when the kid nodded his understanding. Izuku still looked shell shocked a little but Shouta could handle that later. Right now, he had to figure out a way to convince All Might not to fuck up this whole talking to the parents situation.

- - -

Watching the Bakugo family interact made Shouta suddenly very glad that he’d sent All Might on ahead to the next family. They were a little too much for him to be able to handle on top of the former number one.

As it was, he was already planning in his head how much alcohol he could safely consume without being totally out of it for the first day of classes. There had to be a way to get out of his mind drunk, right?

Bakugo Mitsuki ushered them all into the living room and sat down, forcing her son to sit between her and his father and expectantly looking at Shouta to start speaking.

How did one family manage to have so much *energy?* And that was coming from the man married to Present Mic!

“As you know, the school board has decided to change U.A into a boarding school for the safety of our stude-” He was cut off as the youngest Bakugo leaned forward and started speaking over him, bags under his eyes prominent and dark.

“Yeah, yeah, we know. They already signed the paper and everything. Where’s Deku? You didn’t leave him at that stupid police station did you?!” He burst out, eyes ablaze before his mother reached over and pushed his head down with a noise of frustration.

“Katsuki! Stop interrupting!” She barked, shaking the younger blonde’s head. Aizawa paused for a moment, considering the action. It was unusual to see a parent so...hands on right in front of him but Katsuki wasn’t exploding, instead pushing up with his head as hard as he could and glaring at the woman.

“Wait….Deku? Do you mean Izuku, Katsuki?” Bakugo’s father’s voice cut through whatever growling argument the mother and son were having. Mitsuki seemed to stare at her husband for a moment before shifting her hand to almost pet her son’s hair instead of pushing on him.

“Katsuki? I know it was traumatic, kid, but you couldn’t have seen him.” The change from brash to soft almost gave Shouta whiplash. Instead of dwelling on whatever the hell was going on with these people, he decide to speak up since this was a topic he was very, very, familiar with by now.

“Actually, if you’re asking about Midoriya Izuku, he’s alive and currently in the custody of U.A. For his protection, he’s been put into an old reform program through the school.” Shouta met Katsuki’s gaze and gave a brief nod. “You’ll be seeing a lot of him at U.A, actually, as he’s going to be assisting with some classes.”

“Reform? Protection? What does that even mean? The kid has been gone for almost three years?!” Mitsuki seemed shellshocked, absentmindedly petting her son’s hair as he slumped into her side.

“As this is an ongoing case, I can’t give you a lot of details ma’am.” Shouta intoned, glad for the excuse to dodge some of the questions that he himself didn't have an answer to just yet. Or having to answer to this woman in general.

“Whatever he got into, it was serious.” Katsuki mumbled from his spot against his mother’s side, glancing between his parents uneasily as they both turned their gaze to him. “He burst into the bar the League was holding me in and basically read Crusty the Assclown the riot act. I think he might have tried to bust me out if that guy All Might fought didn’t make him go talk to him or some shit.”

And wasn’t that the most worrying part of all of this? What exactly did All for One want with a teenager? Let alone a teenager as smart and apparently tenacious as Izuku?

Nothing good was the answer to that.

“Actually, if you have time right now, I do have some questions about Izuku. If you don’t mind, it would help substantially. Izuku himself is a little...tight lipped about certain things.” Shouta would probably regret this but he *did* need the information.

“Of course! Anything to help Izuku!” Masaru spoke up this time, leaning forward with a serious expression. The look was mimicked by the man’s wife, red eyes boring into what felt like Shouta’s soul.

“Thank you. How do you know Izuku?” It was a baseline, anyway. He hadn’t actually asked Izuku how he knew Bakugo yet.

“His mother and I are childhood friends! We raised the boys together as much as possible since we were so close together with our pregnancies.” Mitsuki answered before pausing, eyes flying wide. “Wait, have you told Inko yet?! She’s gonna cry for a week when she finds out!”

Please, don’t tell her! I can’t go back there!

“As of right now, she has not been informed. This is a delicate situation.” Aizawa probably should have asked this question before confirming that the boy was alive but what was done was done. He had to hope that this woman had the discretion to read between the damn lines.

“Delicate? Her son has been dead for almost three years! Of course she needs to know!” Or not. Movement at the woman’s side drew Shouta’s gaze and he was met with the contemplative look of his student boring into him. One that was born from the lesson of ‘logical ruses’

Shouta was almost proud of the explosive teen.

“Hag, shut it. He doesn’t do anything without a reason.” The youngest Bakugo snapped, leaning forward and away from his mother, ignoring her indignant growl. “What aren’t you telling us? It has to be big if you’re not following protocol and going through a minor's parents.”

Okay, Shouta was damn proud of his students but at this moment he wanted to throttle the kid. Because now three pairs of eyes were scrutinizing him and god damn it why did everything surrounding Midoriya Izuku have to be so complicated?

In his mind's eye he could see the desperate flash to Izuku’s eyes when he begged not to have his mother informed of his status.

So he went for the truth, mostly.

“I have reason to believe there is something in the home environment that contributed to his suicide attempt.” He kept his tone serious and made sure to look all three of the Bakugo’s in the eye as he said it. “Until the time comes that I can rule that out, he will not be returning to his mother’s care.”

There was a beat of silence where the three people in front of him took that information in before all hell broke loose in the form of Bakugo Katsuki. The teenager jumped up from his seat, small explosions bouncing in his palms.

“Bullshit! Auntie had nothing to do with that!” The blonde yelled, fighting against the hand his mother put on his arm to pull him back down onto the sofa. “It’s my fault, not hers! I’m the one that told him to jump! I’m the one that bullied him into even thinking that it was an option! For years! Ever since his stupid quirk didn’t come in and mine did! Don’t blame anyone else but me! I’m the one responsible!”

It took a moment for the teen’s parents to corral him back onto the sofa with them but even then the small explosions in his palms didn’t die until Shouta flashed his quirk quickly. That seemed to get the teen’s attention again and forced him to meet the hero's gaze once more. All Shouta could see in his eyes was self loathing and anger.

And if Shouta hadn’t looked into Bakugo’s records at the beginning of the year, he’d probably be more shocked by the outburst. If he hadn’t seen the intense amount of therapy the kid had gone through before even stepping foot into the shit show that was his first year at U.A, he might have even believed the kid.

Not that he didn’t believe him about the bullying. He could easily see how a kid with a quirk as powerful as Bakugo Katsuki’s could get the wrong idea in his head and turn into a holy terror. Especially when the kid he grew up with turned out to be quirkless.

The nickname Deku now made a lot more sense to Shouta.

And while he wasn’t exactly happy about it, none of Izuku’s recent actions spoke towards any held resentment against the youngest Bakugo.

The only person he seemed to not want to know he was alive was his mother. And what did that say about the kid’s home life that he’d rather the kid who bullied him and told him to jump know than his own mother?

“It stands to reason, Katsuki, that if you were the sole reason for his attempted suicide that he would have left you to rot in that bar, don’t you think?” Shouta kept his tone even, brow raised as the teen’s gaze wavered a little. “Yet, he walked into a bar full of enemies and attempted to do what he could for you. Now, while it ended up just making the plan that your

foolish classmates carried out, he still cared enough to try. That doesn't sound like someone who thinks you're the sole reason for his attempt."

"That's because the nerd has been too nice for his own good his whole life." Katsuki muttered as he sank back into his mother's side, brows furrowed and arms crossed over his chest. His mother looked between the two, her face filled with uncertainty. This was obviously not the first time this subject had come up in the years since.

She turned back to Shouta, though, with a determination in her eyes that he was familiar with when it came to her son.

"But why suspect Inko? Sure, she had to work a lot since her husband moved overseas but that boy was her entire world." Shouta could almost see the protective urges rising in the woman and sighed to himself.

He just wanted to sleep, at this point. Sleep and only have to deal with his own personal loud blonde.

"Because when I mentioned having a discussion with her, the kid freaked out." He said after a moment, giving in to the urge to rub his hand over his face. "I don't know exactly what led to that series of events that day but it's not exactly a good sign when a child begs someone *not* to tell their parent they survived."

He could see the confusion wearing on the Bakugo's faces and promptly decided he was done with this situation. The hero pushed himself to stand and bowed to them slightly.

"The school will be in touch about move in day and the proper supplies to bring." He turned to exit the room when Katsuki jumped to his feet once more.

"Wait...Can I talk to Izuku…?"

Shouta rubbed his hand over his eyes for a moment before turning back and sighing.

"There will be a proper introduction to him once everyone is settled in the dorms. At that point, he can decide for himself if he wants to have that conversation with you Bakugo."

The teen deflated a little at that but nodded, red eyes stormy as he shoved his hands into his pockets.

Shouta nodded to the teen's parents and turned around and left. They probably needed to have a very long talk amongst themselves and he didn't have the energy to even witness it.

Chapter End Notes

Next up! 1A Meets Izuku! Finally! I'm so beyond done with the set up for this universe lol. Shenanigans and all might slander on the way!

Also, since I probably won't mention it from here on out it wasn't just Katsuki that got some intense therapy after Izuku 'died'. The entire Bakugo family went. So no Mitsuki slander in this universe. (Tbh Izuku is probably gonna call her Mama Mitsuki once he and Katsuki get together so yeah. I kinda love her???)

Let me know what your thoughts! I'm excited to see what yall thought about this chapter!

This is Austin

Chapter Summary

Izuku meets Class 1A finally and has an awkward conversation afterwards.

Chapter Notes

Woo! Another three thousand words I barely planned and managed to wrestle itself out of my control. This time it's Bakugo being the problem child.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After dealing with parents and the Bakugo situation, Shouta fully believed he deserved to sleep for the next week. Obviously there was no way that was going to happen but by the gods he could hope.

Entering the new apartment, a bag of take out for the three of them in his hand, he paused to kick off his boots. And then paused again when he took in the quiet atmosphere of the house. It took him a moment to latch onto the noise of his husband humming from somewhere in the house and once he did he relaxed a little. Rarely was their home this quiet.

It was going to take a hot minute to get used to living on campus but at the very least with two of his husband's three jobs close by he'd get to see him more than he already did.

Plus with a teenager in the mix, things were definitely going to get shaken up a bit.

Shouta headed into the living room only to pause again, brow quirked at the massive bundle of blankets on the sofa. Izuku's face peered out from them after a moment, a glare set on the teen's face.

"You didn't tell me you live with Present Mic!" The teen hissed, blanket bundle wiggling a little as he tried to get a hand free to point accusingly at the underground hero.

Shouta couldn't help the laugh that escaped him as he kept walking, only pausing to stick his hand in the kid's hair and ruffle it a little.

"Kid, I'm married to Present Mic." He said, ignoring the squawk of surprise that the kid let out as he walked past. For a moment he wondered if it was the head touch or his words but ultimately decided he didn't care.

"You're MARRIED."

There was shuffling behind him of the blankets and a second later the kid came skidding into the kitchen with a feral look on his face. Shouta just blinked at him before turning his attention back to unpacking the bag of take out. He could hear Hizashi laughing somewhere deeper in the apartment and guessed the blonde was giving them some space. Gods, he loved that man.

“Yes, kid, we are married. Have been for many many years.”

Glancing up, he took note of the weird look on the kids face. He almost looked dazed for some reason. Shouta didn’t say anything else, moving around the kitchen to grab plates and utensils as he set the table. A minute or so passed before Hizashi joined them, dropping a kiss on Shouta’s cheek as he passed to open the fridge.

It took a minute or more for the kid to gather his thoughts, still hovering nervously near the entrance of the kitchen. His eyes followed their every move, brows furrowed a little as if still confused.

“You….you do realize that this kind of information would make me rich, right? That I sell information for a living.” The kids voice was quiet, confusion laced in every word. His eyes were stormy and uncertain as he met Shouta’s gaze.

“Not anymore, you don’t. Besides, we would know where it came from. You’re the only one aside from the rest of the staff here that knows.” Shouta said it carefully, shrugging a shoulder like he didn’t care about the outcome of what he was talking about. He could see Hizashi out of the corner of his eye watching the interaction carefully. Could almost visibly see his husband catch on to what he was doing.

Of course he didn’t take this lightly. Of course it was a big deal that the kid knew something they’d kept successfully under wraps for years.

(Though now that he thought about it, the hell class was going to figure it out as well soon. He’d deal with that when it came time.)

“I know that but….” Izuku floundered for a moment, trying to find the right words as his gaze flickered between the two heroes quickly. “That’s a lot of trust you’re putting in me, Eraserhead.”

The kid looked so lost and confused in that moment that Shouta took pity on him. He motioned for him to sit down across from him as Hizashi took a seat on the other side of the table as well. His husband was going to tease him mercilessly later about adoption but it wasn’t like he could look this kid in the eyes and just leave him to his own devices. That’s how he’d gotten tangled up in the mess he was already in.

Call Shouta protective. This was a teenager who needed someone to take care of them. And if Shouta was in a position to provide that support then he was going to give it, in any way he could.

“Aizawa. Or Shouta, if you prefer.” He corrected gently, handing a container of food to the teen. “And yes, it is, isn't it? It also gives you a safety net, right? Think of it like that.”

A safety net that he wouldn't ever have to use, if Shouta had anything to say about it. But nevertheless, he wanted the kid to relax and if giving him some sort of knowledge to hold over them if he felt he needed some control then so be it.

Shouta watched as Hizashi knocked his shoulder gently against the teen's to get his attention, smiling brightly when he turned his attention towards him.

"Call me Hizashi, little listener! And Shouta's right, we don't think you'll do anything with the info but if it makes you feel a little more in control then we're happy to offer it up."

Izuku nodded, still looking lost as he turned his gaze back down to his food. Shouta decided to leave it for the moment, let the kid process before they dumped any more information on him. At some point they'd have to discuss the conversation Shouta and the Bakugo family had, of course, but he was willing to let it go for the moment.

There were other, lighter, things to take care of.

"Classes start the day after tomorrow." Shouta changed the subject easily, digging into his own food. "We'll take you to get some clothes and stuff for your room tomorrow before the students start arriving."

Hizashi, the extrovert that he was, perked up at that and shot him a blinding smile. "Oh! That'll be so much fun!"

Shouta almost wanted to laugh at the look of betrayal Izuku sent him. Almost. Because he was really punishing himself with this, as well.

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The first day of classes came faster than Izuku was comfortable with, honestly. The day before they'd managed to get back to the dorms before the students arrived and Izuku spent the rest of the day setting up his room with Hizashi.

He was allowed to call Present Mic by his name!!!

He now knew Eraserhead's full name! And had been reminded several times over the past two days to call him Shouta or Aizawa.

It was a little surreal, honestly.

Last night had been rather quiet, just Hizashi and Izuku setting up furniture and the hero helping Izuku put some posters the two adults had urged him to buy on the walls. Something had settled in Izuku's chest, looking around the room.

It was honestly the first time in years that he'd had a space of his own. Safehouses didn't count.

He wasn't sure, at this point, that his room in his mothers home counted either.

Somehow this room, as hastily thrown together as it was, felt safer and more his than anything he'd had before. It wasn't a feeling he wanted to examine at the moment so he set it aside. He'd deal with his baggage at a later date. He had other things to focus on.

Like that he was currently standing outside of the 1A classroom waiting for Aizawa to announce him. They hadn't really talked about how this introduction would go but there was a lead weight in Izuku's stomach at the thought of standing in front of 20 Hero students and listening to Aizawa tell them his history and why he was here.

Even if Aizawa wouldn't let them get out of hand, let them do what his middle school classmates had done, he couldn't get the thought out of his head.

Then there was the issue of Kacchan.

Aizawa had told him about the conversation he'd had with Kacchan and his parents and while Izuku wasn't upset that the Bakugo's knew he was alive, the nagging thought that this would get back to his mother had kept him awake longer than he would have liked. Plus, having to face Kacchan today was going to be difficult enough as it was.

He didn't think he was ready for the whole conversation that they needed to have. But he didn't think the other boy was going to take no for an answer considering the way they'd left things at the police station.

Izuku was pulled out of his thoughts by the rumbling of Aizawa's voice inside the classroom.

"-eaching assistant joining for heroics and other subjects as needed this year. Be respectful or else, gremlins."

The teenager pulled himself off of the wall and slid the door of the classroom open, stepping inside and stopping next to the podium Aizawa was standing behind. The weight of 20 stares settled on his shoulders and he couldn't help the way his hands slid into the sleeves of his hoodie.

He and Hizashi had compromised on his outfit for today, he could keep the hoodie as long as he wore the black slacks and white dress shirt that the blonde had picked out for him. He'd decided to keep it unzipped for the moment, letting it hang down past his hips more than it usually did. The one thing he'd willingly given up was his shoes. The red was a little obnoxious, and not great for blending into the background like he so wished to do right this moment, but also anyone who was in the know would know with one glance that he was quirkless. And if he could manage to keep that information to himself for as long as possible, he would be thrilled.

(Aizawa had left the conversation about clothes entirely at the beginning, declaring he didn't care if Izuku wore sweatpants and a crop top. Hizashi had been rather indigent about it.)

As he stood at the podium, his eyes quickly gravitated to the students who had shown up at the warehouse that night. Each of them looked a little shell shocked, eyes blown wide and mouths gaping open. The blue haired boy looked about ready to have a heart attack.

Which made sense because he'd been close enough to hear the officers when Izuku had been arrested that morning. Damn. He'd had some hope that the whole 'villain' thing would be easy to avoid for a while.

Oh well. He'd figure it out.

Just like he was decidedly avoiding the intense eye contact Kacchan was trying to have with him right now. Out of all of the other students, the blonde's gaze felt the heaviest on him. Almost burned with its intensity.

Gods he was not ready for this.

"Mr. Aizawa! Surely you must know that this is a Villain you are allowing into U.A's halls!" The blue haired boy had risen to his feet, arm making a chopping motion in his panic. Izuku's heart sank at the words and he wanted to curl in on himself.

He curbed the instinct just barely and instead focused on the issue at hand. Aizawa had given him permission to deal with the class as he saw fit when it came to training….

Knowledge was the most powerful tool, wasn't it? Pen mightier than the sword and all that?

So instead of curling in on himself, Izuku squared his shoulders and met the other teen's gaze head on. He could see the rest of the class shifting uncertainly, tense and starting to mutter and mumble among themselves.

"That is information you only know because you participated in an illegal rescue attempt when Bakugo Katsuki was kidnapped." Izuku said calmly, clasping his hands behind him and pulling himself up to his full height. It wasn't much but it was sure to show he meant business, at least. "I don't think you have a leg to stand on, Iida Tenya, when it comes to 'villainous' activity."

No, not when the boy had the gall to think he as a student could take out a villain that had killed numerous trained professionals. He'd have to make sure the other boy knew that he knew that little fact at his earliest convenience.

A side glance to Aizawa told him that the man was giving him the floor and he fought the urge to sigh. Thrown to the wolves on the first day? Cold. Efficient, yes, but still. Cold. He would be sure to be as dramatic as possible when re-telling this story to Hizashi later.

"My name is Midoriya Izuku, please just call me Izuku. As your classmate so tactfully blurted out, I was considered a Villain at one point in time. Now, I'm a ward of U.A and here to help you not get killed by Shigaraki Tomura."

He could tell he had their attention, eyes scanning the rows of students carefully. He made eye contact with each student for a moment before shifting a little to reach for the collar of

his shirt. It was Iida's gaze he went back to and held as his fingers worked at the top button of his dress shirt.

"I happen to know a little about what it means to be targeted by him." He let his words sink in as he pushed his shirt open to reveal the handprint scar against his collarbone and wrapping over his shoulder. A few of the students' mouths hung open and one girl with a darker shade of green hair than his own turned her eyes away quickly, a hand coming up to cover her mouth.

His point made, he closed his shirt once more and turned his gaze over to Aizawa. The man's jaw flexed as he met Izuku's gaze but he could tell that the man wasn't upset with him.

He was upset for him. Which was stupid considering he'd picked the fight that had caused this particular scar. It was his own stupidity that had done it. And it wasn't something the hero would be able to fix.

Aizawa tore his gaze away from Izuku to glare out at his class once more, quirk activated as their whispers started to raise in volume.

"Iida, we will be having a discussion about the proper time and place to divulge information later on. Please pay attention." The teen in question nodded choppily and sank back into his seat, properly chastised. The hero turned his attention back to the rest of the class. "Today's heroics lesson is going to be on basic hand to hand techniques, go change into your gym clothes and meet back here."

Izuku relaxed a little as the students started getting up and milling towards the door. He allowed himself to take a few steps back and partially hide himself behind Aizawa. The man seemed to know what he was doing and let him, still standing at the podium as the class filed out instead of slinking into his sleeping bag. Izuku shot him a grateful look that was answered with a small quirk of the man's lips.

All in all, the first introduction hadn't gone too horribly. Nothing was on fire, at least.

Yet, his mind whispered as he caught sight of Kacchan dragging his feet in collecting his things. Of course he couldn't get out of some sort of conversion with the explosive teen. He shot Aizawa a just slightly panic filled look but the man seemed to purposely not be looking at him, eyes trained on a folder in front of him.

Damn him. Another thing to dramatically complain to Hizashi about.

Sighing and running a hand through his hair, Izuku stepped out from behind Aizawa as the last student besides Kacchan filtered out of the classroom. The last student, the red head with the hardening quirk from the rescue mission, shot a lingering look behind him as he left but said nothing about the fact that Kacchan was dragging his feet. Smart kid, that one.

"Kacchan." Izuku said the name simply as he stood in front of his once childhood friend, fingers twisting anxiously in the sleeves of his hoodie. The blonde's gaze bore into him and

for a moment he wanted to run away. Have this conversation on a day where he could be positive it wouldn't end in tears.

The blonde stared at him for a moment longer before bowing, posture so stiff and tight that Izuku could have cut himself on it if he had reached out at that moment. If he'd had the mind to do anything but gape at the teen in front of him.

"I'm sorry." The blonde teen's voice was muffled a little but the tone was clear. Regret. Self loathing. Anger, possibly directed at himself? Izuku didn't know much past that, his entire brain shorting out at the absurdity of this whole situation. "I know that words don't mean jack shit and won't fix anything but I am sorry. Sorry that you had to deal with all of my bullshit. Sorry that I pushed you to think that jumping off of that bridge was a good idea. Sorry that I made you think you were better off where you were than at home. I'm so goddamn sorry about all of it."

Izuku cut his gaze toward Aizawa whose own eyes were wide at the display. When he met Izuku's gaze he gave a small shrug and the teen wanted to throw something at him.

Hearing Kacchan cry was decidedly not something Izuku was built to handle. And that was exactly in front of him, right now. He couldn't see Kacchan's face but his voice was thick with tears and regret.

Unable to stand the feeling swirling in his gut, Izuku closed what little distance was between him and the other boy and reached out to lay a hand on his shoulder. Katsuki's head lifted at the touch and met Izuku's own watery gaze. Seemingly panicked that he'd made the green haired teen cry, Katsuki stood up and grasped at the teen's wrist, eyes blown wide with panic.

"Kacchan, no! None of this was your fault." The unbelieving look on the others face made him backtrack a little, free hand waving and gesturing quickly. "Okay, some of it was you but not all! Not even the majority! Me not coming home had nothing to do with you! I promise."

There was no way he could tell Katsuki who actually caused all of this. Not yet, at least. He wasn't petty enough to break someone's faith in their hero while there were more important things to worry about.

A look came across Katsuki's face before his eyes darted towards Aizawa and back to Izuku, brows furrowed.

"Was it Auntie? Did she hurt you somehow?" Izuku almost smiled at the almost protective tone in the other's voice. He hadn't heard it in so long….

"No, Kacchan. She didn't hurt me." Not physically, at least. "It's...complicated."

He could see from the furrow in the other teen's brow that he wasn't going to let this go so Izuku changed tactics. He shifted the arm that Katsuki was holding until he was clasping at Izuku's hand. He could almost feel Aizawa's eyes boring into him and brushed it off.

It wasn’t like he was holding hands with someone in front of his dad. Nope. Not at all. He hadn’t known the man long enough for that. Not even a little.

“You have class to get to, Kacchan, and this isn’t a conversation we can have quickly, you know?” He kept his tone soft as he met the stormy red gaze with his own. “I forgive you, Kacchan. Yeah, words don’t mean shit but actions do. Show me you’re sorry and give me a little space for right now and maybe we can work on starting over?”

Katsuki seemed torn but at the gentle squeeze of his hand finally nodded, free hand coming up to rub at his face angrily. Izuku almost felt bad that the rest of the class was probably going to be able to tell he’d been crying. Almost.

The explosive teen squeezed his hand before letting it go entirely and picking up his bag, silently meeting Aizawa’s gaze before making his way out of the classroom.

Once he was gone, Izuku let himself curl in on himself a little, hands rubbing over his face tiredly. Nothing ever went his way, did it? At least this surprise could turn out to be a good thing, this time.

He hoped. Gods did he hope.

“So. Kacchan, huh?”

Izuku lifted his face to glare at the other man.

“Hush before I tell the class that you have to have a goodnight kiss from Hizashi before you have for patrol!”

“Don’t you dare, problem child!”

Chapter End Notes

Pacing? What's that? Don't know her.

Seriously, I know that apology feels like it's coming out of nowhere but I really can't see them moving forward without it. It's not a quick fix, they're friends again, but it's a start. Also Dadzawa is happening fast too but sue me, I needed a little fluff. (Also sorry, Iida. You're an easy target)

I made a beacon link if anyone wants to check out my tiktok, it's in my profile!

I hope yall enjoy this chapter! Next one is going to be some short snippets of 1A getting to know Izuku!

Find out who your friends are

Chapter Summary

Mineta gets what he deserves and Izuku makes some friends

Chapter Notes

This is not exactly the chapter I wanted to write but it will do! I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The transition into the dorms went smoothly and the students and teachers alike fell into an easy routine.

Most nights, Shouta would find himself settling down at one of the tables in the common room to grade or go over reports for a few hours. Was this absolutely necessary? Not really. It did, however, make him feel better.

Most of these kids were old enough to be self-sufficient but it didn't hurt to be extra cautious.

Especially after the first fire Kirishima started in the kitchen attempting to cook. It was easier to be in the area or tucked into a nearby corner to keep an eye on his hell class than it was to have to be summoned from his apartment.

Plus, it wasn't like there was anyone there but the cats until a certain time. Hizashi always worked for a few hours after classes ended at the Station and Izuku had started working on socializing with kids his own age. Shouta had no comment on how well that was going, currently. (Poorly. It was going poorly. The kid had little to no normal social skills)

Shouta lifted his gaze from the papers in his lap to scan the common room again, brow scrunching a little when he realized he hadn't seen his ward since classes had let out that afternoon.

Slightly worrying.

It was a tiny break in routine that nagged at the back of the hero's mind. Usually Izuku sat with him for a little while going over lesson plans and whatever homework Nezu had given him before wandering off to attempt to act like a normal teenager. After making little progress, he'd come back to the apartment to hang out with Shouta and Hizashi before Shouta left for patrol.

His gaze flickered through the students currently in the common room, pen tapping against the papers in his lap idly as he thought.

Uraraka, Asui, and Jirou were huddled around one table trying to make heads or tales of the homework Hizashi had assigned. Beyond them, he could see Bakugo attempting to literally beat the knowledge on their next test into Kaminari and Kirishima's heads with a rolled up paper while Sero laughed at them. He could hear Iida, somewhere out of his vision, scolding Bakugo and his group for being loud.

He was trying to recall where the rest of the class was when the elevator dinged behind him. In itself it wouldn't be something to pay attention to if he couldn't hear the yelling coming from inside of it.

The door slid open and the yelling became words instead of indistinct noise.

"-of me you stupid villain!" It was Mineta's voice and Shouta took a moment to close his eyes and steady his temper before he turned around. Izuku was holding the student by the back of his shirt off of the ground and the look on his face was nothing less than furious.

Shouta's eyes slid away from the two boys to the two other students coming out of the elevator, Ashido and Yaoyorozu walked behind Izuku as he made his way further into the common area. Both girls looked uncomfortable and pale, Ashido's hand rested on Yaoyorozu's back comfortingly as they made their way forward.

"How dare you touch me! Let me down this instant! I'm going to get you thrown in jail so fast for assaulting a student!" Mineta continued to yell as he wiggled uselessly in Izuku's grip. At this point everyone in the commons area watched as the green haired teen stalked towards Shouta, knuckles white with how hard he was holding onto the perverted teenager in his grip.

The teen stopped in front of the hero and shook the grape haired boy in his grip in his direction.

"I found this little pervert in Yaoyorozu's room, going through her underwear drawer." Izuku growled, shaking the smaller teen again when he made a noise to protest.

Shouta blinked and took a moment to count to ten in his mind. Had he not just impressed upon these kids just a week ago to not step a single toe out of line? Was he not clear in the threat? With All Might's retirement it was going to be much more difficult to expel students but he was sure Nezu was going to make an exception here. Especially in this case.

"What were you even doing up there? Shouldn't Mr. Aizawa be more worried about a villain roaming around the campus?" Mineta spat, wiggling around again to glare up at the green haired teen.

Izuku growled and dropped the smaller teen to the ground, looming over him with a look that would have sent most sane people running for the hills. Mineta apparently didn't have the sense the gods gave a fly, though, because he just kept ranting about being manhandled and assaulted. Shouta wondered where exactly he'd gone wrong recently to deserve this kind of headache.

"Izuku, why were you on the fifth floor in the first place?" He asked, pinching the bridge of his nose before glancing at his ward.

"I heard this disgusting little creep muttering about panties and cameras earlier and asked the girls if they'd be comfortable with me checking their rooms just in case." The green haired teen growled the words out, hands flexing at his sides as he glared down at Mineta. "Yaoyorozu and Ashido came with me to be witnesses that I wasn't doing anything sketchy."

By now a crowd had gathered around and when Shouta glanced towards Uraraka and the other girls they just nodded to agree with Izuku's statement. Asui and Jirou looked angry about it, as well, so he turned his gaze over to the two girls that came out of the elevator with the other two.

"We found him in my room and it looks like he might have been in Ashido's room just before mine." Yaoyorozu's voice was steady for the most part but Shouta could just barely hear the tremor in it.

His gaze flickered between the girls of his class and back to Mineta who was growing increasingly pale.

"Were there any cameras?" He asked, gaze flicking back to Izuku. The teen's jaw was clenched but he was calming down slowly, hands no longer flexing and no longer looking like he was about to stomp the smaller teen at any moment.

"None that I could find."

With a sigh, Shouta gathered the loose papers in his lap together and slid them back into order before standing. He handed the folder to Izuku before his capture weapon snapped forward to wrap Mineta up. The purple haired teen made an indignant noise before his mouth was covered as well.

Shouta held him up to eye level, glaring at him with as much wrath as he could muster without activating his quirk. "We're going to have a nice long discussion about this with Principal Nezu. I do remember not even a week ago warning you what would happen if you put a toe out of line."

He flicked his gaze back around the room to the students watching and fought the urge to sigh again.

"Back to what you were doing. Don't burn the building down while I'm gone."

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Izuku watched Shouta leave the building and let out the deepest sigh he could muster, shoulders sagging as the unadulterated rage he'd felt finding that little creep in the girls room finally seeped out of him.

He'd run into way too many disgusting people like that kid to let it stand. It was his job to protect these kids from villains and in his opinion that little fucker was about a step away from being the worst kind of villain.

Running a hand through his hair, he turned to face the students who had gathered to watch the entire scene go down with a little bit of trepidation. Sure, he knew that the girls were going to be grateful but the others were a wild card right now. Especially since the little pervert had thrown around the word Villain like he had.

The first gaze he caught was Kacchan's, the red eyes taking on a thoughtful light to them before flickering toward Ashido and then back to him. The blonde teen gave him a little nod before reaching out to drag Kaminari and Kirishima back towards the table they'd been studying at.

As soon as Kacchan did so, the rest of the teens seemed to snap out of their stupor and all moved at once towards Izuku. He fought not to flinch as they crowded around him, now.

"That was so cool, man! I kinda wish I'd gotten it on video." Sero laughed, patting Izuku on the shoulder and flashing him a grin as he passed him on his way back towards Kacchan's group. Izuku managed a small smile and a nod before turning his attention back to the girls that were crowded around him.

"I can check again for cameras, if that would make you comfortable. I don't think he placed any from what I can see." More than likely the grape was planning on trying to place them and just hadn't had the chance yet.

Yaoyorozu smiled at him and waved her hand in dismissal, tension uncoiling from her shoulders now that the threat was taken care of.

"No, no, it's fine. We wouldn't want to trouble you any further."

Izuku frowned a little, a hand coming up to scratch at the back of his neck as he glanced around the circle of girls in front of him.

"I mean, it's not any trouble. It's kinda my job, you know? I'd be doing a pretty bad job of protecting you guys if I let a creep like that keep making yall feel unsafe." He said it with a little shrug, eyes flickering from girl to girl in an effort to make eye contact with all of them.

He needed them to understand him on this. He didn't have the built in trust that Aizawa did with the students but he needed them to at least trust he'd do his best.

Ashido let out a coo and reached forward to pinch his cheeks and he reigned in the instinct to slap her hands away, instead just leaning away from her as far as he could get without falling

over. It didn't do much good as she just followed, a grin on her face.

"I call dibs for the Bakusquad." She declared, grinning triumphantly and ignoring the indigent yell from Uraraka.

"Hey! No fair!"

"I called dibs! The cutie is ours!"
While the two girls good naturedly bickered, Izuku found himself being dragged towards Kacchan's group, Ashido's hands now wrapped around his arm.

"Oi, Round Face unless you're here to study shut it. I don't want to listen to these two whine if they fail again." Kacchan grunted as Izuku was pushed down into a chair at their table, Ashido sitting next to him and Uraraka hovering a little to the side.

The brown haired girl stuck her tongue out at the explosive blonde and slid into the seat next to Ashido. She flopped her arms down on the table and made a face at Kacchan when he growled at her.

"I'm just saying, Blasty! You can't exclusively call dibs on him! Let the rest of us have a shot!"

Izuku ducked his head to hide his grin at the bored look Kacchan was sending the girl, enjoying the energy of the table. He'd been worried for a hot moment that Kacchan and the gravity quirked girl wouldn't get along based on what he'd seen of the sports festival but the more he observed them, both in class and outside, it seemed they weren't actively antagonistic towards each other. Hell, some of their actions and words were almost teasing.

It was interesting to watch and compare to his mental image of Kacchan from middle school. It was amazing to see how much the blonde had grown in such a short amount of time.

He immediately wanted to take that thought back, though, when the blonde glanced over and met Izuku's eye. The smirk that quirked his lips upward only spelled trouble.

"Considering I've known the nerd since we were in diapers, I'm sure he would have ended up over here anyway." He said smugly, turning back to Uraraka.

"Kacchan!" Izuku squawked, sitting up and reaching over to smack the other teen on the arm. "Ever heard of 'need to know information'?!"

"Ha? Like you were going to be able to hide that, nerd! You can't even call me by the right name!" The blonde shot back, smirk now stretched into a full blown grin.

"Kacchan?! That's great! I'm going to call you that exclusively now!" Kaminari thumped the table with his hand, grinning as he leaned into Kacchan's space. The explosive teen growled at him and smacked him with the rolled up paper again.

"You don't get to call me shit when you can't even pass one single test, dipshit!" Kacchan growled, smacking him a few more times when Kaminari's only reaction was to laugh at him.

Izuku watched the interaction with a small, fond, smile on his face and only tore his eyes away when Ashido nudged him with her shoulder, a slow grin curling at her lips.

“Kacchan, huh?” Her tone was low enough that only Izuku could hear it and teasing enough that it brought a bright blush to his cheeks.

“Like he said! We’ve known each other since we were little! I don’t think I’ve ever called him anything else.” He hissed back, bringing up his hands to cover his face.

“Raccoon eyes! What did you say to him?! Stop trying to embarrass the nerd, he might catch himself on fire or something stupid like that.”

Chapter End Notes

So was this a filler chapter? Kind of. I mostly just wanted to get rid of Mineta and have Izuku bond with 1A! So sort of mission accomplished!

The next maybe two chapters are just going to be Izuku bonding with 1A and rebuilding Izuku and Katsuki's relationship.

Let me know what yall thought! (the more feedback I get the more I want to write so keep that in mind ;D)

This got out of hand

Chapter Summary

Things get out of hand when All Might returns to class

Chapter Notes

So this chapter and I have beef. I sat down to start writing at 7:30 and finished it at 12:28 PM. I can't stand to even look at it anymore, either.

I hate it, kinda, but it's necessary to moving the story along so I couldn't exactly skip it.

Be kind

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Everything had been going well, Izuku thought.

He'd finally found an in to bond with the class. Mina and Uraraka were never far away from him now in the dorms and the others seemed to accept him as well, including him in activities and asking for study tips. Iida was still distant and a little distrustful of him but he could deal with that.

Kacchan was very sweet in keeping some of the more intrusive of his classmates off of his back when it came to the reason he was ward of the school in the first place. Eventually Izuku knew he was going to have to come clean about everything, quirklessness included, but for now he was enjoying feeling almost normal for the first time in his life. Everything was….easy, almost.

Izuku's lessons with Nezu were more fun than anticipated and quite honestly felt like a set up for world domination with the way the principal had him analysing situations around the school. It was great practice and great fun. He was even enjoying the hacking lessons the rat was giving him. All in all they weren't traditional lessons but he couldn't help but feel Nezu had a plan regardless. It was nice, honestly, to let someone else handle the planning.

Things with Shouta and Hizashi were amazing as well! Their routine was easy to fall into at this point. Izuku would help Shouta with grading and lesson plans or even just case notes after classes ended before the other students wandered down to the common areas to start prepping dinner or separate study sessions. Shouta would ruffle his hair a little, sometimes,

before he got up to head back to the apartment and leave Izuku to whatever the class decided to do that evening.

Izuku would hang out with the class for a little while before excusing himself when he saw Hizashi sneaking into the building, making a bee line for the apartment right after the blonde hero. Hizashi and Shouta made it a point to have dinner together nightly, before Shouta had to go on patrol, and Izuku made a point to be back in the apartment in time for dinner every night.

It was...domestic and nice, honestly. Talking over dinner with the two older men about 1A's shenanigans or the different ways Shouta had tried to sneak off that day to nap. If Izuku was being one hundred percent honest, it was the best part of his day. It made him feel warm and happy in a way he couldn't remember ever being in his life.

Inko wasn't cold to him, per say, but as he got older dinner together happened less and less often. Before everything, he'd just chalked it up to her having to work so hard to support them but now? How could he? Hizashi worked three jobs and Shouta worked two but both men purposely made the time to spend a meal together.

So why couldn't his mother care enough to do the same?

He did his best not to dwell on this kinds of thoughts, focusing more on learning how to make lesson plans and putting small bits of input in on when and how to teach things they were planning. If he wanted to stay in the bubble of warmth he'd found himself in, he'd have to make himself useful.

Not that he thought they'd kick him back out on the streets or into jail if he didn't but at this point, what else could he do to repay either Shouta or Nezu for what they'd given him?

Of course, he should have known things were going far too well for far too long.

He was reminded of his shitty luck when he walked into the 1A classroom two weeks after arriving at the school and saw a familiar figure standing at the front of the classroom.

All Might

The man was in his shrunken form, having been revealed in the battle of Kamino, talking with a few students. Izuku fought to swallow down the lump in his throat that threatened to choke him. If he had to describe it, he would say it felt like ice had been injected into his veins. Sure, he knew he'd have to face the man eventually but he'd hoped he would get a little bit of notice beforehand.

Izuku could feel eyes on him and he tore his gaze away from the former number one hero to meet Katsuki's eyes, burning curiosity meeting abject panic. Just from that one glance he could tell that Katsuki didn't understand his reaction from the way his brows furrowed and his gaze bounced between the ex villain and the Symbol of Peace.

As if sensing the tension, the retired teacher glanced up from the conversation he was having with the crowd around him. His gaze felt like the weight of ten elephants settling on Izuku's

shoulders and his couldn't help but hold his breath and wait for the recognition to settle into the man's expression.

Recognition was not what settled on the man's face, however. It was so much worse.

Barely disguised distaste.

No one else except maybe Katsuki caught the look, the class distracted by the hero inadvertently calling attention to Izuku's arrival. The group dispersed from around All Might, heading towards their desks and laughing amongst themselves.

(He'd been working with Shouta so much in the past two weeks on lessons that his arrival to the room was almost as powerful as Shouta himself walking in the room to get the class to settle. If he wasn't so freaked out at the moment he'd be a little proud.)

Knees wobbling a little bit, Izuku finally moved further into the room and behind the podium. He set his bag down at the base and glanced hopefully towards the desk, hoping to see a familiar yellow sleeping bag tucked underneath.
But today was a bad luck day. Of course. No Shouta to help him.

Shouta didn't even know he needed an out from this, either.

Not for the last time had his need to keep info close to his chest had backfired on him spectacularly.

* * * * *

Katsuki watched All Might as he moved to stand in the front of the room, his smile the same as ever as he faced the class.

But Katsuki had seen the look he'd given Izuku. He'd also seen the look of absolute panic on the teen's face when he'd walked in to see the former symbol of peace standing there.

And it wasn't the panic Katsuki was expecting, either. This wasn't the fanboy 'my hero is here' reaction he'd been looking forward to.

No, this was almost abject horror.

For a moment, he let his gaze wander back towards the green haired teen and felt the confusion grow tenfold. Green eyes were glued to the podium, knuckles white as he gripped the sides of it to keep himself in place. Everything about his posture screamed that he wanted to be anywhere else but in this room.

"-s a little differently today! I thought for my first day back we could have a class discussion" Katsuki tuned back in quickly, tearing his eyes away from Izuku and back to All Might as the man grinned at the class.

"Today's discussion is going to be around villains and why we must never let our guard down when it comes to apprehending them and bringing them to justice!"

A month ago, a lecture on this topic would have drawn a little groan from the class but they would have moved on. Now? Now the entire class shifted almost as one uneasily. Almost every eye slid away from the hero and towards Izuku at the podium.

The teen's expression was blank but from his spot in the front Katsuki could see the way his hands shook as he shoved them in his pockets.

All Might, seemingly not feeling the shift in the energy of the room, continued speaking as if he wasn't intentionally targeting the teen behind him with his words and choice in topic.

"The first thing you need to remember is that Villains will say whatever they feel will get them out of trouble! Or something that will have you lowering your guard enough for them to attempt to strike you down!" Even in his deflated form, his voice was booming and commanding. All eyes were on the man again but even Katsuki could feel the uneasy rippling through the room. "Please remember that you can't trust anything a villain says to you for this reason. All they care about is destruction and chaos at the end of the day."

He could see his classmates shifting their focus every few seconds from what the man was saying to what Izuku's reaction would be. It had only been a week or so of actually befriending the teen but the class was already fairly fond of him.

Katsuki turned his head a little to try and catch a glance of Racoon Eyes. Her face was twisted into a scowl and her hands were fisted against the top of her desk. If he had to hazard a guess, Round Face was probably doing something very similar but he couldn't turn to check without drawing more attention to himself.

"Not to correct you, All Might, but that isn't entirely true."

Izuku's voice held a small tremor but the steel that had entered his posture. His hands still shook a little as All Might turned to face him.

"Young Midoriya, you are not welcome to participate. I'm sure everyone would prefer it if you returned to your quarters at once. This class is no place for you."

Katsuki was halfway out of his seat when Izuku's eyes cut his way, a warning clear enough in his gaze. The blonde wordlessly growled, hands flexing as he sank back into his seat. Rage, hot and burning, surged through his chest and he had to fight the urge to just explode the thing causing it.

Especially when the man turned his back to Izuku once more, a clear dismissal, and smiled back out at the class.

"My name is Izuku, please, and I have the authorization from both Principal Nezu and Aizawa to be here. This is as much my class as it is yours." The teen's voice brokered no argument as he stepped out from behind the podium and forced himself into the pro hero's line of sight once more. "And you are currently not setting realistic expectations for them in the slightest."

The teen angled his body so he was facing the class without turning his back on the hero, a smart move considering the thunderous look on the man's face.

"Not every villain you're going to face is going to be a megalomaniac hell bent on ruling or destroying the world. Especially not as fresh graduates." The teen's hand came up in a shushing motion when All Might opened his mouth to speak again. Katsuki could almost see the steam pouring out of the man's ears to match the red color that was taking over his neck and face. "The most common type of villain you're going to encounter is going to be one committing petty theft. Or a purse snatching. Especially for those of you who are going into Limelight heroics. These 'villains' are just going to be people trying to survive."

As interesting as the points being made were, none of the class could focus on that. Instead every eye in the room was on All Might and the way his hands clenched and unclenched at his sides and the uncharacteristic scowl on his face.

Katsuki wasn't the only one who could see the tension in Izuku. It practically rolled off of him in waves and he was vividly reminded of that night in the bar. The teen's fingers were hidden in his sleeves once more but he could almost picture him brandishing a knife at the man in his mind's eye.

A part of him wondered if he should be worried about how not worried that image made him. A part of him almost wished Izuku had his weapons to defend himself with right now.

"Young Midoriya-"

"Izuku"

"Leave this instant. You have no business around the students or pretending to be an equal or above them. Nezu has clearly lost his mind letting someone as dangerous as you roam the school as he pleases but I will not stand for it." Steam poured off of the man as he barely restrained himself from welling up into his muscled form.

"Dangerous? Please!" Mina spoke up then, standing up from her desk and slamming her hands down to get the man's attention. "Izuku has done nothing but help since he got here! He listened to us when Mineta was giving us problems and actually did something!"

There was a murmur of agreement from the girls in the class and somehow that seemed to anger the Symbol of Peace even further. Katsuki rose from his seat as well, tension building in his arms as he flexed his hands and let off little pops with his quirk. His eyes were glued to Izuku, though, and the way his eyes darted around the classroom.

"Miss Ashido, Young Bakugo, sit back down. Obviously he has pulled the wool over your eyes which proves the need for this lesson! He is an admitted associate of All For One and cannot be trusted!"

Distantly, Katsuki registered the way Izuku jerked like he'd been slapped and took an instinctive step away from All Might. Something in him snapped and Katsuki stepped

forward and grabbed the other teen by the elbow and pulled him until he was behind him. Standing between All Might and Izuku, Katsuki bared his teeth at the retired hero.

“Are you going to accuse me of the same thing just because I was in that bar that night, too?! Huh?!” He snarled out, hand not pushing Izuku behind him popping dangerously with sparks.

“That is enough! This is unbecoming of everyone involved!” Iida’s voice rang out above the growing murmurs of the class, the Class Rep now standing from his desk as well and chopping the air with his hand. “Nezu has vouched for Izuku and trusts him. There is no reason for us not to do the same.”

Izuku abruptly stopped fighting against Katsuki, turning to face Iida instead with a shocked expression. Iida had been one of the ones hanging back, as of late, and watching everyone else interact with the teen.

“Iida….thank you…” Izuku’s voice was trembling a little and Katsuki didn’t need to turn around to know there were tears threatening to spill.

“Enough of this! I am in charge of this class and he is leaving, immediately.” All Might’s voice boomed, the man himself seemingly losing what little composure he had left.

“You know, when people have to yell that they’re in charge that usually means they have no control over anything.” Shinsou drawled somewhere behind Katsuki, earning a few snickers from the class.

“I am bringing Aizawa here now to end this nonsense and cancel whatever quirk this villain is using to trick all of you into defending him!” All Might finally snapped, a frightening glare settling on his face.

Katsuki felt the way Izuku tensed up behind him, could feel the tiny tremors that wracked the teen’s body and instinctively knew he was going to do something impulsive. Something he was going to regret later.

He didn’t get the chance to turn or even attempt to stop the other teen, though, because Izuku silenced the entire classroom with a single sentence.

“I mean, sure, do that but it won’t do much good since I’m quirkless.”

Chapter End Notes

See? A mess. I hope yall at least enjoyed the mess lol

We'll be here for you

Chapter Summary

Still Dealing with All Might

Chapter Notes

I am honestly blown away by how much yall enjoyed that last chapter! So I had to complete the scene and give yall a quick and speedy answer to that cliffhanger.

I hope yall enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“I mean, sure, do that but it won’t do much good since I’m quirkless.”

Izuku wasn’t sure what possessed him to use that particular fact to sass the former number one hero but the moment the words were out of his mouth he regretted them. The murmurs that had been building during the entire confrontation died completely at his words.

Tears that had threatened to spill when Iida of all people stood up for him built up again, burning at the back of his eyes. He couldn’t cry right now! Not in front of All Might and surely not in front of the class. He couldn’t be weak.

They probably hated him now anyway, though. No one ever treated him the same after finding out. It was going to suck so much worse this time, though. Everyone was going to side with All Might now because obviously he was a problem. .

He’d just hoped he’d have more time to be their friend before he was forced to tell them how broken he was.

His vision was darkening at the edges as his panic set in, breath stuttering in his effort not to break down.

The hand on his elbow loosened and gently slid down his arm to tangle their fingers together. The small squeeze the other teen gave his hand pulled him out of his panic a little, green eyes wide as they met the stormy red of Katsuki’s.

Kacchan’s expression was worried, obviously not liking whatever he saw in Izuku’s own expression. He wanted to apologize. He wanted to run away. He wanted to not be in this situation.

Before he could open his mouth and put his foot back into it, Katsuki's gaze snapped away from him to scan the crowd of students once more. Something in his gaze relaxed at what he found and even though it made Izuku curious, he couldn't bring himself to look himself. It would break him to see any ounce of rejection on his new friends faces.

"Anyone got a problem with the nerd because he lacks a stupid damn quirk? If so, you go through me." The words were growled out, Katsuki's grip on his hand tightening for a second before becoming gentle again.

"Young Midoriya.."

All Might's voice drew Izuku's gaze to him again and what he saw there had his stomach dropping all over again. The recognition that the teen had been dreading in the beginning was now there and it just made the panic lingering at the edges of his senses that much worse.

"How many times does he have to tell you his name is Izuku." A hand came to rest on his shoulder as Shinsou spoke, giving a small comforting squeeze even while the purple haired teen glared at All Might. "You should choose your next words carefully, too, since you're coming dangerously close to sounding quirkist. For a second there, it sounded like you were accusing him of brainwashing us."

All Might's face drained of color and he cleared his throat awkwardly, seemingly trying to find a way to control the situation again. The class started to rise from their seats, a few more hands coming from all around Izuku to ruffle his hair or pat his back or shoulders as the students tried their best to comfort the teen. They didn't seem to have words yet, still processing the ongoing mess that this lesson had turned out to be, but the silent support brought tears back to Izuku's eyes.

"Be that as it may, a villain has no place among hero students. No matter what you've tricked these children into thinking." All Might's face settled back into the grim frown he'd been wearing before, drawing himself up to his full height. "And if you are quirkless, as you claim to be, then that's even more reason to find somewhere more suitable for you. Think of how they would feel if they were to injure you severely because you cannot protect yourself."

Three years ago, Izuku might have flinched at his words. He might have taken them to heart and shrunk into himself and made an excuse to step away from the comforting hands and people surrounding him. Three years ago, he didn't know that he could be strong.

But in the past three years he'd survived against people with quirks. He'd outsmarted more of them than he'd overpowered, yes, but he could hold his own against someone like Shigaraki and had earned himself the position he was in. Just because one muscle bound idiot couldn't deal with it didn't mean he hadn't done everything he'd done to get himself to where he was standing right this moment.

Hadn't he already let this man's opinion of him hurt him for long enough?

He had the support of the people that mattered.

Finally gathering the courage, he turned his head to look at everyone that had gathered around him. Shinsou was on his right, hand slipping off of his shoulder to take his hand as well and giving it a gentle squeeze. Izuku flashed him a small smile. Beyond Shinsou he could see Kaminari and Kirishima glaring at All Might fiercely, Jirou and Mina with hands on their arms to keep them from storming forward.

Turning a little more, Iida and Uraraka were behind him with Sero standing near Kacchan's other side. If Izuku had to guess, the black haired teen was going to hold the explosive blonde back if he made a leap for All Might. He'd have to thank him for that, later.

The rest of the class was gathered around them, all either glaring at All Might or watching the interaction uneasily. Yaoyorozu was wringing her hands nervously, eyes dancing back and forth between All Might and the classroom door like she wanted to run for an authority figure. Next to her, Todoroki was as blank faced as usual but Izuku could see the tense lines of his shoulders and the way he'd angled himself to better be able to ice someone over if things went wrong.

Izuku made a mental note to put more effort into befriending the youngest Todoroki before turning back to face All Might.

The youngest Todoroki hardened his resolve as well. Dabi hadn't put all the work and time and attention into helping him survive just for him to roll over and give up now. Even if he and the burned man weren't on speaking terms, Izuku had to at least honor the man's want for him to spit in the world's eye and keep moving when it told him what he could or couldn't do.

"With all due respect, sir, that's not for you to decide." He said finally, squeezing Katsuki and Shinsou's hands back and squaring his shoulders. "As you've been told no less than three times in the past few minutes, Nezu put me in this position and only he can dismiss me from it. I'm here to help everyone in this room survive in the mess you've created oh mighty Symbol of Peace."

Izuku met the man's gaze evenly, chin tilted up defiantly as he stepped forward and dropped the hands he was holding. He could feel the entire class shift behind him, closing ranks and very firmly showing the man where they stood in this matter.

"You don't get to come in here and lecture me or them on how to do the job. The world they are going to be heroes in is going to be so unlike the one you worked in because of you and not in a good way. They need as much help as possible to be ready for the danger they're going to be stepping into." Izuku's resolve continued to solidify as he spoke, his tone turning to steel and his spin filling with it as well. "You can continue to call me a Villain if you want but at the end of the day I'm going to be the one giving them a realistic idea of what to expect out there, not you. So I suggest you think very carefully about your next words."

His chest heaved a little as silence settled over the classroom, both of them glaring at each other. Vaguely he heard Shinsou whistle lowly behind him and could have almost heard Kacchan growl something about dibs. He couldn't be sure about that last part, though, because the moment his brain tried to process it another voice spoke up from the door of the classroom.

“Very well said!”

The squeaky voice of the Principal broke the tension into a million pieces as every eye turned to the doorway with varying degrees of relief. The rat stood on Hizashi’s shoulders, grinning brightly at his student before his gaze turned to the former number one hero.

“All Might, I believe you and I need to have a quick chat. Yamada will take over this class for today.” The tone the principal used brokered no discussion. All Might slumped and shot Izuku one last lingering look before he turned and headed towards the door.

Nezu transferred from Hizashi’s shoulder to All Might’s, paw coming up to grip at his hair in a way that Izuku vaguely noted was probably not comfortable. Now that the confrontation was over, though, he didn’t have much brain power left. The energy he’d found there at the end drained out of him and he slumped a little, one hand coming up to rub over his face and then to tug at his hair. All of this had gotten so out of hand so quickly. It felt like everything had changed in the blink of an eye.

He was broken out of his hazy thoughts as Hizashi stepped further into the classroom, coming to stand in front of him and gently pull his hand out of his hair. The blonde hero replaced it with his own, petting the teen’s hair gently and pulling him closer to him. Izuku wanted desperately to grab hold of his leather jacket and not let go but…

Turning his head, he could see the strange looks the class was giving them. Sure, it would be normal for Shouta to act this way, kind of. Everyone in class kind of knew that they were close but they’d never seen him interact with Hizashi. It would be weird and it wasn’t something he could explain without outing him and Shouta.

He wouldn’t be the one to cause the men who’d given him something he hadn’t realized he craved trouble.

Even though it pained him, he pulled away a little and flashed Hizashi a small smile to show he was okay.

Later he would break down. Later. In the safety of the apartment where he couldn’t put their secret in jeopardy.

Hizashi seemed to understand immediately but surprised Izuku by rolling his eyes and pulling the teen in again and wrapping an arm around his shoulders.

“Oh little listener, it’s okay. We already figured Shouta’s hell class was going to find out, one way or the other.” Hizashi’s voice was low enough for only Izuku to hear but the message was somewhat clear to everyone else as Izuku sagged against the voice hero, tears finally falling from his eyes as he buried his face in the man’s chest.

“I knew it!” Kaminari crowed, smacking Kirishima and doing some sort of little victory dance. “I told you him and Aizawa were dating!”

Kirishima groaned loudly and pushed the electric blond away from him before digging in his pockets.

“Fine, fine! I don’t have the money on me, you’re gonna have to wait till we get back to the dorms, bro.”

As the red head grumbled, the rest of the class shook off the tense energy of before and surged forward to surround the voice hero and Izuku. Sniffling, Izuku pulled away a little to aim a watery smile up at the man who just laughed and ruffled his hair gently.

“What even happened, little listeners? It looked mighty tense in here when we walked in.” Hizashi glanced around at the assembled students, taking in the way their faces fell at the mention of the encounter.

“Ass Might is a quirkist bastard is what happened!” Shinsou’s voice was angry and his face was pinched. Katsuki was staring at him with an unreadable expression before turning back towards Izuku, once again reaching out to take his hand.

Izuku didn’t shake him off, instead offering him a watery smile. He didn’t have the energy to try and figure out the other’s emotions right now but the contact was nice and settled him in a way he couldn’t and didn’t have the heart to quantify right now.

“He kept calling Izuku a villain and saying he didn’t belong here!” Kirishima piped up next, arms crossed over his chest. “It was so unmanly! He even tried to say he couldn’t be here because he didn’t have a quirk.”

Hizashi’s eyes roved over the entire class, taking in the angry and unsettled expressions of each student before sighing and glancing back down at Izuku. He didn’t seem upset with him, at least, so Izuku was going to try his best not to overthink the expression on the man’s face.

If he was honest with himself, he just really wanted to curl up in the dorms and recharge. There was too much to pick apart right now and his mind was too exhausted to try and figure out where to go from here.

“Alright, I don’t think we’re going to get much done after all of that drama. I’m going to text Aizawa and let him know we’re going back to the dorms early. You guys pack up and head back that way now and Izuku and I will follow in a few minutes.”

The class all nodded and moved back towards their desks. Katsuki seemed torn but a small smile and a squeeze of his hand seemed to convince him that Izuku would be okay. The blonde reluctantly let go of him and moved away, packing up and leaving with only a backward glance with the rest of the class.

Everyone made a point to either pat Izuku on the shoulder or back as they passed or ruffle his hair. It was...nice.

He was too tired to think further on it, though, leaning against Hizashi as the last of the students filed out of the room. The man didn’t rush him, instead humming a song to himself as he gently pet Izuku’s hair while the teen pulled himself together.

“They’re going to have questions.” He mumbled after a few minutes, rubbing at his face and slumping further against the blonde. His sort of father figure just hummed an affirmative and nudged him to stand on his own.

“They will. But Shouta and I will be there with you to help keep them in line and it won’t be until you’ve at least had a nap, little man.”

Izuku nodded at his words, not protesting as the adult herded him out of the classroom and in the direction of the dorms.

That was a problem for future Izuku.

Chapter End Notes

So a kind of cliff hanger? Next up the class has some questions and Izuku really doesn't want to answer but they deserve some context.

I hope yall enjoyed this bonus chapter! Don't forget to come hang out with me on TikTok @EmbeddedFiction!
(Also I might make a discord if yall want one? Let me know)

Sweet Child O' Mine

Chapter Summary

Feelings are had.

Chapter Notes

So, this chapter was supposed to just be the conversation with the class but as always the characters had a different idea.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Everyone returned to the dorms and collectively decided to set up camp in the common room. As promised, Izuku and Present Mic returned but the blonde man waved them away when everyone rose to greet them.

One look at Izuku and everyone understood, his eyes were red rimmed and he looked like he was about to drop. Present Mic was practically holding up the teenager. Everyone hovered nervously as the man shot them a small smile and guided the exhausted teen away from them and down the hall towards Aizawa's apartment, well their apartment.

They all settled once more, spreading out homework and other things around the tables and couches as they settled in to wait.

It didn't take long, though, for them to get restless. Katsuki could feel their eyes on him and it was wearing on his nerves with every minute that ticked by. His leg began to bounce under the table he was sitting at and his grip grew tighter on the pencil in his hand.

When the chair in front of him slid out and a body dropped into it he barely resisted the urge to snap the object in his hand. It was an accomplishment that he'd brag about to his therapist in their next session. Especially when he raised his gaze to find Shinsou sitting across from him, a smirk tugging at his lips.

Normally, he didn't mind the purple troll doll. He was nowhere near as annoying as some of the extras in 1B and miles above the dumbass he'd replaced after the Sports Festival. Right now, though? Now he kind of wanted to set an explosion off in his face to get rid of that damn smirk.

"So. Care to explain what exactly that was all about?"

Katsuki could feel every eye in the room turn to them. He could feel the irritation in himself rising and forced it down once more. What they'd just seen was disturbing and he couldn't blame them for wanting answers.

He just didn't know if he was the right one to give them those answers.

"Ever heard of the old saying 'Never meet your Heroes'? Guess we learned the hard way that they never live up to expectations." Katsuki grumbled, dropping his gaze back down to the homework in front of him.

Shinsou leaned against the table, leaning into Katsuki's space. The damned smirk fell off his face and was replaced with a more serious expression.

"Bakugo, we both know that's not what I was talking about." When the blonde looked up to meet his gaze again, the other teen's expression was searching. Katsuki couldn't fault him for trying to understand what the hell had happened in that classroom. He himself was trying to wrap his head around it with the limited pieces of the puzzle he held.
"You know he was a Villain, right? Nothing murder level or anything but enough that he and Crusty the Assclown are hostile on sight." Katsuki didn't lower his voice, knowing damn well that the rest of the class was listening in on the conversation. "When they kidnapped me he bust into the bar and threw a fucking knife at Shigaraki's face."

The look of awe on Troll Doll's face made Katsuki want to throw something but instead he just drummed his fingers against the table unhappily.

"Get that stupid look off your face, troll." He grumbled, glaring with all the energy he could muster at the moment. Instead of the desired effect of making the idiot stop it just made his lips quirk up in that stupid fucking smirk.

"Oh? Am I not allowed to find him attractive? Because from where I sit he looks pretty unattached."

Katsuki's lips pulled up in a snarl and he was halfway out of his seat when a hand came to rest on his shoulder and Kirishima's voice registered through the haze of anger.

"Dude, not cool. The last thing Izubro is worrying about right now is dating, I think."

Shinsou lifted his hands in surrender but the smirk only grew when Katsuki growled at him as he dropped back into his chair heavily.

"How did he get from the bar all the way out to that warehouse, though?" Uraraka settled into a chair on the other side of Katsuki, brows furrowed. "It wasn't exactly close enough that he could have gotten there so quickly…"

"All for One, the Villain that Ass Might fought, apparently wanted to 'talk' to Izuku and made the warp villain bring him over to him. I'm guessing that's why he was all bent out of shape about Izuku being on campus." Katsuki slumped in his chair a little, fingers tapping against his leg the only other sign he was agitated.

The other students were gathered around their table now, leaning against the other nearby tables or just milling around listening to the conversation.

“That’s not exactly fair to Izuku. That guy leveled part of a city, who knows what he’d do if someone told him no.” Sero mumbled from the other side of Katsuki.

There were murmured agreements from the other teens and Katsuki found his gaze jumping from person to person, searching. As much as he didn’t want to broach the subject, he had to. There was no way he was going to let Izuku walk into this room and be met with the same kind of bullshit that caused him to disappear in the first place.

Slowly, Katsuki stood up and met each of their eyes. Several of his classmates looked confused and others looked wary. While he wasn’t as volatile and angry as he had been in the past, the class was still used to him exploding verbally instead of the quiet intensity he was exuding right this moment.

“Listen up, fuckers, I’m only going to say this once. If any of you have a problem with Izuku or are going to be quirkist fucks, you either keep it to yourself or deal with me.” His tone brokered no arguments, gaze serious and sharp as it roved around the gathered students.

Several voices sounded at once, many indignant and a couple of them annoyingly cooing at him.

“Like we’d have an issue with sunshine boy.” Katsuki met Jirou’s gaze and her unimpressed eye roll drew a small snort from him.

“Besides, you said he threw a knife at Shigaraki’s face. I don’t know about anyone else but I’m not gonna be the one to suggest he’s anything but a badass.” Kaminari grinned as he said it, drawing a laugh from a few of the others.

Katsuki relaxed a little, shoving his hands in his pockets and letting his posture slump again.

“Good. He doesn’t need more people being assholes.” He grumbled, not meeting their eyes because he could see the teasing smiles popping up on his friends and classmates faces. There was no way he was dealing with this much emotion. Fuck that.

“Aww, he’s so soft for the sunshine boy.” Mina cooed, reaching out to poke him playfully. Growling, he slapped her hands away and dropped back down into his chair.

“Shut up. NO one is to mention this conversation ever again. Go back to studying or whatever.”

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Several hours later found Izuku bundled up in blankets curled up between Shouta and Hizashi on the sofa, his head on Shouta’s lap as they watched some pre-quirk superhero movie. Izuku had napped for a little while but the anxiety of the entire situation was quick to descend on him once he was fully awake.

Honestly, the impromptu cuddle pile was the only thing keeping Shouta from finding the former number one hero and ripping him a new one. Nezu had already given him a brief rundown of what had happened before he'd left the school and he'd hurried back to the apartment when Hizashi had told him he'd dismissed class for the day.

Izuku glanced up at him through his hair before sighing and pushing himself up to sit properly between the two adults. As much as he'd like to rest for longer, the anxiety just built worse and worse with each passing minute.

Both adults turned their attention to him and he flashed them a small smile.

"They have questions." He said simply, shrugging the blankets off of himself and pushing himself to his feet. Shouta's eyes followed him critically, no doubt taking in the bags forming under his eyes and the way his fingers tugged and pulled at the sleeves of his hoodie.

They hadn't given him his knives back yet and he honestly longed for the weight of them between his fingers. He didn't know when they'd become a comfort item but he missed them dearly now that he didn't have access to them.

"Answers they don't absolutely need. Don't push yourself if you don't need to." Shouta rumbled, reaching out to snag Izuku's wrist and attempting to pull him back down onto the sofa.

Izuku resisted, planting his feet and shooting the man a small smile. It was nice to be fussed over, honestly. Especially after the day he'd had.

But he wasn't going to be able to relax until he dealt with this. If he didn't face them now, he'd have to deal with the anxiety of not knowing their reactions all night. And that was not even a little bit restful.

"The longer I put it off the worse it's gonna be." He laughed softly at the grumpy look on Shouta's face. "You know they won't let me rest until I give them some kind of answers. Better to get it over with now, before they can think of more."

Hizashi huffed out a laugh and extracted himself from his own blankets, reaching out to Shouta with a grin. The black haired man rolled his eyes and huffed before taking his husband's hand and letting him pull him up from the sofa as well.

Izuku took a moment to just watch them, already seeing the massive reaction the class was going to have at seeing both of them in their comfy clothes. Hizashi's hair was down and free, all of the gel he'd used that day washed out, while Shouta's was pulled up and away from his face.

He'd only been with the couple for two weeks but already he knew he'd do anything to protect their little bubble. And yet, here they were, ready to reveal the full extent of their relationship to the class just so they could support him. He couldn't fathom why they bothered with him. Why they were so good and kind to him.

Before he realized it, hot tears were washing down his face again and he hurried to cover his face before either man noticed. Unfortunately, the motion itself brought their attention back to him and Hizashi let out a small, distressed, noise as he stepped back towards Izuku.

“Oh no, Izu! What’s wrong? We don’t have to do this, like Sho said!”

Izuku shook his head quickly, breath hitching again as Shouta stepped up next to his husband and gripped the teen’s shoulder gently.

“No! No!” He hiccuped out, shaking his head quickly. “I just...sorry! Both of you are so amazing! I’m sorry I’m ruining everything.”

Understanding flashed over Shouta’s face and he gently pulled Izuku to his chest, wrapping his arm around him and even more gently carding his fingers through his curls. Hizashi flashed him a concerned look over the kids head but Izuku couldn’t see it, face buried in the man’s chest as he tried to stem the flow of tears pouring from his eyes.

“You’re not ruining anything, kid.” The man rumbled, rocking a little with the teen. “We’re doing this because we care about you. Sure, it’s gonna be annoying to have to deal with Kaminari’s remarks and Ashido’s gossip mongering ways but we already knew this was going to become common knowledge at some point.”

“And if it’s because we’re supporting our favorite kid in the world, then that’s even better.” Hizashi’s voice drew Izuku’s face away from Shouta’s chest, green eyes flooding with tears again as he reached out to drag the blonde man into the hug as well.

“We’re not supposed to have favorites, ‘Zashi!”

“I”m sorry, my kid is always going to be my favorite!”

Between the two of them, Izuku froze up as the words processed. He couldn’t have said what he thought he said. No way. Because there was no way either of these amazing heroes thought of him like that.

Silence settled over them and the men shared a concerned look again, unsure of how to react to the slip up.

“Kid? Talk to us.” Shouta said softly, pulling back a little to try and get a look at the teen’s face.

“....you don’t have to….I’m not….it’s sweet but you don’t have to lie to me.” Izuku mumbled, not meeting either of their gazes and slowly pulling away now that Shouta was no longer boxing him in between the two of them.

The teen flinched when two hands came up to cup his face, the touch light but strong enough to force him to meet the man’s eyes. Hizashi had tears building in his eyes and when Izuku glanced away from him, unable to look at it, he was almost horrified to see the sad look on Shouta’s face.

What had he said? Did he hurt their feelings by calling them on the lie? He hadn't meant to do that. He'd just wanted to make sure they knew he didn't need to be coddled. He understood.

No one wanted a quirkless, villain, kid. He got it.

It was such a nice thought, though.

"Kid. Izuku. No, I wasn't just saying that." Hizashi drew Izuku's attention back to him, eyes so sincere that Izuku couldn't force himself to interrupt the man again. Honestly, it felt like his brain stopped working as he waited for the man to continue speaking.

"Yes, we've only known you for a little while but both of us would fight All Might for you if you wanted us to." The statement drew a watery giggle from the teenager, bordering on hysterical. "So yeah, you're our kid."

"We'd adopt you legally but since you're a problem child, that's a little impossible at the moment." Shouta's voice was dry as he stepped in again to settle his hand back into the teen's curls. "But don't you dare think we're just doing something to be nice or out of some obligation. We don't do anything we don't want to."

Izuku couldn't answer, curling into himself and trying not to let the floodgates open back up completely. If he was asked to describe how he was feeling, he wouldn't have been able to. Joy welled up in his chest, making him warm and floaty like Uraraka had used her quirk on him. The anxiety was still clawing at the back of his mind, though.

Both men waited, though, for him to compose himself a little more. Shouta pet his hair lightly and Hizashi hummed a quiet tune, hand rubbing gently along Izuku's shoulders. Their presence helped ease the anxiety a little, letting it fade to the background so he could enjoy the moment.

"Maybe we let Midoriya Izuku stay dead and see if Nezu will help me hack into some really illegal places to make a new identity?" He asked hopefully, grinning a little when Shouta groaned and pushed his head down.

"I knew letting you near Nezu was a bad idea! I knew it the moment he offered his little devil paw to you!" The underground hero threw his hands up in the air causing his husband to snort out a laugh. "Chaos. Both of them!"

Izuku couldn't help but laugh, leaning into Hizashi and watching Shouta as he lamented the corruption of his child by The Rat.

"Come on, then, Problem Child. When I went through the common room earlier they all looked like they were sitting on live wires."

Shouta turned at those words and held the front door of the apartment open, looking put out about the whole situation. Chuckling, Hizashi lead Izuku out of the door. The teen ducked his head when Shouta ruffled his hair again before falling in step with them.

As they rounded the corner into the common room, Izuku couldn’t help the smile on his face. Shouta and Hizashi stood on either side of him, shoulders brushing, as every eye in the common room swung around to them.

“Hi guys. You probably have some questions for me.”

Chapter End Notes

Shouta and Hizashi just had to have the emotional family stuff this chapter instead of letting me have the conversation I wanted them to have. Rude.

Anyway, this chapter took forever but ultimately I'm kinda proud of it in a weird way. I hope yall enjoyed!

(Remember, the more you comment and feed my need for dopamine the faster I write C:)

A look into the past

Chapter Summary

Some Q&A and a question

Chapter Notes

Will I ever be able to write more than two scenes per chapter? Only time will tell lol But no, seriously! I meant for this one to be quite a bit longer than this but between being sick and working all day today this was all I could do and I didn't want to delay the chapter any longer! So here you go!

I hope you enjoy! Big things coming on the horizons! I have plans <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It took a few minutes for everyone to pile into the common area comfortably, everyone either sitting on the floor in the middle of the couches or on the couches themselves.

Izuku himself sat on a couch, Hizashi and Shouta on either side of him. Katsuki had decided to act even more like a guard dog and sat on the floor in front of him, shoulder pressed against his leg. Izuku pointedly ignored the kissy faces and smug looks from the class at that and instead shot Katsuki a bright smile.

Once everyone was settled, Izuku looked out over all of the faces eagerly watching and not for the first time wondered if he'd bitten off more than he could chew.

Taking a deep breath, he leaned against Hizashi for a moment and tried to think calm thoughts. He'd had an idea of how to tackle this but now with everyone looking to him for direction it was more than a little intimidating. Which was mind boggling because he'd faced off against all kinds of things in the past three years and survived.

Yet 19 teenagers were going to be what scared him the most. Make it make sense.

"Who wants to go first?"

The words were barely out of his mouth when Iida's hand shot in the air, the teen almost rising from his seat in his eagerness. Izuku was not surprised, had even counted on this. He had a good feeling of what the uptight teen was going to ask, as well, and steeled himself for the inevitable as he pointed to him.

“Forgive me for prying, Izuku, but I feel the need to ask this so I will try and be as tactful as possible.” The class president rose from his seat carefully as he spoke, adjusting his glasses nervously. “How did all of this start? I’m finding myself unable to see how someone like yourself could end up with such a high villain ranking.”

Izuku relaxed a little, secretly relieved that the teen had phrased the question as tactfully as he had. A part of him expected an outburst like the first day of class.

It still didn’t make answering the question any easier but that was a whole other matter. Especially when he could feel Kacchan tensing up as he waited for Izuku to drop the hammer, so to speak.

It was a good thing Izuku had already forgiven the blonde’s teen actions otherwise this would get really ugly really quickly.

“Well, it all started when I was four years old and diagnosed quirkless…” He laughed a little, leaning forward a little and daring to run his fingers over the hair on the back of Katsuki’s neck, hoping he would understand that he could relax. There were scattered laughs from the class and Izuku flashed them a small smile. “Really, though, it did kind of start there. No one is exactly welcoming of Quirkless kids these days. We’re not common in this generation and we’re sort of seen as inferior and useless.”

The somber nature of the topic settled in over the class and Izuku could feel the tension in Katsuki’s shoulders and neck rising, either in worry about what he was about to say or upset at the topic at hand. Izuku couldn’t tell but he could also feel the hand Shouta placed on his back to steady him, the underground hero having some idea of where this was going. Izuku could do this. He could tell this version of the story.

“So yeah, not really a pleasant way to grow up, you know? I was mostly okay until one day in the beginning of my second year of middle school. On my way home a villain tried to use me as a shield against a hero that was chasing them…” Izuku paused to gather his thoughts, making sure the way he bit his lip and twisted his fingers into the back Katsuki’s shirt made it seem like he was just unhappy reliving the memory and not just thinking over the way to word his next statement.

He had a plan, and this next part was going to be crucial to it.

“When the villain was contained, I took the opportunity to ask that hero if someone like me, quirkless, could still be a hero. They didn’t exactly sugar coat what they thought of that.” He gave the class a sad smile, not really having to fake this part. Just remembering the man’s words that day made him want to curl up in a ball and cry all over again. He didn’t think he’d ever be able to shake the intense reaction to the words ‘be realistic’. “He couldn’t have known, of course, that I wasn’t exactly mentally sound at the moment but he left me alone and I kind of spiralled.”

The hand on his back gripped at the back of his hoodie and Izuku couldn’t help but peek up at Shouta out of the corner of his eye, taking in the absolute rage shining in his dark eyes. That was...surprising. He looked away quickly and cleared his throat, shifting a little so he could pet Katsuki’s hair a little more to calm himself.

It was a testament to how upset the rest of the class was that no one made a comment on it, all of them silent and staring at him with troubled looks. He hadn't really thought they'd be this upset by his words. Even Katsuki was just letting him do as he pleased with his hair as he talked.

Maybe...this hadn't been the best plan of action?

"Uh, sorry, I got off topic a little. Um. Long story much shorter, I attempted to hurt myself that night and someone stopped me. Someone..uhhh. with..a..less than healthy disregard for the law? That works. He patched me up and gave me a place to stay when I decided I didn't want to go home."

There was no way he was name dropping Dabi in this room right this moment. Not when he could feel Shouta and Hizashi's eyes on him and the tension in Katsuki in front of him. "Things kind of spiralled from there? I mostly traded information in the underground and sometimes did favors for people. My 'villain' rank is mostly because I know too much about too many people."

He tried desperately not to stare directly at Shouto when he said this but his gaze drifted that way anyway. The duel quirked teenager's face was as blank as it ever was but he thought for a moment he saw a flash of recognition there.

Maybe it was wishful thinking?

The silence that fell over the room was stifling, as the other teenagers let this new view of him sink in. He couldn't help but bounce his leg nervously. They didn't seem to be reacting to the quirkless thing badly but he couldn't help but worry that the coddling was going to start soon. Inevitably, if people didn't leave him they started to treat him like he couldn't be trusted to care for himself.

Uraraka's voice pulled him from his thoughts, his gaze snapping to her face and taking in the sad look on her face. His stomach sank a little at the expression. While he needed to drop these breadcrumbs he hadn't wanted any of them to be this affected by even part of that story.

"You wanted to be a hero?" The question she voiced brought a sad smile back to his face.

"More than anything. It was all I talked about, honestly. I'd go find villain fights to watch and analyze so I could learn as much as I could about different fighting styles and strategies." He could feel Katsuki's snort more than he heard it and the smile morphed into a shyer smile as the blonde teen tipped his head back so Izuku could see him roll his eyes at him. "I even got scolded by local heroes because I may have ran onto a scene once to try and help since none of their quirks were suited to what was going on."

Katsuki tensed again at the reminder of his encounter with the sludge villain but Izuku breezed past it, fingers smoothing through the other teen's hair again in an attempt to soothe the memory away. The rest of the class didn't notice the interaction, instead laughing a little and relaxing at what they assumed was a minor infraction.

Izuku wasn't going to force Katsuki to relive that incident again so he let the atmosphere ease again and tried not to look at either of his new parental units whose eyes were boring into him. He could guess what was on their minds and what their suspicions were but he wasn't going to have those discussions in front of the rest of the class.

"So, when are you joining the hero course, then?" It was Shinsou who spoke up this time, a challenging light in his eye as he stared Izuku down. All eyes immediately settled on Izuku again, eager for his answer.

Several people around the room, the members of the Bakusquad if Izuku had to guess, whooped at the idea of it and Izuku had to force himself not to wince. That was honestly not something he thought the class would ask him.

"That's...not exactly in my plans…" He said shifting nervously and pointedly not meeting anyone's eye.

"What? Why not?! You'd make such a kickass hero! Bakugou said you threw a knife at Shigaraki's face!!" Kaminari was the loudest voice Izuku heard and his entire face felt like it was on fire as his gaze snapped down to Katsuki. The blonde just smirked at him.

Several other voices sounded in with their agreements and the green haired teen had to actively work to keep tears at bay. Never in a million years had he thought any of them would be encouraging about this. None of them were laughing at him. None of them were telling him to be realistic.

"Guys! I thank you for thinking so highly of me but..it's just not..something I can realistically do." As soon as the words were out of his mouth he had to hold up both of his hands to call for quiet because of the explosion of sound that took place. He had to raise his voice, even then, to be heard over the other teenagers protesting. "For one, a hero license is a license to use your quirk to do hero work. That's not something I qualify for."

There were still grumbles from around the room and Izuku couldn't stop the smile that bloomed on his face. Yes, they were idealistic and naive but it was nice that even in such a short time of knowing him they were fully in his corner. If he had any doubts before, they were banished now.

"Which yes, I could fight the commission and probably win but I don't have that much fight left in me." His tone grew somber once more as his gaze traveled over the group. "I'm more than happy to do my job here. All of you are going to be amazing heroes and take the hero industry by storm. That's my focus right now."

Looking around the room, he could see a few like Aoyama and Kirishima tearing up and the rest were staring at him with wide eyes and open mouths. Next to him, Hizashi was sniffling a little and Izuku knew if he looked over the man would be fighting back tears. Which was the exact reason Izuku wasn't looking back at him.

He didn't need a full blown crying session right now. That would come later, he was sure.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Katsuki's mind wandered as the questions got less serious and more silly. He was comfortable, Izuku's fingers playing with his hair every now and then helping him relax back against the couch.

His eyes settled once or twice on classmates who weren't paying attention, several times subtly flipping the bird to one of his idiots when they made a face at him or wagged their eyebrows. He wasn't going to apologize for being comfortable. Nor was he going to tell Izuku to stop what he was doing.

The one time, though, that his gaze fell on Troll Doll he had to force himself not to react to the stupid smirk he was shoooting him. Especially when he looked back a few minutes later and the purple haired troll was paying attention to Izuku again with that stupid look of awe again.

Like hell was he going to lose his nerd to that.

Unfortunately, Kaminari was going to lose his life tonight since when Katsuki did tune back in, the blonde was grinning as he asked if Izuku was a 'Top' or a 'Bottom'.

Luckily for the electric quirked blonde, Aizawa reacted first. The man stood up and glared down at Kaminari, silent for a very long moment, before declaring the questions done and over with. Present Mic laughed and stood as well and, to the excitement of the entire class, grabbed the underground hero by the hand and gently tugged him away from the group.

Katsuki could practically feel Mina vibrating from where she was sitting. The girl wasn't one to gloat when she was right but since she'd called this since the beginning of the year, Katsuki could let her gloat a little.

Just a little, though. He didn't want to have to hear Kirishima whine about it later.

He was pulled out of his thoughts when Izuku's fingers combed through his hair again, drawing his head back so he could get a look at his face.

"You seem rather comfortable down there, Kacchan." The green haired teen was grinning at him and Katsuki was so comfortable he couldn't do much more than admire that smile.

….it was a couple hours after his bedtime so maybe that's why his insides felt so mushy and he couldn't bring himself to muster up any annoyance at their classmates cooing at them from just out of earshot?

He was also going to blame his being tired for reaching up to grab Izuku's hand as it exited his hair and tangling their fingers together.

"Hey. The old hag wants to see you." He kept his head tilted back, watching the uncomfortable look that bloomed over Izuku's face. "You don't have to if you don't want to but her and the old man were happy to hear you were okay and she, I quote, 'wants to make sure those bastards at that school are treating him right'."

Izuku's face relaxed and he smiled down at him, not answering his question for the moment but instead playing with his fingers gently. Katsuki let himself drift as he waited, just kind of idly taking in the soft little bubble that had surrounded them. He was vaguely aware of the others kind of lingering in the background but he couldn't really bring himself to care about them right now.

"If you say yes, we could go out to eat or something afterward." He blurted out, the nice little thought overriding his brain to mouth filter.

For a brief second he wanted to take the words back, shove them back into his mouth somehow or something, but the way Izuku's face slowly turned red and he hid his face with his free hand was worth it. He couldn't help himself and lifted up his own free hand to poke at the bit of Izuku's cheek that he could see.

"Is that a yes? Ha?"

"Kacchan! You can't just blurt something like that out! Especially in the context of going to see your mom before that!" Izuku's face was still bright red but he freed both of his hands to shove them in Katsuki's face in an attempt to stop him from smirking up at him again.

"Look how cute!" Mina's squeal broke the little bubble they were in, both boys jumping guiltily as they turned to look at her.

Izuku's hands on Katsuki's shoulders were the only thing keeping him from hopping up off of the floor and flying after her when he noticed her phone was out. Undoubtedly there were some sickly sweet pictures of them both on that phone and he had to destroy it. No one could have proof that King Explosion Murder could be soft!

Mina escaped with phone intact, though, because Izuku shifted his hands from Katsuki's shoulders to his arms wrapped around his shoulders. Unable to move, obviously, the explosive teen relaxed back against the sofa again and only glanced up at the other when his grip loosened.

What he saw was Izuku descending into nerves, biting his lip and not looking at Katsuki. With a huff the blonde pulled himself up onto the sofa with the green haired teen and reached out to tangle their fingers together again.

"What's up, nerd? Is it my parents or me asking you out?" He kept his tone soft and waited while the other seemed to put his words together. It took a moment before the other had his thoughts in line and gave Katsuki's hand a squeeze.

"Are you sure you want to….I'm more trouble than I'm worthy, especially for you." The words were mumbled and made Katsuki's hand tighten involuntarily, the words so wrong he actually kind of wanted to physically fight them. "I'm still considered a villain outside these walls. If anyone or, god forbid, the commission found out your career would be over before it started…"
"Bullshit." Katsuki grit the word out like it had personally offended him. "Look, I'm not good with words 'n shit. You of all people know this but if you think I'm gonna let something like that stop me from getting what I want, then you're an idiot."

Izuku blinked at him, taken aback for a moment, and for a brief second Katsuki thought he might have gone too far. Biting his own lip, he pulled the other closer and forced himself to calm down. Words were needed here. More than maybe he could nicely say but god damn it he was going to try.

“What I mean is, I don’t see you as trouble. You’re….my hero.” He had to look away from the look on Izuku’s face, afraid that the tears building in the other teen’s eyes would trigger his own. “You literally came back from the dead to try and save me from a literal group of villains. Don’t think I don’t know who came up with that crazy ass plan, Izuku. If you think I’m letting anyone, commission or no, tell me that I have to let you go in any capacity you’re crazy.”

Izuku squeezed his hand so tightly that Katsuki had to peek back at the other, surprised to find that he wasn’t crying but instead grinning at him with watery eyes.

“Then yes, Kacchan, I want to go to dinner with you after going to visit your parents.”

Chapter End Notes

Thank you for reading! I hope you enjoyed this chapter and the fic so far! I'm so blown away by how many people enjoy this constantly!!!! I even came across someone recommending this on Tiktok and blue screened for a few minutes lol. (If you were recommended this fic let me know where, drop a link, something! I'm beyond curious to see where you guys are coming from lol)

Until next week! A date? Mitsuki being delightful? Surprises?

Welcome to the Family

Chapter Summary

Aizawa says no dating, Mitsuki is Mitsuki, and Izuku and Katsuki attempt a date

Chapter Notes

This chapter took forever and I'm not sure how I feel about it, honestly! I hope yall enjoy it and as always let me know what you think!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Luckily, by time Izuku had extracted himself from the sofa and the soft atmosphere that had built around himself and Katsuki it was quite late. Everyone had split apart and were slowly making their way out of the common areas and into their dorms.

When he pushed open the door to the apartment he could see that Shouta was already preparing for his patrol and Hizashi was going through his nightly routine. The teen paused in the doorway for a moment, watching the older men talk quietly. Shouta was still tense from whatever questions he still had for Izuku but he and Hizashi's fingers were tangled together and he leaned in when Hizashi asked for a kiss.

It was nice to see them so...domestic. And he was glad he hadn't interrupted their routine or dynamic too much. They'd been so kind to him thus far that he wouldn't be able to stand it if he put any kind of strain on them or their relationship…

It didn't take long for the two to notice his entrance, Hizashi noticing first and flashing him a soft smile. The blonde motioning him forward grabbed Shouta's attention and Izuku hesitated when those dark eyes fell on him. They were full of questions and the embers of the anger he'd seen there earlier in the night.

He knew the anger wasn't directed at him but it still made him antsy. The man seemed to realize that and gave him a small smile and reached out to him with his free hand.

Izuku reached out with his own, letting the man pull him closer to them both.

"You know we're going to have to talk about all of this at some point, right?" Shouta asked, eyes searching and cataloging Izuku's response to his words. Izuku couldn't even be upset about it, really, he'd known this would be the most likely outcome of that particular breadcrumb.

But he couldn't spill just yet. Not when the hero in question was so powerful and could literally help the Commission's efforts for him to disappear quietly along with everything he knew.

As tedious and delicate as the job was, it had to be done right.

"I know." Izuku mumbled, dropping his gaze down to his feet in an attempt to hide from Shouta's gaze. "Just...please not tonight? I'm exhausted and I...kind of agreed to go see Auntie Mitsuki with Kacchan tomorrow."

Both adults blinked at him, surprised and he internally breathed a sigh of relief. At least with a change in subject he could dodge the questions he knew both of them had.

"Which means if I could pretty please have my knives back?" He fumbled on forward, shooing Shouta the most pleading look he could manage at the moment. "Since we're also going to be going to get dinner afterwards?"

Immediately he could see that his wheedling had gone a step too far when Shouta's eyes blew wide again and he tightened his grip on Izuku's hand.

"...Absolutely not. No dating. No loud blondes. Not happening. Be the sensible one in this family, Izuku."

Hizashi let out a snort , tugging his husband away from Izuku a little.

"Sho, he's allowed to date. It's a normal teenage thing."

"And the rules for dating are: No loud blondes. Bakugo is the loudest blonde in class."

"Oh? So if I were to date...Shinsou, that would be fine." Izuku asked innocently, fighting back the urge to smirk at the absolute indignation that covered the underground hero's face.

"...that just feels wrong. No dating until you're 30."

Izuku couldn't help the small smirk that tugged his lips up, kicking at the floor lightly as he thought about the best way to mess with the man.

"I mean, okay, but then I have to tell Kacchan I can't go. It's such a shame since he asked me and all. He'll probably revert back to being emotionally constipated and be that much more of a handful in class." He hummed, watching Shouta's expression out of the corner of his eye.

The man's eye twitched and he seemed to be looking skyward, possibly asking the universe what he'd done to be put in this kind of position. After a moment he huffed and reached out to pull Izuku into a one armed hug.

"Fine, problem child, but I'm not giving you your knives back just for sassing me." He muttered, releasing him to lean over to get a kiss from Hizashi, ignoring the teenagers whine.

“Be good, kid, I’ll see you in the morning.” Shouta turned back and ruffled Izuku’s hair before making his way out of the apartment.

It was quiet for a moment before Hizashi turned to the teenager and wagged his eyebrows at him, grinning.

“So? Shinsou came out pretty fast when he shot down Bakugo.”

“Nope! I’m going to bed! G’Night!”

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Standing on the doorstep of the Bakugo household, Izuku’s anxiety spiked. Katsuki glanced at him, brow raised, as he took in the way the green haired teen squeezed his hand and stared at the front door like it was going to bite him or something.

“Oi, nerd, it’ll be fine. They’re excited to see you.” He rumbled, knocking their shoulders together gently.

The other teen just flashed him a wobbly smile before nodding that he was ready. If Katsuki hadn’t heard and seen just how much his mom had worried about the other teen, he’d have suggested they just blow them off and go to the mall instead.

But he honestly couldn’t do that to the hag. When he’d called her to say that Izuku was coming with him, she sounded damn near tears.

Plus, she’d probably never let him live it down. He’d be hearing about it for the next fifty years.

Squaring his shoulders, the teen pushed open the front door of the house and led Izuku inside. From the corner of his eye, he could see the other teen’s head moving as he gawked at how much the decor had changed since the last time he’d been in the home.

Katsuki rolled his eyes and tugged on his hand, pulling him further into the house and towards the kitchen. He could hear his mother’s voice drifting from that direction. When they rounded the corner and stepped into the spacious kitchen, he was proven correct by the sight of his mother and father sitting at the table talking.

His mother paused mid sentence, staring at them over the old man’s shoulder. It was silent in the room for a moment before she abruptly pushed away from the table and practically flew across the kitchen.

“Izuku! I’m so happy to see you!” She cried, enveloping the teen in a hug so fierce that Katsuki worried about the other’s ribs. He was forced to let go of Izuku’s hand and take a step back when his mother’s gaze shifted to him.

The look in her eyes told him that she’d seen it and there would be a conversation about it later. For the moment, though, she seemed content to let sleeping dogs lay and instead rocked Izuku side to side in her hug.

When she finally did let go, she held the teenager at arms length and took a good hard look at him. Her nose wrinkled when she took in the black hoodie he was always wearing paired with the too large t-shirt and jeans.

“....we still need to work on your fashion sense, I see.” Izuku laughed a little as the woman made another face before pulling him back into another quick hug. “Nothing we can’t fix. You’ll have to come back over break and we can take you out shopping.”

“There’s no need for that, Auntie! Aizawa and Yamada bought me plenty of clothes. I just prefer comfort over looks”

Katsuki couldn’t help the snort that escaped him, shoving his hands into his pockets as he moved around his mother and friend to sit at the table with his father.

“No wonder Aizawa’s practically adopted you. You’re more similar to him than Troll Doll.”

The look his mother gave him was almost predatory as she dragged the green haired teen over to the table as well. Both of his parents must have been expecting them around this town because there was tea set up in the center of the table. Katsuki didn’t say anything as he reached out to start making his own cup, keeping an eye on Izuku out of the corner of his eye.

The other teen had relaxed a little now that the hag wasn’t actively trying to break his ribs. Though, he had taken note of the way Mitsuki had angeled her body towards him and was smiling at him in a way that was entirely too friendly.

“Aizawa is the homeroom teacher, correct? The one who defended Katsuki at the press conference?” She asked, like she didn’t already know the answer to that question. Katsuki could see a little of the tension returning to Izuku’s shoulders and grit his teeth a little to keep himself from snapping at his mother.

Izuku could handle Bakugo Mitsuki, he was sure. The last thing he needed was Katuski being overbearing and trying to fight his battles for him.

(His therapist would be proud. Katsuki didn’t need to be the loudest person in the room anymore.)

“Yes, that would be him. Since he’s the homeroom teacher for 1A, I’m under his custody.” Izuku said slowly, eyeing Mitsuki carefully as he mimicked Katsuki and poured himself a cup of tea. “I am..considering asking Nezu to allow me to stay with him full time after my probation is up.”

Before Mitsuki could jump on that like she so obviously wanted to, Masaru reached out to rest his hand gently on Izuku’s shoulder and flashed him a small smile.

“We’re happy to hear that you feel comfortable with Aizawa. Mitsuki was worried they weren’t treating you well.” His words were met with his wife’s fist hitting the table, unable to stop herself it seemed from behind loud and over the top as usual.

“Damn right I was! You’ve been through enough without those bastards adding onto it!” The woman fumed. “I tried to call up to the school to talk to you and the damn principal told me you didn’t exist!”

The laugh that Izuku let out was light and almost a giggle and had every single Bakugo in the room staring at him strangely. He flashed a brilliant smile Mitsuki’s way and waved his hand to try and dispel her confusion.

“I apologize, Auntie! I asked him to respond that way just in case my mother caught wind of this somehow. Not to say that I thought you would tell her, of course! I just wanted to be extra cautious.” The green haired teen flashed another smile and reached for his tea again, seemingly happy that the principal had actually kept his end of the bargain.

The hag’s expression changed a little, then. Katsuki held his breath, debating if he should change the subject or just grab Izuku and run. Instead of exploding again, Mitsuki reached out to put her hand over Izuku’s and making sure he was looking at her before she spoke.

“I won’t tell her anything, if you don’t want me to. I just….did she hurt you? Do I need to kill her?” Mitsuki’s voice was serious and her expression didn’t waver as Izuku laughed nervously. “I mean it, Izu, I might have known her since we were kids but if she did something to harm a single hair on your head I will not feel guilty.”

From where he was sitting, Katsuki could see the sheen of tears in Izuku’s eyes and was two seconds away from loudly demanding his mother cut the crap when the teen gripped her hand back and shook his head vigorously.

“No! Auntie, she didn’t hurt me on purpose. She just…” The teen huffed a little, blinking back tears and reaching up to rub at his eyes with the back of his hand. “She wanted to lock me in my room for my ‘safety’ and treated me like I was made of glass. I was never going to be able to be my own person with her…”

Katsuki could see his parents exchange looks before his father reached out to rub a hand over Izuku’s shoulders lightly.

“Okay, Izuku, we understand. We won’t say anything, promise.” The man’s voice was soft but the looks exchanged between him and his mother were making some sort of ‘danger’ sense blare in the back of Katsuki’s brain. He didn’t know, though, if it was just teenage embarrassment at whatever his parents were plotting or actual danger…

“If you want to come stay with us over breaks, or if you ever need somewhere to go because that school is too much, you’re always welcome. Okay? Hell, even if Katsuki is being a pain in the ass.”

Ah, so teenage embarrassment over his parents being AWFUL. At least his mother’s words got a soft giggle out of the teen.

“Oi! Hag! Stop being embarrassing! I’m sure his new dad, Aizawa, will try and fight you if you adopt him before he can.”

“Kacchan!!”

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Several hours later found Izuku and Katsuki walking through the local mall, fingers interlaced and swinging between them lightly. Katsuki wasn’t even sure if they had a destination in mind at this point because every few minutes Izuku was pulling him off into a different direction.

He wasn’t going to complain, though, because it was worth it to watch the other teen’s face light up as he caught sight of something interesting.

The blonde did note, however, that the green haired teen was giving any kind of hero merch a wide berth. He couldn’t say he blamed him, per say, considering what the other had told them of his past with heroes but it was...sad, almost.

He would never say this to Izuku’s face but a part of him missed the nerd’s rambling about how cool heroes and their quirks were. Sure, he still rambled about quirks but it was mostly classmates or upperclassmen he’d spotted in the halls.

Maybe he could bait him into talking about Present Mic and Aizawa?

Katsuki was pulled out of his thoughts by Izuku tugging them in a new direction, towards a sporting good store.

“I could probably find a decent knife in here! Shouta won’t give me back mine for another week!” The last part was whined and Katsuk couldn’t help the snort that left him.

“You know most kids complain that their parents take away their phone or something. You’re complaining about getting your weaponry taken, nerd.” His words, though, were softened by the fact that he was grinning at the other teen.

“Rude, Kacchan. Weaponry is very teenager of me, I’ll have you know!” Izuku sniffed, practically lifting his nose in the air and drawing another laugh from the blonde.

“Well, Mr. Teenager, why don’t we go get some food before we start shopping for weapons? I’d like to have a last meal before your dad kills me for letting you buy that stuff.”

Again, the other teen just rolled his eyes at him but stopped pulling him towards the store. Him stopping short caused Katsuki to bump into him and before he could take a step back, Izuku turned a little and grabbed the front of his shirt.

Which left him in the position of Izuku pressed rather close to his front, grinning up at him and batting his eyelashes as he leaned against his chest. Katsuki was momentarily distracted wondering if it was normal for his heart to try and beat itself out of his chest just from close proximity.

Maybe he needed to see Recovery Girl when they got back?

“It would be soooo romantic if Kacchan got it for me?” His tone was teasing enough that Katsuki knew he wasn’t serious but it didn’t stop the thought from sounding appealing.

Until he remembered why it was an awful, horrible, idea.

“Ha?! You’re trying to get me killed by Aizawa now, I’m sure of it.”

Izuku threw his head back and laughed, taking a step away from Katsuki and grinning widely at him.

“Honestly, no, but my accounts they could find are kinda frozen right now or I’d buy one myself.” The teen shrugged, grin still on his lips as he swung their intertwined hands playfully.

Katsuki’s retort died on his tongue, though, as someone came from behind Izuku and draped an arm across his shoulders. His free hand started to come up to pop off some warning explosions before he registered what exactly he was seeing.

Icy blue eyes met red, scars on the man’s face stretching a little as he grinned at Katsuki. Izuku shifted a little and made a noise of confusion, attempting to pull away from the man but he tightened his grip and leaned more heavily on the other teen’s shoulders to keep him in place.

“I could buy them for you, if you want, Izuku. I know the kind you prefer, after all.” Dabi drawled, gaze never leaving Katsuki.

Chapter End Notes

Dabi has arrived!

This is your warning that going forward, this guy is going to be a recurring character. The next chapter we're also going to touch on some backstory between Dabi and Izuku! Get excited, I am!

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! Let me know what you think!

In the past is where we'll leave it

Chapter Summary

Dabi is Petty and Izuku is intense

Chapter Notes

Standard disclaimer. Yes, there is past Dabi/Deku mentioned in this chapter. No, I do not condone this kind of relationship in real life. These are fictional characters and thus, not real people. I enjoy the complicated dynamic of these two so please please please don't jump down my throat about this.

That being said! I hope yall enjoy this chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Izuku wondered, sometimes, what he'd done in a past life to deserve the awful luck he had. Of course, today of all days, Dabi decided to show himself. Today, of all days, the universe decided to send him a big middle finger in the form of the man he least wanted to see right now.

In the middle of a mall where Izuku couldn't scream every obscenity he knew at the man and then quietly beat the shit out of him.

He could see the look on Katsuki's face, the rage starting to light up in those red eyes, and desperately wished he had a quirk to turn back time and avoid this interaction ever happening. Izuku knew deep in the bottom of his heart that this was going to dig up old trauma for the blonde and he hated that this was his fault.

If he'd had it his way, no one outside of Shouta and possibly Shouto would know about his connection to Dabi. Hell, after they'd left things he hadn't thought the man would be willing to approach him again.

The taller man's arm shifted so he was pulling Izuku back against him, pulling him out of his thoughts as well. With a hiss, he elbowed the fire quirked man in the stomach as hard as he could and slipped out of his grip. Dabi let out a grunt of pain and tried to reach out for him again, fingertips missing his hoodie by mere centimeters.

"What the actual fuck is wrong with you?!" Izuku hissed again, turning to face him as he purposely put himself between Katsuki and the league member. Finally facing the other, he

could see the anger brewing in the man's eyes.

As if he had anything to be angry about! The last time Izuku had seen him was right before he abandoned him for Shigaraki.

The worst part of facing him, though, was watching the cogs turn in his brain. He could see his former friend and mentor putting pieces together as his gaze darted between Katsuki and Izuku. There was almost a grim satisfaction in Izuku's gut at the way Dabi's lips downturned for a brief moment.

He hadn't even thought about Dabi when he'd agreed to this date, not even once. But now a little bit of satisfaction curled in his gut that he could inflict pain on the man even just a little. To show him a little of what he'd felt when the man walked out of his life to join the very person he hated most.

Izuku hadn't done the exact same, of course, but he could enjoy his own petty version of that feeling.

Behind him, he could hear Katsuki shifting anxiously as the silent staredown between him and Dabi stretched on. This was going to be...awful to explain to him later. If he even got a chance to explain.

Katsuki had his own issues with Dabi, Izuku knew, and him having the kind of connection he did to the man was not going to go over well. He could already see the fight that was going to come after this. If Katsuki didn't just straight up refuse to speak to him. He wouldn't blame him if that was the road he decided to take.

"You know, I never really took you as the type to sink this low, Izu." Dabi finally broke the silence, stance relaxing a little as he shoved his hands into his pockets and flashed Izuku a smile that made a shiver run up his spine. It was petty and way too relaxed for his liking. "I mean, playing the sweet innocent victim card is a bit degrading, isn't it? I thought I taught you to have some self-respect."

Behind him, Katsuki made a noise of confusion and stepped forward enough that Izuku could see him out of the corner of his eye. One of his hands reached out to wrap around Izuku's wrist, trying to get his attention.

" 'Izu'?" The blonde repeated, tone unreadable as he stared hard at him. Izuku did his best not to meet his eye, instead focusing on the villain in front of them.

"I'm assuming that's what you're doing, right? When things got scary after Kamino you ran to your precious Kacchan and weaseled your way into his good graces? You've always been a bit conniving but this takes the cake."

The hand on his wrist quickly turned into Katsuki holding Izuku back, the green haired teen's lips curled back in a snarl as he reached out to attempt to wipe the man's smirk off of his face with his fist.

“How dare you!” He snarled, fighting against Katsuki’s hold on him for a moment longer before deciding he wasn’t going to be allowed to assault the man in front of him for the moment. “You know damn well that I can protect myself. As if you even care since you’ve made so many new friends.”

Dabi didn’t even flinch as the words were spat at him, though. His smile widened into a smirk and he tilted his head a little, gaze flickering over to Katsuki again.

“Izu, come on. I offered for you to come with me. Shigaraki even said he’d behave. It’s not my fault you decided splitting would be better than joining with me.” The words were said with a shrug but Izuku knew better. Knew what game the man was playing.

He could feel Katsuki’s eyes boring into the side of his face before his gaze flickered away to Dabi once more. Izuku grit his teeth against the scream of frustration that built up in his chest.

All he’d wanted was one good day. Just one. Wasn’t he owed at least one moment of peace?

“Is this really the game you want to play?” Izuku hissed, hands curling into fists at his side as he glared at him. “Do remember how much I know. Lots of things that could...slip. You know, since I’m so conniving and all.”

A flash of uncertainty crossed his face and his gaze flickered around to the small crowd that was beginning to gather around them. Blue eyes flickered back to Izuku, sneer pulling at his lips as he pulled his hands out of his pockets and held them up in mock surrender.

“Point made. Have fun on the rest of your date, Izu.”

Before Izuku could retaliate for that comment, he turned around and disappeared into the crowd. As much as he wanted to follow him and find out what the actual fuck that was about, he couldn’t. Not when his attention was pulled back to the one audience member to this disaster that mattered with a small tug to his wrist.

Growling a little under his breath, he twisted his wrist and hand until he was holding the blonde’s hand firmly and began pulling him in the opposite direction that Dabi had fled.

“Come on, we need to go.” The last thing Izuku or Katsuki needed was to get caught having some sort of altercation in the mall with a Villain. Katsuki didn’t have his provisional license yet and Izuku would be taken back into custody before even Nezu would be able to save him.

Izuku pulled Katsuki through the crowd and towards the entrance of the mall quickly, stomach rolling uncomfortably when he looked back to catch sight of the guarded look in the blonde’s eyes.

It wasn’t until they were out of the mall and a few streets away that Izuku stopped pulling on the other teen, ducking into an alleyway before finally stopping.

In a fit of frustration, Izuku kicked a nearby trash can over and finally let go of Katsuki’s hand. Now free, his hands made their way into his own hair as he tugged at it and turned to

kick at the wall of the alley.

“Next time I see that bastard I’m pulling staples out of his stupid, smug, face. What right does he have to say shit like that!” He ranted, finally turning and slumping against the wall a little.

Katsuki stood a few feet away from him, expression unreadable and posture closed off. The silence between them stretched on and on, both of them watching each other for a sign or a scrap of what the other was thinking.

“Really, nerd? Dabi? Of all people…” Katsuki finally said, shoving his hands in his pockets and slumping against the wall opposite to Izuku. Everything in his posture screamed defensive and closed off.

Izuku pushed himself off of his wall and took a few hesitant steps towards the blonde, pausing to see if he was welcomed in the other’s space at the moment. There was no indication that he wasn’t allowed so he stepped forward again.

“He wasn’t...always this... bad.” He started, unable to meet Katsuki’s eyes. One of his hands came up to rub at his arm, shrugging a little. The snort the other teen let out drew a small chuckle from him, hand coming up to rub at the back of his neck.

“Izuku, he’s a villain.” At his words, Izuku finally met Katsuki’s gaze again. The blonde’s gaze was angry and Izuku met it with anger of his own.

“So am I, you know.” Izuku bit the words out through clenched teeth, frustration welling up in him again. “He saved my life. He pulled me out of that river and then spent a lot of time and energy keeping me alive, afterwards.”

Katsuki dropped his gaze, crossing his arms over his chest as his jaw clenched and unclenched. He obviously couldn’t argue against that and Izuku hadn’t wanted to throw that particular bit of information at him, just yet, damn it!

“I’m not saying he’s a good person. Hell, I don’t like him all that much at the moment! But at the end of the day, I can’t just pretend like I don’t owe him my damn life.”

The blonde looked up once more, locking Izuku’s gaze to his own as he obviously mulled over whatever question was on his mind.

“You ‘split’ with him when he joined the league?”

“Yes. I can’t stand Shigaraki. What you saw in the bar that night was a mild disagreement in the grand scheme of how much we don’t get along.”

“Right. So you and staple face were dating before he joined up with Crusty?”

Izuku opened and closed his mouth a few times before looking away, unsure how to answer. He lifted his shoulder in a small shrug and let his hand make a ‘so so’ gesture.

“I….kinda? We were never physical or anything like that but he’s definitely not a brother or father figure.” Izuku didn’t think in a million years he’d ever be able to fully explain the complicated nature of his and Dabi’s relationship. Dabi, up until recently, had been the one person that Izuku felt he could be himself around without judgment. He’d been the only person on the planet that Izuku never had to doubt would be in his corner or not.

Or so he’d thought. Shit, as usual, went to hell in a handbasket when Shigaraki got involved.

“Do you love him?” Izuku’s head shot up at the question, meeting Katsuki’s gaze again. He could see the insecurity, then, and the anger that was simmering under the surface.

Stepping closer to him, he carefully watched the others face as he slid his fingertips over his arm. When the blonde didn’t pull away he put a little more pressure, palm sliding up and down his arm comfortingly as he stepped further into his space.

For a few long moments he didn’t say anything, just stood in Katsuki’s space and gently ran his hand up and down his arm. Slowly, the anger seemed to seep from the blonde’s gaze and was replaced by bone deep worry and a stormy expression rather than rage.

“Yes, I do.” He kept his voice soft, gaze locked with Katsuki’s as he tried to convey how serious he was about this. He needed Katsuki to understand where he was coming from here. “I know it sounds weird, but yes. If he were in trouble right now, despite how angry I am with him, I’d call in as many favors as I needed to and do some very morally and legally questionable things to make sure at the end of the day he was alive and able to be an asshole.”

Izuki drew in a deep breath to calm his nerves, heart beating painfully at his ribcage as he slowly traced his hands up Katsuki’s arms and shoulders until he was cupping the blonde haired boy’s face between his hands. His expression and gaze was still stormy but it softened a little as Izuku let his thumb sweep over his cheek lightly.

“I need you to understand, Kacchan, that yes I would do all of that for him if you were in the same position or if anyone tried to harm you, I would do so much more.” Izuku’s voice was firm as he leaned further into Katsuki’s space and prayed that the other could feel his sincerity right now. “I would rip the world apart atom by atom for you. There’s no force on earth that would be able to stop me from doing whatever I needed to do to make sure you’re okay.”

There was a long moment where neither of them said anything, just watched each other carefully and soaked up the proximity of the other. Izuku was confident that his message got across but outside of that he couldn’t be sure. He was sure that Katsuki could feel his heart beating rapidly and feel the way his hands shook a little against his face as he tried not to rush the other teen.

Finally, Katsuki reached up to take Izuku’s hand from his face so he could tangle their fingers together. Some of the tension bled out of him, enough for Izuku to know that the other wasn’t fully happy with the situation but he was no longer ready to fight.

“Way to be intense, nerd.” The blonde mumbled, pulling Izuku closer until he could tuck his head under his chin and wrap his free arm around him. “This was not how I pictured tonight going, by the way.”

“Yeah, I figured.” Izuku laughed quietly, relaxing against Katsuki and soaking up every bit of attention he was giving him.

Later, they would part and head back to the school to deal with telling Shouta what had happened. But that was later and Izuku was going to enjoy every bit of warmth he could get.

Chapter End Notes

Hi darlings! I hope you enjoyed the chapter! It's a day early because there's a lot of things going on right now irl and I didn't think I'd be able to get it out on time if I left it till tomorrow lol

Come hang out with me on discord! https://discord.gg/ghyXCWSxNt

and please, let me know what you thought! Yall know I love seeing your reactions! It gives me much needed serotonin

My songs know what you did in the dark

Chapter Summary

What's done in the dark will come to light. No one can hide from the truth forever.

Chapter Notes

I am absolutely in love with this chapter and how it came out. It's been done, edited, and waiting since Wednesday. I'm so excited to see how yall like it!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Time ticked by slowly as they stood in the alley, Katsuki leaning back against the wall and holding Izuku to his chest carefully. The blonde stared vacantly at the wall across from him trying to get his thoughts in some semblance of order.

Everything was just so jumbled.

Katsuki didn’t know what emotions were swirling around in his chest at the moment, all too mixed together at the moment for him to really untangle them.

Part of him wanted to rage and blow up everything within a fifty foot radius. The quieter part of him just wanted to curl up somewhere and try to forget that today had even happened.

Everything had been going so well. His parents hadn’t completely embarrassed him when he’d brought Izuku home and the date had been going so well up until…

Dabi.

Dabi, of all people, had a history with the nerd.

Even if he didn’t admit it to anyone else, Katsuki still had nightmares about the scared bastard and that night at the training camp. Could sometimes still feel the man’s hand wrapped around the back of his neck as he was pulled into that portal.

But that was, now, the man who kept Izuku alive.

That man was now the person he owed for having the chance to apologize to Izuku. For keeping him alive when no one was there or aware that he was in danger.

That was now, also, someone so dear to Izuku that even as mad as the green haired teen was, he still admitted to caring for him?

How was Katsuki supposed to reconcile any of this?

It left his mind spinning and his chest tight.

His therapist was going to have a field day with this shit when he finally got in to see her.

Katsuki was pulled out of his swirling and circling thoughts as Izuku shifted in his hold a little, nuzzling his face into his shirt as if he could read Katsuki's mind.

He'd certainly known that he wouldn't react well to this information. Which was why he'd kept it a secret.

How many more secrets was the green haired teen keeping from him? How many more 'surprises' was he due for?

Did he even want to know, really?

Before he could get lost in his thoughts again, the smaller teen was pulling back a little to peek up at his face. He couldn't be sure what the other was seeing but it likely wasn't good nor what he was looking for if the way he bit his lip and pulled away a little more was anything to go by.

"Kacchan, I'm sorry. I really am…"

"Sorry that it happened like this or that I found out at all…"

The words slipped out of his mouth before he could stop them and for a brief moment he felt bad. Izuku's expression closed off and he stepped away from Katsuki all together, letting go of his hand and turning his face away.

"What do you want me to say, Kacchan? No, I didn't ever think it would be relevant information." The teen mumbled, crossing his arms over his chest and shifting uncomfortably.

"Relevant information? You didn't think the fact that you have connections to the league and a wanted criminal isn't relevant information?!" Katsuki exploded finally, pushing away from the wall he was leaned against to step back into Izuku's space. "Didn't think that your ex boyfriend is part of the League and might hold a grudge was relevant information?!"

"If you want a list of every single wanted criminal I have connections to, we're going to be here a very long time Kacchan." Izuku ground out, finally looking up at Katsuki. He uncrossed his arms from his chest and pushed on Katsuki's chest with a growl. "I am a wanted criminal. I've done so much shit that I can't ever tell you that it could fill ten more notebooks than I already have. I'm sorry that I'm not the sweet innocent Deku I was when I tried to kill myself."

Katsuki jerked like he'd been slapped and watched as Izuku turned away from him, stalking angrily back to the other side of the alley and curled in on himself. Katsuki's own shoulders dropped as he took a deep breath and dragged a hand through his hair.

How had today turned out so awful? All he'd wanted to do was show Izuku he cared and wanted to make this work…

Shaking himself out of his thoughts, he approached the smaller teen once more. He carefully laid a hand on Izuku's shoulder and gently pulled until he was facing him again. Katsuki cursed himself as he noticed the tears building in the other's eyes.

"I don't want you to be that person, Izuku, I just…." With a frustrated huff, he cut himself off and glanced away, trying to find the words to convey the swirling mass of emotions in his chest. "I was caught off guard, tonight, and I am trying so hard to understand who you are now…"

Izuku swiped at his face with the sleeve of his hoodie before turning to face Katsuki again fully. He hated how small and closed off he was, angry with himself that he caused this. Angry with Dabi for being bastard enough to cause this entire situation.

A little angry with Izuku as well for not telling him, damnit.

"Kacchan, you have to understand, there are some things that I'm never going to be able to tell you about. Not because I don't want to but because they could put you in more danger than I ever want to be the cause of…" Izuku said after a moment, looking up at him with wide eyes that practically begged him to understand, to listen.

"Then just tell me what you can. Just...don't shut me out because you're scared of my reaction." Katsuki ground out after a moment, turning his face away and dragging a hand through his hair again. "Just because I don't like it doesn't mean I'm going to abandon you over it."

When he glanced back at the other, he could see Izuku searching his face for something. Whatever he was looking for he seemed to find because in the next moment he was stepping back into Katsuki's space. The blonde held his breath for a second before letting it out slowly as the other simply reached out to tangle their fingers together gently.

"I can do that." Izuku said quietly, flashing him a small smile. "Just...not right this second? I'm kinda exhausted from this revelation…"

Katsuki rolled his eyes and pulled the other in closer, dropping a kiss to his hair gently before pulling back to nod.

"Yeah, same. Let's get back to the dorms before Aizawa starts hunting us down, eh?"

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Izuku stepped into the classroom, backpack slung over his shoulder, and paused for a second to take in the scene in front of him.

All Might was once again standing near the podium and once again, the sight made him want to turn around and flee.

Seeing All Might standing near the podium was an altogether unpleasant experience after last time and the class seemed to agree. Everyone was already in their seats, their gazes bouncing nervously between Izuku and the former hero once they realized he had arrived.

Several of the class were glaring at the man and he was obviously trying not to show how uncomfortable he was at the hostility lingering in the air but the tense line of his shoulders told everyone who knew to look for it all they needed to know. Izuku almost wanted to giggle a little at the sight of one of the most formidable heroes in history squirming as nineteen teenagers glared daggers at him.

Hiding his smile, he stepped up to the podium and set down the stack of papers he'd brought with him. From the corner of his eye he could see Shouta wrapped up in his sleeping bag, looking to the untrained eye like he was napping. The tension in his shoulders eased and Izuku turned his head to flash the man a small smile.

It appeared no one was eager to have a repeat performance from the former number one hero.

Looking back out over the class Izuku met Katsuki's intense gaze and smiled, giving a small wave before turning his attention back to the business at hand. This wasn't his first time leading the lesson but it was by far the most important.

It was going to be the ultimate test of if his plan was successful or not. He was fairly sure he'd left enough breadcrumbs for the class to follow but one could never be 100% sure what information others retained.

Katsuki and Shouta were sure to put two and two together immediately but the others…

Well, it was now or never, he supposed.

All Might was staring at him with barely concealed contempt as he moved around the podium and started passing out the papers. He'd already voiced his displeasure at taking a backseat for this lesson to Shouta and gotten told to deal with it or talk to Nezu.

Rightfully, it seemed, All Might was hesitant to cross the rat principle more than once. So he kept his mouth shut and moved to sit behind the Podium.

Izuku, ignoring the daggers the man was glaring at his back, finished passing the papers out and flashed the class a smile. Most of them smiled back, Mina and Kaminari shooting him very obvious thumbs up that he couldn't help but grin at.

"Alright, so today we're doing a group discussion kinda thing. I know you've already had your unit on procedures and protocol but with the provisional license exam coming up we

thought it'd be best to go over it again, briefly." He said brightly, eyes roving over the class as they got their papers and cracked open their notebooks.

He could see several of them wrinkling their noses as they stared at the papers and internally laughed to himself. This, out of all of the breadcrumbs, was going to be the most fun to execute.

Turning, he took the last two remaining papers and handed one each to the other 'teachers' in the room. Shouta raised a brow at him as he leaned over the desk and waved the paper in his face but silently took it, seeming to catch on to the fact that Izuku was up to something.

All Might, on the other hand, was as blissfully unaware as usual and took the paper from Izuku with a small grunt.

With a brilliant smile Izuku turned back to the class, noting a couple more disgusted faces in the crowd now that most of them had the time to skim the paper a little.

"So, this is a real life scenario. This happened nearby a couple of years ago so I thought it'd be perfect to use as an example. We're going to discuss what this hero did right, what they did wrong, and discuss how to avoid the mistakes that were made here. Not so bad, right?" He bounced a little on the balls of his feet as he said this, scanning the faces in front of him again.

Behind him, he could hear the paper in All Might's grip crinkling and probably tearing. He didn't turn around but he could almost picture the look on the man's face as he realized exactly what incident was on the paper held by each and every one of his students.

"Midoriya, this is highly inappropriate. We shouldn't be tearing down other heroes like this." All Might's voice was firm but Izuku could hear the quietest note of panic buried deep in his tone.

He turned on his heel a little to flash the toothiest grin he could manage at the man, pinning him in place with a stare that could rival Shouta's level of unimpressed. He let the man squirm for a moment before gesturing with his hands and a shrug.

"Nezu disagrees, sir. Real life scenarios are invaluable for our students so he personally approved this lesson plan for today." He said brightly before turning his back on the man once more.

He let his gaze flicker briefly up to the camera in the corner of the room, winking at it before he refocused back to the class.

For the moment he'd let the man stew in the panic of exactly how much Nezu possibly knew about this 'scenario'.

(Nothing, so far, but he was fairly sure the Principal would have the whole picture soon enough. Especially with how nervous the former number one was acting right now.)

By now, most of the class had read the scenario and Izuku was more than a little thrilled to see the way they were looking down at their papers. Most of them were scribbling notes down and others were just staring at the paper like it had offended them. Iida was making chopping motions to himself while Todoroki looked like he was contemplating setting it on fire.

However, Izuku's eyes were drawn to Katsuki and the scowl that was etched into his face. There was no way that the blonde didn't recognize the description of the villain in the 'scenario'. Izuku knew he'd put at least some of the pieces together by the way the edges of the paper were smoking in his hands.

"So, who wants to tell me the first thing they noticed that was incorrect in this scenario?" Izuku asked, clapping his hands together and scanning the crowd of students.

Hagakure seemed to vibrate in her seat, uniform floating up like she was standing up in the desk and waving her arm violently to get Izuku's attention. Smiling a little to himself, he motioned for her to go first.

"The victim was unconscious for several minutes with a substance in their lungs that had been through gods only know where and the hero didn't call for medical immediately. In fact, I don't think they called for medical or police once during this entire take down." She said, sitting back down and shaking the paper at him. Obviously, he couldn't see her face but from her tone of voice she was frowning.

There were murmurs of agreement throughout the class and Izuku motioned for Iida to speak as his hand shot up next, anticipating that the floor was now open for discussion. Standing up, Iida adjusted his glasses and glanced back down at his notes with a frown.

"The biggest mistake this hero made was not calling in for the police and medical once the villain was captured. Plastic bottles are obviously not the best capture method and there was no guarantee that they would hold. This entire mess could have been avoided had they stayed on scene like protocol dictates." The teen adjusted his glasses again, almost outright scowling now as he seemed to think on it more. "It was very irresponsible of this hero and I would hope he was reprimanded for the damage done when the villain escaped."

Tokoyami waited till Iida had sat back down before speaking, giving Izuku searching glances every few seconds as he glanced between him and the paper in front of him.

"The victim shouldn't have grabbed hold of the hero, yes, but the fact that the hero left what is described to be a minor on a rooftop with no way down is concerning in itself. Especially since they had not seen a medical professional yet."

Discussion rose around the room but Izuku's gaze was drawn back to Katsuki, finding the red of his gaze boring into him once more. A muscle jumped in his jaw as he clenched and unclenched it as if physically forcing himself not to start demanding answers right that moment. Izuku spared a moment to feel a little proud of him before turning his attention back towards the rest of the class.

“Any kind of fluid in the lungs is a problem, ribbit.” Tsu was explaining to Kirishima who looked a little lost. “I’ve heard of people drowning on dry land because they didn’t go see a doctor after inhaling water.”

Izuku tried to school his expression to a mildly interested one but he could tell that his face dropped a little and he was sure his already pale complexion grew a few shades lighter.

The bacteria in his lungs just from the sludge villain had been bad but the water he’d been pulled from hadn’t helped matters...

Katsuki must have heard the statement as well as saw the way Izuku reacted at the mention of drowning because his handle on his temper slipped and his hands slammed against the desk loudly. Every eye turned his way but he didn’t seem to notice nor care at the moment.

“You were attacked first, that day.” He said without preamble, shaking the paper in his hands in Izuku’s direction. He didn’t wait for Izuku to confirm or deny the statement, instead pressing on as rage filled his gaze. “And whoever this piece of shit hero is told you that quirkless kids can’t be heroes.”

Behind Izuku, he could hear both pro heroes moving from their positions as silence fell over the students at Katsuki’s declaration.

“Young Bakugo, calm yourself. This is no way for a hero student to act over a small thing like this." All Might boomed from behind Izuku.

Katsuki missed the way the green harried teen flinched as he tore his gaze away for a brief moment to pin the former symbol of peace with a glare.

“Shut it, old man, you obviously don’t know shit!” The blonde snarled, shaking the paper again before his gaze swung back to Izuku. “Whoever this piece of shit is, he’s part of the reason you jumped off that bridge and I’m going to tear his spine out of his mouth.”

“Bakugo!” Shouta’s voice was reprimanding but it did nothing to cool the simmering rage in the blonde’s eyes. If anything, the fire grew hotter and Izuku found himself rooted in place.

Of all of the outcomes he’d planned for, this one was pretty far down on the list of what Izuku had expected to happen today. Sure, Katsuki would be upset but not this upset. Hell, he’d half expected the blonde to be angry at him for letting the villain get away and come after him.

He wouldn’t blame him, honestly, the feeling of suffocating on something you can’t expel was a vivid part of his own nightmares for a long time after the incident.

“Who. Was. It.” Katsuki growled, leaning over his desk again to slam the fist holding the paper down onto it.

Izuku’s gaze skipped away from Katsuki nervously, taking in the faces of the class for a moment while he tried to figure out how to answer. He couldn’t outright say it was the man standing almost directly behind him, now. No, that would still be leaving himself too open for

retaliation and the accusation of slander. Unless All Might incriminated himself, now, there was no way Izuku was going to be able to answer that question.

Even if every student in the room was staring at him, seemingly wanting the same answer.

Kirishima and Iida were out of their seats, hovering anxiously as if waiting to have to keep the peace. Shouji and Ojiro were still in their seats but they were eying Katsuki warily in case they needed to jump in and help restrain him, if needed.

The only person not looking at Katsuki or Izuku was Todoroki. His mismatched eyes were trained on All Might. His expression was as blank and unreadable as ever but there was something in his eyes that made Izuku's stomach clench uncomfortably.

Why were the Todoroki siblings always the one thing to either save or destroy him, anymore?

The moment those mismatched eyes flickered over to him, Izuku knew everything was about to blow up. In possibly the best way.

Or worst. One could never tell the direction a Todoroki shaped bomb was going to go off, honestly.

"Use your brain, Bakugo. Who in the Pro-Hero scene can use one punch to end a fight?" His voice was monotone as usual but there was a fire behind his eyes as his gaze landed on the former number one hero once more. "I can only think of one and if I'm not mistaken, he used the same attack against the same Villain later on that day."

The silence that overtook the room was even worse than the first time and Izuku hesitated to peek at Katsuki's expression. When he did, though, all he saw there was bone deep shock. Even the fires of the blonde's anger couldn't help but take a backseat to the revelation that his hero wasn't what he thought he was. For a second time, the entire class had to face that fact.

A hand fell on his shoulder and Izuku nearly jumped out of his skin. His gaze skittered backwards to meet Shouta's, the man's eyes dark and stormy as he seemed to search Izuku's gaze for whatever answer he was looking for.

He didn't seem happy with whatever he found if the way his grip tightened was anything to go by.

Seconds seemed to tick by as everyone in the room digested the information that had just been dumped at their feet. It wasn't an easy pill to swallow that someone they all admired was the cause of the downfall, almost literally, of someone else they admired. Especially when All Might stood on such a high pedestal.

The first incident in the classroom had brought him an inch or two closer, mind you, but this was damn near knocking him off of it for most of them.

Izuku turned his head a little to sneak a peek at the number one hero and found him glaring at him with all his might. The rational part of his brain told him that the man wouldn't attempt

anything against him in front of the entire class, especially after what had happened the last time, but the other part of his brain screamed danger.

And well, Izuku hadn't survived as long as he had without listening to the danger part of his brain.

Very carefully he ducked out of Shouta's grasp and began to back away, towards the door. The class would have questions but those could wait until later. Away from the hateful gaze of someone who looked like they'd really like to strangle him right this moment.

Unfortunately, for him, his movement seemed to break whatever spell had fallen over the class and the entire room erupted into noise. Vaguely, he could hear Katsuki's explosions over the yelling but he was more focused on trying to make a break for the door than hearing what anyone was saying.

Right as his fingertips brushed the edge of the door, a massive hand grabbed his hoodie. He had a brief moment to wonder what kind of strength the skeleton-like man managed to keep before he was pinned against the door by the former number one hero. The man's free hand came up to wrap around his throat, expression murderous as he leaned in to pin the teenager in place.

"I won't let you corrupt these children against me further." The blonde man growled out, hand tightening around Izuku's throat as he easily ignored the teenager's hand clawing at his wrist. "This is the last time you twist the truth like this! I'll make sure of it!"

Struggling against him, Izuku not for the first time wished he had his knives on him.

The teen attempted to lift his knee up to put pressure on the man's injured side, hoping to get him to back off but the man instead shifted out of his reach. The move did give him a little bit of space as the pressure to his throat lessened enough for him to get a good breath in.

"Not twisting the truth." He ground out, glaring up at the man as he aimed a kick at the man's left side again. It gave him a little more room and the man's grip loosened again.

He was close to freeing himself when the volume in the classroom rose once more, explosions drowning out the yelling as they got closer. Katsuki didn't get a chance to tackle the former pro, however, before a familiar capture weapon was wrapping around the tall blonde man and pulling him away from Izuku.

Katsuki skid to a stop next to Izuku as Shouta hauled All Might backwards, struggling a little as the man fought against him.

Izuku could feel calloused hands pulling at his hoodie and ghosting at the skin of his neck but he couldn't look at the other teen, eyes still glued to where Shouta was restraining the tall blonde.

"You can't run from the truth, Toshinori. You made your bed now lay in it." Izuku pushed as much of his anger into his voice as he could muster, pulling himself to his full height and glaring at the man. "It's not my fault you decided to be a shitty excuse for a hero, in the end."

The man stopped struggling for a brief moment, enough that Izuku could finally hazard to look up at Shouta and meet his eyes once again. He couldn't read the emotion in them and forced himself to look away. Unfortunately, the only other safe place to look was at Katsuki.

Katsuki was still hovering at his side, hand extended like he was debating pushing Izuku behind him and out of sight of the man wrapped up in Shouta's capture weapon. Something in Izuku's chest broke a little at the sight and the enormity of the entire situation finally crashed down on him.

Everyone knew what happened that day. They all knew everything now.

Despite the fact that this was what he'd wanted, the enormity of everything pushed down on him and made his chest tight and his breathing stutter.

Suddenly the walls of the classroom began to close in on him and he needed to go. The traitorous part of his brain whispered that everyone was going to know how weak he was now.

Without a word, he turned on his heel and fled from the classroom.

Chapter End Notes

Please, tell me what you think. It feeds me and fuels more of this story. :D

The night the lights went out in Georgia

Chapter Summary

Consequences are had

Chapter Notes

This is a hefty chapter and took forever to put together the way I wanted. I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Once Izuku left the room, things happened very quickly.

Nezu himself entered the room not five minutes later, followed by Midnight and Cementoss.

It seemed like they'd already been briefed on the situation as Midnight quickly knocked All Might out and he was taken from the classroom by the two heroes. Presumably to Nezu's office though no one caught the details of what exactly was happening there.

Katsuki barely heard Nezu trying to calm Aizawa down over the sound of his own heartbeat in his ears.

He found himself sitting on the floor of the classroom, Sero and Kirishima on either side of him. In his peripheral he could see Iida and Yaoyorozu herding the class away from where he was seated and back towards their desks. Very little of what they were saying was registering to him, though, so he turned his head so he could watch the Principal and their teacher.

The rat was standing on the Podium speaking to the man who looked absolutely wrecked. If Katsuki had any energy left he'd be surprised at the level of emotion the usually stoic hero was showing. Even with his addled brain Katsuki could see the man's hands shaking and the way one of his hands was still wrapped tightly around his capture weapon.

"He's left the campus already." Nezu's voice drifted over to him and the blonde couldn't help but shoot up from his sitting position to insert himself into the conversation.

"He left?!"

The rat's gaze bore into Katsuki for a moment like he was trying to see into his brain or something before he shifted to face the teen, posture calm and collected.

“Yes, he was seen on cameras leaving campus just after I arrived on scene. Not to worry, Young Bakugo! This is completely expected.” Nezu’s words seemed to pull something out of Aizawa because the man dragged a hand through his hair and looked like he wanted to strangle the principal.

“Expected? None of this was expected!” The man grit out, eyes a little wild at the edges and posture tense.

“Well, not all of it no. I certainly wasn’t expecting the former number one hero to attempt to strangle a minor. However, Izuku running away when things got a little too much for him was something I was expecting.” Nezu clapped his paws together and motioned for Aizawa to come closer. “I expected it to be much, much sooner than this but not to worry. His phone has a tracker in it and he has things here he clearly cares about. He’ll return once he is ready.”

The irritation Katsuki felt was mirrored in Aizawa’s face as he stepped closer and let the rat climb up onto his shoulders. He turned his attention to Katsuki once more and flashed him a smile, giving a small wave of his paw.

“We will handle this, don’t you worry! Just focus on helping your friends wrap their minds around this before Izuku comes back. He will need support, don’t you think?”

As much as he didn’t want to admit it, that really was all he could do in this situation. Sure, he could leave school grounds to go try and hunt Izuku down but even he had to admit that he had no idea where the green haired teen would be headed.

He’d managed to survive for almost three years without anyone being even the slightest bit aware he was alive. What hope did Katsuki have in tracking him down if he didn’t want to be found?

Nodding, he turned to go back to where Sero and Kirishima were hovering nervously but paused as Aizawa turned to leave. The man saw his pause and turned his gaze to him, questioning and dull. Katsuki’s hands curled into fists at his sides and he grit his teeth against the swell of rage still burning in his chest.

“Don’t let the bastard get away with this.”

Aizawa’s gaze sharpened and for the first time Katsuki could see the rage simmering just under the surface reflected back at him. The man didn’t say anything, instead giving a sharp nod and turning on his heel.

As much as Katsuki wanted to be able to do something, it was in the best hands it could be in.

Aizawa had proven over and over that he’d do what it took to protect their class. There wasn’t a doubt in his mind that had this scenario happened to one of them, he’d still be furious and on a warpath.

But Katsuki also wasn’t stupid. No one who watched the hero and Izuku interact could miss the fact that the man was probably working on adoption papers in his free time.

With that thought in mind, Katsuki turned back to where his friends were hovering and gave them a short nod of his own. Kirishima flashed him a small smile and patted him on the back as he passed, both of them turning to follow him back to the rest of the class.

Katsuki pushed past Iida and Yaoyoruzu carefully and made his way to the closest desk, Ojiro blinking at him with uncertainty as he paused in front of him. The blonde ignored him and grabbed the paper that had started all of this mess off of his desk, frowning down at the words as his mind raced.

Surely all of this hadn't happened in one day, right?

"Bakubro, you okay?" Kirishima asked, pulling Katsuki out of his thoughts. His eyes scanned the class before dropping down to the paper in his hand. Kirishima followed his gaze and frowned, stepping closer to put his hand on the blonde's shoulder gently. "You were attacked by that same villain, weren't you?"

Two years ago Katsuki would have attempted to blow the red head's face off for even mentioning the incident. Now, though, he just nodded numbly and kept his eyes on the paper. The class had the good sense to not push the issue, a hushed kind of murmur filling the room and rolling past Katsuki without touching him.

The paper crumpled in his hand as his fist closed, teeth grit against the rage just beneath the surface of his skin.

"All of this happened because that bastard couldn't be bothered to do his job correctly." Katsuki spit the words out as his free hand flexed at his side. He longed to be able to blow up something more satisfying than this stupid paper.

Nothing was going to be okay until he could either punch All Might in the face himself or Izuku came back and they could all see for themselves that he was okay. Whichever came first.

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The loudest noise in Nezu's office was the sound of All Might's breathing, once he came to. He was sat in a chair in front of the principal's desk, not restrained but smart enough to not to move from the spot he'd woken up in.

Midnight leaned against the wall behind him, examining her nails and every now and then glancing between Nezu and Shouta. The Principal sat at his desk, humming to himself as typed something on his computer.

Shouta leaned against Nezu's desk, arms crossed over his chest and his gaze never wavering from the former number one hero. His quirk wasn't activated, yet, but the tension in his entire body told anyone who looked at him how eager he was for the blonde man to attempt anything he didn't like.

The silence was finally broken as Nezu leaned back from his computer and pushed his chair back enough that he could walk across the surface of his desk and stand almost level with

Shouta. The rat clapped his hands as if trying to get their attention, though only All Might actually looked at him.

“Alrighty, then, time to address the rather large elephant in the room. All Might, you are hereby stripped of your position. I can’t fire out outright, of course, since the commission has been sniffing ever closer to my business lately. However, you will no longer be teaching Class 1A and will instead be taking on a Teaching Assistant position to Vlad King of 1B. Should he have any complaints regarding your behavior, I will personally release the footage of you strangling a minor to the media.”

Nezu’s gaze was sharp as he stared down the former number one hero, hands clasped behind his back. The smile that curved his lips was as close to feral as Shouta had ever scene it and even if it wasn’t completely the outcome that he wanted nor the vengeance he felt was deserved, it was good enough for the time being.

“If things weren’t so tumultuous in our society right now because of your retirement, I would have skipped this conversation all together but with things the way they are we can’t afford to give Shigaraki and All for One’s remaining minions any more ammunition.”

The former number one hero’s mouth hung open slightly, brows furrowing in a way that was no all too familiar to Shouta. All Might sat up in his chair further, trying to straighten to his full height despite the little bit of blood leaking from the corner of his mouth.

“You are going to take the word of a villain over mine?! This is absolutely absurd. I have done nothing wrong!” The man thundered, attempting to push himself out of his seat. He didn’t get far, Midnight coming up behind him and placing a hand on his shoulder.

“I would sit down if I were you, we wouldn’t want to have to tie you down would we?” Her voice was sweet but Shouta could hear the underlying threat in her tone.

Shouta pushed off of the desk and advanced into the former hero’s space, lip curling into a snarl as his hand came up to grasp his capture weapon.

“The only reason we’re not turning you over to the police is that so much time has passed and collecting evidence is impossible now.” Shouta growled the words out, putting himself right up in the man’s face. “You were grossly negligent in caring for a victim on scene, cruel in crushing said already traumatized victim’s dream, and then left said minor alone afterwards.”

The raven haired hero reached out to grab two fistfuls of All Might’s shirt and pulled him closer, making sure they were face to face and the blonde man couldn’t look away from him. The rage that had been simmering under the surface now flowing freely.

He wanted this man to understand exactly what he’d done. Wanted to see him pay for every single stupid mistake he’d made that day that lead his son to believing he was ultimately so worthless he didn’t deserve to live.

“That child, then, decided to throw himself off a bridge because you couldn’t be bothered to prioritize the victim and the rescue. A hero is supposed to protect, All Might, but you were almost the direct cause of his death. You are the reason he became a villain in the first damn

place so stop using that as an excuse to put him down further."
With every word the color drained from the former number one hero's face. As satisfying as it was, it wasn't enough in Shouta's book. If he had his way, he'd burn the man's entire legacy to the ground.

"I….I didn't know…"

At All Might's words, Shouta threw the man the most disgusted look he could manage before letting go of him and stalking back towards Nezu's desk. The rat watched him with an unreadable expression before turning his attention back to All Might.

"Ignorance is no excuse. This matter is far from settled but we need Young Izuku for any further action so you are free to go for the moment. Though, I do advise that you stay on campus. You signed a contract that would have….consequences if you tried to break it and flee from your actions at this juncture."

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The sun had barely set when Izuku slipped through the door of the apartment safehouse, closing it softly behind him in an effort not to alert the neighbors of his presence. In this area of the city everyone tended to mind their own business but he couldn't take any chances.

With a sigh, he rested his forehead against the wood of the door and finally let the tension from his shoulders drop. The encounter with All Might had left him wrung out and anxious all at the same time. He knew he probably should have stayed and dealt with the inevitable fall out but…

He couldn't handle it right this moment. All he wanted to do was curl up in bed and sleep until the whole experience was a bad memory that he could repress for the rest of his life.

If he was honest with himself, he probably wasn't going to leave this hidey hole until he was able to pull himself into the mindset of being able to cover the ring of bruises around his throat. It was bad enough that Katsuki had seen, as it was.

(He wasn't protecting All Might. He wasn't. He was protecting Shouta and Hizashi. If they saw him like this, they'd go to jail for murder and he wan't going to ruin their lives like that.)

"Well, well, well...never expected to see you here, shortstack."

Izuku's entire body tensed at once as the familiar voice sounded from behind him. For a moment, he wondered if maybe the gods hated him. They sure were doing their damndest to ruin his life all at once.

Several moments ticked by before he was able to turn his head enough to peek at the man standing behind him. Dabi looked the same as ever, cocky smirk in place and his entire posture slouched as he leaned against the doorframe of the kitchen.

“I didn’t think you’d be here, either, too busy playing with your new friends.” Izuku couldn’t put heat into his words, all the fight leaving him as he turned to lean his back against the front door. “I needed a place to crash and this was the closest safe house I could remember.”

While Dabi’s posture was relaxed his eyes told a different story. They were cold and maybe a little angry. The sight of them made Izuku’s stomach churn. What right did the fire user have to be angry with him?! He was the one who’d abandoned him, not the other way around.

The longer the silence stretched between them the hotter his anger grew, scalding him from the inside out. He didn’t deserve the silent treatment. He didn’t deserve to be treated like a piece of gum underneath someone’s shoe. He didn’t deserve any of this!

Unable to stand the silence and judgmental stare any longer, Izuku dropped his head back against the door and snarled to himself. His hood fell from his head and pooled around his shoulders, fabric slipping around him like a veil.

“Fuck this. Forget you ever saw me.” He spit, turning to flee.

The doorknob had barely turned in his hand before the other reached him, his grip tight around the wrist he captured. The taller man crowded into his space, trapping him against the door soundly as his other hand came up to push the excess fabric of his hood away from his throat. Izuku flinched as fingertips grazed against the bruises blooming, eyes darting around the area looking for an escape route.

“Which ‘hero’ did this, Izu?” Dabi’s tone was barely restrained rage, eyes trained on the teen with an intensity that made him feel safe and terrified all at once. “I’m gonna burn that school to the ground, I swear to the gods.”

“It’s not like that.” Izuku mumbled, relaxing a little as the other’s hold on his wrist eased and then finally disappeared. At the quirked brow and pointed look at the marks, he shook his head and tried to move away from the door. “You can’t do anything about this”

Izuku pushed gently on the other’s chest to get him to take a step away before carefully skirting around him and heading deeper into the apartment. The taller one followed him, a worried shadow as he passed through the doorway into the living room.

This was one of their more frequently used safe houses, one that Izuku had set up himself from his own funds, so the layout was familiar. He hadn’t been lying when he’d said it had been closest but it was also the one he felt the safest in.

It wasn’t, his traitorous mind supplied, as cozy or safe feeling as the apartment in the dorms but he quickly pushed that thought away. He couldn’t think like that or he’d cave and crawl right back to his newly found parental units and show them a few reasons to commit murder.

Before he could plop down on the sofa, Dabi beat him there and pulled him down next to him. With a grunt, he landed half on the sofa and half in the other’s lap. As badly as he was feeling at the moment, he wanted nothing more to curl up but it was the principal of the matter at this point.

Giving a frustrated little growl, he pushed himself away from him and settled himself near the arm of the sofa.

“Nu-uh. You don’t get cuddle privileges just because you remembered to give a shit.” The teen huffed, pulling his knees up to his chest. ``I'm still mad at you.”

The fire user rolled his eyes and shifted until he was leaning his back against the opposite arm, angling his body so he was facing the teenager. His gaze lingered on his neck, subtle rage still brewing in his eyes. Izuku ignored it and very firmly ignored the way it made him feel warm. He was mad at him, damnit.

“Excuse me, I’m the one who should be mad! Last time I saw you before the mall was when you disappeared into that portal to see All For One! I thought you were dead.” Dabi’s tone was indignant and for one solid second Izuku wanted to feel bad. The next moment, though, it was overshadowed by the anger that had been simmering underneath the surface since that night.

“Thanks for that, by the way, because you opened your mouth I had to answer a ton of questions.” He snapped back, curling up tighter and glaring at the man over his knees.

Dabi knew how much he hated having to offer information to get himself out of trouble. It seemed like that was all he was doing these days, too. Hell, outside of the earth shattering information he just dropped on him, he wasn’t even sure where he and Katsuki stood.

He was pulled out of his thoughts, though, when the man snorted and reached out to tug at the sleeve of his hoodie.

“Yes, because I was thinking clearly after seeing you all cozied up with your precious Kacchan while wearing my clothes.” Dabi’s sneer was angry and as petty as the words were. It made Izuku want to reach out and punch him.

He probably would have if he didn’t recall having to help the man fix his staples on occasion and he really didn’t feel like dealing with that at the moment. Instead, he mustered up all the anger he had simmering underneath the surface and glared at the man, hands fisting in the fabric of his pants.

“You’re such a child! None of this would have happened if you hadn’t abandoned me to go play villain with Shigaraki.” He hissed, the part of him he didn’t like acknowledging satisfied with the shame that crossed the man’s face for a brief moment. “So yeah, when I got arrested and Nezu came knocking, I decided ‘this may as well happen’ since I had nothing to keep me here.”

The word nothing seemed to snap Dabi out of whatever mood he’d been in previously, his head jerking a little as if he’d been slapped. Izuku watched as the fight went out of him little by little until he was slumped against the sofa and frowning unhappily at him.

“What? So you’re some kind of pet for the heroes to make them feel better about themselves?” The man’s tone was bitter, gaze flickering to the bruises he could see peeking over the collar of Izuku’s hoodie. “Or better yet, a punching bag? Easy target practice?”

And as badly as Izuku wanted to be mad at him for the accusation, he couldn’t bring himself to. With Dabi’s past with heroes and his past with his father, it was no wonder he was suspicious and bitter. But he couldn’t let the accusations rest, either.

“No, Nezu offered me a job.” He said softly, uncurling little by little until he was sitting cross legged. “These kids are at a disadvantage and you know it. It’s my job to protect them from you and your people.”

The older man snorted and let his head drop against the back of the sofa for a moment, waving his hand in a dismissive motion.

“Right. So noble of you.”

“Someone once showed me how to survive out here.” Izuku retorted, dropping his gaze down to his hands instead of the man on the other end of the sofa. “There’s no one to do that for them. They mean well, from what I can tell, and I can’t just let them walk out into the mess the world is right now without preparing them for it.”

Peeking up at Dabi, he could see the phrasing of his words had struck a cord the way he’d intended it to. There was hesitance in the way he picked his head up to peer at him. There was also that suspicion still, as well.

“Please, they have the great and powerful All Might to teach them. Why would they want you?” Izuku winced at the phrasing and the way that the first encounter with All Might in the class room swam in front of his eyes for a moment.

“They defended me against him.” He said quietly, lifting up his hands to rub at his eyes quickly to try and clear the image from his minds eye. “Turns out he’s a quirkist piece of shit who demanded I be locked away before I brainwashed the students to the darkside. And all of them pretty much told him where he could shove it.”

Pulling his hands away from his eyes, he peeked over at Dabi once more only to find him staring at him with his mouth hanging open a little. He didn’t look entirely like he believed him but that was fine. He could deal with that. If he hadn’t lived the entire bizarre encounter he probably wouldn’t believe it, either.

Silence fell between them for a few long moments, the teen tugging at a loose thread in the sleeve of his hoodie while the other seemed to contemplate everything Izuku had said. It wasn’t an uncomfortable silence, though, so Izuku let himself relax a little.

Everything between him and Dabi was beyond complicated now. As it had been since the moment Dabi got it in his head that the League was the answer to his Endeavour problem. But even with it being complicated and strained, the fire quirked man was still one of the few people that Izuku trusted wholeheartedly.

If he truely needed the man, all he had to do was call.

Feeling the man's eyes on him again, he lifted his gaze from his hands and sucked in a breath at the rage simmering in the older's eyes. He'd hoped he'd distracted him from the situation at hand but apparently not.

"You sing their praises but here you are, in one of your bolt holes with bruises around your neck." Dabi's voice was low and dangerous as he sat up and leaned forward into Izuku's space again. "Tell me who did it, Izu, and I'll make sure they don't have a hand to put on you ever again."

Izuku hated himself for the reaction those words gave him. He hated the fact that his chest felt warm and tears built up behind his eyes. Wasn't he beyond this childish need for comfort and protection? He'd done more than most teens towards protecting himself. He'd built a name for himself in the underground that made people think twice about crossing him or attempting to fuck him over.

But no. Here he was fighting back tears because he'd been too weak to protect himself and was getting emotional over someone wanting to take care of the problem for him. How much lower could he sink, here?

Pretty damn low, apparently, because he couldn't hold back the floodgate any longer and curled in on himself again with a sob. The tears were hot as they flowed down his cheeks and he hated himself for it.

So lost in his pain and misery he almost didn't register the fact that Dabi had reached out for him, gently pulling him into his lap and tucking him under his chin. Once his brain caught up with what was going on, one of his hands came up to curl into the fabric of the other's jacket and hold onto it for dear life.

He couldn't make out anything the man was saying but his voice soothed him a little, one of the scarred man's hands coming up to card through his hair gently. For a brief moment, he was that kid who jumped again. He was that kid again being told that he mattered and he didn't have to go back to the life that brought him nothing but pain.

This was why he could never stay mad at Dabi, no matter the bone headed shit he pulled. Yes, he was angry and hurt that the man decided to join up with the person he hated most in the world. Yes, he had been scared of being on his own first the first actual time in his life and carried all of the anger that it inspired still.

But everything they'd been through together made it impossible for him to not forgive it so they could move on.

(If he wanted to look closer at that feeling, it was also the same kind of thing he had with Kacchan. These two were just people he couldn't survive without, somehow. Was it healthy? Not a chance. Did he care? Not really.)

He couldn't tell you if it took an hour or a few minutes for his sobs to slow or his eyes to dry finally. He was so exhausted, physically and mentally, that all he could do was let himself

relax against Dabi and let his eyes close finally. The man was still petting his hair, quiet now as if he'd run out of words at some point.

Izuku could hear the other's heartbeat beneath his ear and relaxed further listening to it. It was familiar and soothing all at once to know that Dabi was alive and here with him. As much as he didn't want to admit it, he missed the feeling of being absolutely certain of that fact.

"It was All Might…" Izuku's voice was barely a whisper as he said it, fingers clenching around Dabi's jacket tighter.

The man's questioning hum resonated through his chest and echoed in Izuku's ear as he grasped at the strands of his courage before they disintegrated.

"My neck, it was All Might." His voice shook a little as he resisted the urge to curl into a ball once more. "I basically laid all of the information out in front of the class about what he did that day and when Kacchan and Shouto figured it out, he attacked me. Seems to think I've got some mission from All for One to corrupt the children."

Dabi's entire body was tense by the time Izuku was done speaking and he wasn't sure if it was from the information he'd just dumped in his lap or at the mention of his brother. The silence was heavy the longer it dragged on but Izuku was too exhausted to pick his head up and try and figure out exactly what the other was thinking.

"Shouto figured it out first?" Dabi's voice held a note of pride in it, not that the burned man would ever admit it out loud. The question drew a small chuckle from the teen as he shifted a little to get more comfortable against Dabi's chest.

"Yeah, he basically told Kacchan to stop being an idiot. There aren't a lot of people who can create wind pressure with just a punch."

Dabi hummed again, hand slipping out of Izuku's hair to rub over his back gently. They lapsed into silence again, this time comfortable in each others presence like they hadn't been in months. If Izuku didn't think too hard it could almost be just like none of the bad had ever happened.

"...I can try and kill All Might for you, if you want. What's one more top hero?" Dabi said after a little while, his words breaking through the sleepy haze that was taking over Izuku's thoughts.

"Nah, I think Shouta is gonna do that for you." The teen responded, jaw cracking a little as he yawned after the words were out of his mouth.

It drew a snort from the man and Izuku flipped him off, groaning as he shifted again in an attempt to get comfortable.

"Shouta? As in Aizawa Shouta, Eraserhead?" Dabi's voice was amused and teasing as he shifted them both so that he was stretched out on the sofa and Izuku was laying on top of him.

“Mmhm. ‘s my dad now.” The teen mumbled, nuzzling his face into Dabi’s shirt sleepily and settling finally. “I call him Dadzawa in my head. Don’t tell him, though, he’ll find it offensive.”

“I absolutely am not telling him anything, Izu. Now go to sleep.”

“M’kay Toucchan…”

The villain just laughed quietly and dragged his fingers through Izuku’s hair, luring him deeper and deeper into the haze that was settling over his thoughts. He almost wanted to fight against sleep in an attempt to soak up as much of the time he was going to get like this with Dabi but the exhaustion of the day pulled at his mind.

He could have sworn as he went under finally that he felt Dabi’s lips press against the top of his head in a light kiss but when he awoke, he wouldn’t remember the fleeting feeling.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! I'm not entirely sure if I'm happy with it or not but I can't stand to look at it any more. I saw quite a few people saying All Might should be arrested but honestly, hero society couldn't handle his forced retirement and then arrest so soon together. So no arrest no matter how much they want to throw him in cell next to AFO.

I really, really, enjoyed getting to write Dabi and Izuku interacting honestly. Their dynamic is so complicated and interesting that I could probably fill a whole other fic with just them tbh.

Let me know what you thought, as always! Comments fuel faster writing <3

Every light in the house is on

Chapter Summary

All Izuku wants to do is get cuddles. What he gets is struggles.

Chapter Notes

This chapter is on the shorter side but I procrastinated hard on actually writing it so this is the best I've got tonight lol As always, I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Hours later, Izuku woke with a start as his phone began to loudly ring. It wasn't a ringtone that he'd ever set but only the gods themselves knew what the support department put into his phone at Nezu's insistence.

He was sluggish and groggy as he wiggled around trying to get his hand into his pocket enough to pull the offending gadget out. Dabi groaned as Izuku's knee dug into his stomach and he made a motion to push the smaller male off of him. Izuku clung to him with his free hand, refusing to be dislodged.

"Turn that damn thing off." The scarred man growled, still attempting to push Izuku off of him.

Izuku finally managed to pull his phone free and silenced it quickly. Ignoring the grumbling man he was laying on, he sat up fully and squinted down at his phone. It took his eyes a moment to adjust to the harsh light of the phone in the pitch black living room but once he did his stomach dropped.

There were at least a dozen missed calls from Kacchan and thirty from Hizashi.

"Fuck." Izuku said emphatically, dropping his phone onto Dabi's chest and burying his own face in his hands. "I'm in so much trouble."

Dabi squinted up at him, shifting so he could drag his fingers through his own hair before reaching to pick up Izuku's phone off of his chest. He flipped it over and let out a low whistle. It turned into a laugh when Izuku whined and swiped his phone out of the man's hand.

“I slept for so long. I didn’t mean to!” The teen whined a little more before climbing off of the sofa and slipping his phone back into his pocket. He wasn’t going to call them back just yet, not with Dabi sitting up on the sofa and watching him the way he was. There was no telling what the man would say just to embarrass him or get him into even more trouble.

“Awww. Daddy’s calling? Gotta run back to your little heroes.” The edge was back in Dabi’s voice and Izuku paused for a second to look at the man seriously.

The man in question was sitting on the edge of the sofa not looking at Izuku, shoulders hunched and posture tight. The teen couldn’t help but sigh quietly to himself because after their little talk he’d hoped that they were on better footing now.

But when did he ever get what he wanted fully?

“Just because I have to go back doesn’t mean I’m leaving entirely.” Izuku said softly, stuffing his hands in his pockets and kicking at the man’s boot gently.

The man looked up at him finally, disbelief written all over his face.
“Right. Because we can so easily hang out. I’ll come visit U.A one day, it’ll be great.” He snarked, leaning back heavily against the back of the sofa. Izuku kind of wanted to punch him again.

“Phones exist. And as everyone keeps forgetting, I excel at skirting around and breaking rules.” Izuku ground out, turning on his heel and stalking into the kitchen of the safe house. He could hear Dabi getting up and following him but he paid no mind as he searched around for what he was looking for.

Pulling out an old discarded notebook from one of the drawers, he hastily scribbled down his phone number before turning to push it into Dabi’s chest.

“There. Now you have a way to contact me.” He huffed, watching as Dabi rolled his eyes and set the notebook to the side. “Don’t make me hunt you down, Dabi, because I will.”

The man rolled his eyes and reached out to grab the back of Izuku’s hoodie, hauling him in for a quick hug. The teen sagged into it for a moment before wiggling away and dancing backwards towards the front door of the apartment.

“You act like I wasn’t the one who taught you how to hunt people down, brat.” Dabi grumbled, crossing his arms over his chest and drawing a quiet laugh from the teen.

As much as he wanted to stay and soak up as much time as he could not fighting with Dabi, there was no way Hizashi and Shouta weren’t worried sick after that many missed calls.

“Yeah, yeah, kid go on. Be sure to tell the Bakugo brat I said hi.” Dabi drawled, waving him away as he leaned against the counter.

Izuku stuck his tongue out at him as he cracked open the door, one foot outside the door already.

“I will not be doing that, you petty bitch. Bye!”

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Shouta watched his husband pace back and forth across the living room from the sofa, one of the cats in his lap, and tried not to lose his mind. He could see the phone in Hizashi's hand and see him already dialing Izuku's number again.

It'd been like this for the past hour and a half.

Granted, yes, Shouta was a little worried as well despite Nezu's assurances that Izuku would return soon. The Principal might be a genius but Shouta and Hizashi dealt with traumatized teenagers on a daily basis. Sure, their kid had a little bit more spice than the others but it was the same idea.

The volume of Hizashi's frustrated growl instinctively had Shouta's quirk flaring, even as his husband whirled around to glare at him.

"He will be fine, 'Zashi." Shouta soothed, getting off of the sofa and walking over to his husband. The blonde sagged a little, worry written all over his face as his gaze skittered back down to his phone.

The raven haired man sighed a little and gently pried the phone out of Hizashi's hands, lips quirking up into a sad smile as the man's gaze flew to his own. He gave the man's hand a squeeze before tangling their fingers together gently.

"Worrying like this isn't going to make anything better." He said softly, quietly relieved when Hizashi let him lead him towards the sofa. "We have to trust that he'll come back when he's ready. He's capable enough to handle himself until then."

The blonde's whine as he was pulled down onto the sofa next to Shouta bordered on quirk usage. He did let Shouta pull him closer, though, burying his face into his husband's shoulder as he tried to pull himself together.

"I can't just not worry about our kid, Sho We just got him to open up and trust us and now this! What if he decides it's not worth it and w.e never see him again?"

Shouta was quiet for a moment, running his free hand through Hizashi's hair as he thought of a good answer for that. Sure, the kid could decide that being this close to All Might was a risk he wasn't willing to take. Neither of them could blame him.

But even only knowing the boy for a few weeks, Shouta already knew that neither he nor Hizashi were going to be able to let Izuku just walk away from them. He also knew that if he didn't want to be found it was going to be absolute hell to track him back down.

He was pulled out of his ponderings about that potential problem by Hizashi's phone ringing. Both of them jumped a little in surprise and Shouta fumbled to pick the phone back up out of his lap.

Flipping the phone over, the caller I.D read Izuku's number.

Shoata couldn't remember a time he answered a phone call faster. Before he even said a word, the set the call to speaker and held the phone between him and Hizashi.

"Izuku! Are you okay? We've been worried sick." Hizashi exclaimed, one of his hands coming up to wrap around Shouta's wrist and pull the phone closer to him.

There was a beat of silence on the other end and then a small laugh. The sound of it sent shivers up and down Shouta's spine and raised every hair on the back of his neck. Something was wrong. Something was horribly wrong.

"I'm sorry to add onto it, Papamic." Izuku's voice was strained and instantly both of them were leaning closer to the phone to try and listen for anything telling in the background of the call. "You see, I was on my way back to the school but there's someone following me."

Ice slid down Shouta's spine at the words and he was instantly reaching for his own phone and sending half spelled text to Nezu about tracking Izuku's phone. He hadn't bothered with the feature up until now but…

"Who's following you? Can you get a description of them?" Shouta could feel himself slipping into work mode, trying not to focus on all of the bad outcomes that could happen in this situation.

"I can do you one better. I have a name." Izuku's voice was strained and Shouta could hear in his quick breaths that he was spooked.

"Who is it?" Hizashi's voice was as soft as he could make it in the moment, obviously trying to keep his quirk under control as his emotions flew all over the place. His hand was tight around Shouta's wrist as he fought to keep professional and calm for Izuku.

"Toga Himiko. She's not disguised or anything and she's gaining. Fairly sure they plan on warping me away to wherever they're hiding out right now." Izuku's breath picked up a little and Shouta's heart froze in his chest at the sound. "I don't have any weapons and I know for a fact she has at least three. She's going to take me. Track the phone, I'll try and hide it before she gets to me."

"Izuk-"

"Dad, I'm sorry but I've gotta be smarter here. I've got a plan. Track the phone."

The call ended and both Shouta and Hizashi stared down at the phone in disbelief.

The League had Izuku.

Their kid was in the clutches of the people that had been giving them hell and traumatizing the hero class since damn near the first day of school. People that were as much Izuku's enemies as they were U.A's.

"Sho, this can't be happening. Tell me it's not happening." Hizashi's voice was a hair's breadth away from being a full on sob.
Shouta couldn't say anything, instead letting Hizashi's phone drop into his lap as he picked

up his own. Nezu hadn't said anything yet but he'd read the message. The rat was no doubt running the program needed to track the phone now.

They would get Izuku back no matter what.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Izuku came to slowly, head lolling against his chest a little as he struggled to bring himself back into consciousness. A small tug of his wrists and ankles confirmed that he was tried down to the chair he was sitting in.

The last thing he remembered was hanging up on Shouta and stuffing his phone into the inner pocket of his hoodie. He'd turned around to maybe try and talk his way out of the situation to find Toga closer than anticipated…

And then everything was dark.

Now that he was aware, a groggy haze had settled in over his mind and for a moment he worried that he'd been drugged. However, when he went to lift his head his worries of drugs were assuaged by the dull throbbing in the back of his head.

So Toga had opted to knock him out. Interesting. That usually wasn't her go to.

At least he didn't have any cuts he could feel where she might have collected blood. So he was safe from whatever havoc she could cause using his face.

Done taking stock of his body and situation, he tried to listen for any nearby voices or anything to give him an indication of what he was going to be opening his eyes to. The room was silent aside from the swish of fabric of someone moving around the space quietly.

One guard then? Depending on who it was, that could be good or bad.

If it was just Shigaraki he could probably annoy his way out of this chair and thus out of this situation.

Anyone else? There was no telling what the rest of the League thought of him.

The thought of the rest of the league had his stomach sinking down to his knees. Had Dabi known about this plan? Had he purposely kept Izuku at the safe house to make sure they had time to grab him?

Surely not. No one outside of 1A even knew he'd left the school. Hell, no one outside of Dabi even knew he was anywhere near the school.
So what was this about?

Finally sick of all the questions piling up with no answer, Izuku cracked his eyes open and bit back a curse as the light hit his eyes.

Definitely a little bit of a concussion, then.

Once his eyes adjusted, he could see he was in some sort of kitchen. The soft sounds of fabric moving turned out to be Kurogiri moving around the area. It definitely was a new hide out, then, because Izuku didn't recognize anything about the place.

Altered by his movements, Kurogiri turned to look at Izuku. He couldn't make out the expression on the man's face, the mist that was his head as hard to read as ever. There was a slump of his shoulders though that told Izuku what he needed to know.

This was bad.

Kurogiri was going to follow orders. Always had. So this had been ordered from Shigaraki himself because the man didn't seem all that thrilled about whatever it was that he had to do now that Izuku was awake.

"My apologies, Izuku, but Tomura wishes to speak with you now that you're awake." The words were punctuated by a warp gate opening up underneath Izuku's chair.

The teen barely managed to form a thought before he was falling through the portal and landing on solid ground with a resounding crack of the legs hitting the floor. Unluckily for him, it seemed someone had chosen a sturdy chair because the wood underneath him barely even ground at the sudden movement.

Izuku on the other hand let out a few choice curses as pain washed through him. Before he opened his eyes again he had several very colorful ways thought up of how he was going to murder Shigaraki for this.

He could be at home right now getting cuddles from his fathers. This was a crime of the highest magnitude and he would make sure Shigaraki understood that by the end of the night.

Cracking his eyes open, the first thing he saw was Shigaraki himself standing up from the chair he'd been sitting in and advancing towards him with a crooked grin. Vaguely, Izuku could tell that this was a living space of some kind. There were sofa's and chairs strewn across the area and a tv sat against a nearby wall. It wasn't on but Izuku caught a glimpse of a gaming console set up underneath it.

The next thing Izuku noticed was the entirety of the League piled around the room, either sitting on sofas or leaning against walls. All of them watched him with thinly veiled curiosity as his eyes bounced between all of them and then back to Shigaraki.

At least Dabi looked sufficiently surprised to see him. Izuku could probably rule out his involvement in this little scheme.

Probably.

"Izuku, so good to see you." Shigaraki rasped as he advanced towards him, grin turning wild and feral as he loomed over the seated teenager. "I'm so glad you could join us. I have some questions for you."

Chapter End Notes

And so starts a new arch! I've tentatively named it the 'Shigaraki fucks around and finds out' era lol

I hope you enjoyed! Come hang out with me on Discord and on Tiktok @EmbeddedFiction!

As always, your input drives the actual writing. <3

Friends in low places

Chapter Summary

Izuku has no filter and Dabi wonders how he got here

Chapter Notes

I suck at writing action and all Izuku wanted to do was be a sassmaster. So this is how this is turning out lol

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It took every bit of self control that Dabi had to keep his expression frozen in the moment that he realized who exactly was tied to the chair in front of them.

Shigaraki had been going on and on about a guest that Toga had grabbed on her way home but the asshole hadn't given a name. Just a play by play description of which body parts he was going to decay first. Which, you know, gross.

At the time, though, Dabi was in a bad enough mood that he was looking forward to having some one on one information gathering time with whoever it was. It would be a good distraction from the burning sensation in his chest at having to watch Izuku walk out of that front door. It would be a good distraction from Izuku and that entire situation in general, really.

Now, though? His mood was exponentially worse.

Briefly he wondered if he should have found a way to warn Eraserhead or the rat principal that Izuku damn near needed a leash to keep him out of trouble.

The amount of times he'd had to drag the kid out of stupid situations by the back of his hoodie were beyond counting at this point. Even after the kid had made a name for himself in the underground he still managed to stumble his way into stupid situations. Why had anyone let him out and about unsupervised clearly hadn't known him that well or for very long.

Oh, right! They hadn't.

Obviously even his precious Kacchan didn't know better than to let the kid wander off on his own.

So now he was in this predicament, watching as Shigaraki approached the teenager. Even from where he was sitting, Dabi would see that Izuku was testing the bonds on his wrists even as he glared up at the silver haired man child.

None of this was going to end well.

If Dabi had to guess it was going to end with someone bleeding and at least one room of their brand new hide out on fire.

“I’m glad you could join us. I have some questions for you.” Shigaraki rasped as he stopped in front of Izuku, his entire posture and tone smug. As if he’d done something here instead of happened upon an opportunity.

This was a comedy of errors that could only come out of stupid, random, chance and the universe’s hatred of Dabi’s peace of mind.

Izuku seemed to take in his words before slumping as much as he could in his bonds and rolling his head back against the chair. He was the picture of teenage sass, eye roll included as he picked his head back up and motioned as exaggeratedly as he could with his hands bound.

“You see, when a psycho mommy and a sociopath daddy hate each other very much…” The teen began pausing to scowl up at Shigaraki through his bangs. “....well…I honestly don’t think you need to know the rest, buddy, since it won’t apply to you. No one’s going to want to kiss that ugly mug anytime soon. Might I suggest some chapstick?”

Scratch that, the entire damn building was going to be on fire.

If Dabi were less self aware he’d wonder what he’d done to deserve this hell. He’d done a lot of bad in his life but really? Did he deserve this?

How did he get stuck with this kid? Out of all of the dumbass teenagers he could have pulled out of a river it had to be this one who had no self preservation, a flair for the dramatic, and chaos etched into his very being.

He was pulled out of his musings, though, by the snarl that left Shigaraki at the teen’s words. Every hair left on Dabi’s arms raised and he found himself watching in slow motion as the man began to strip off of the artist gloves he’d begun donning after Kamino. Shigaraki’s entire frame screamed murderous and that did not spell good things for the subject of his ire at the moment. Especially since Dabi knew for a fact that Izuku had no weapons on him and no way out of his bonds.

He very obviously had a choice to make here. He could protect the kid and go against Shigaraki which would have lasting repercussions for his plan to destroy his father. Even as much as Izuku protested, this group had been the best way he could find to get the attention he needed for his plans. Who was going to listen to some random thug screaming about the newly minted number one hero? Nobody, that’s who.

His entire revenge plan hinged on the attention this group could garner. Even if the leader was a giant man child.

His only other option, though, was to let Shigaraki beat and possibly kill the closest thing he had to a real and honest relationship. Dabi hadn't spent two odd years keeping the gremlin alive to just sit here while someone put their hands on him. As if he could, if he was honest with himself. He remembered the blind rage that had settled in his gut at the sight of the bruises around Izuku's throat.

There really was no choice, here.

Earlier, in the safe house, he'd offered to kill the former number one hero for the kid. What was Shigaraki compared to that?

The entire world had narrowed down to Shigaraki and Izuku, Dabi's vision tunneling down until he couldn't even hear what the crusty villain was ranting about. All he could see was him looming over Izuku who was refusing to look to him for help. He was terrified, Dabi could see it in the way that his hands were curled around the arms of the chair in an attempt to keep his nerves from showing.

And yet he refused to look at the one person in the room that would possibly be willing to help him.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Izuku had a feeling he'd fucked up royally when the gloves Shigaraki were wearing started to be peeled away. It wouldn't be the first time his quirk had been used on him but by god it was the scariest.

There was a feral light in Shigaraki's eyes that did not bode well for Izuku. It wasn't one that he was familiar with seeing in the silver haired man and briefly Izuku wondered if he'd miscalculated. It didn't usually take this little to set him off this badly.

Something was very, very, wrong and Izuku didn't have enough information to figure out where he'd mistepped here.

"You stupid little bastard." Shigaraki growled, throwing one glove down onto the ground and flexing his fingers as he took another step closer to Izuku. "What makes you so special, huh? You'll be dust just like anyone else if I wrap my hands around your neck."

"While that sounds kinky, good for you by the way didn't know you had it in you, I'm going to have to decline." Izuku responded out of reflex, mentally cursing himself as the words slipped out of his mouth. "I am still a minor, you know."

The snarl that left Shigaraki's throat was feral and Izuku had a brief moment to wonder if Kacchan and his dads would miss him much as he watched Shigarki's hand in slow motion lift towards his face.

Blindingly fast, a hand came out of nowhere to grip Shigaraki's wrist and stopped the man in his tracks. Izuku couldn't tear his eyes away from the purple scars on his savior's hand for a moment to see the look on Shigaraki's face but the absolute rage in his voice when he spoke painted a clear enough picture.

"What exactly do you think you're doing, Dabi?" The silver haired man practically spit the words at the scarred man, red eyes boring into him with a frightening intensity.

Izuku found the courage to finally look at Dabi and found him in a staring contest with his so called boss, lip curling into his signature sneer as he forced the younger man back a few steps by the grip he still had on his wrist until Izuku's entire field of vision was filled with the back of Dabi's coat.

"Making sure you don't undo three years of hard work, crusty." Dabi drawled, posture relaxed as his grip tightened on the other's wrist. "I can't have you killing him after I've done all this work to keep his stupid ass alive."

"Hey! I did some of the work too, you know!" Izuku sassed, slumping in his bonds a little in relief. "Also, nice timing. Was actually sure I was going to die in the lamest way possible there for a second."

"What is this?!" Shigaraki broke free of Dabi's hold with a sharp yank of his arm, surprising the man who'd turned his attention back to Izuku briefly.

"When two people love each other very mu-"

"SHUT UP."

Shigaraki's scream was full of rage as he ripped off his other glove and flexed his fingers, hands just barely stopping before they curled into fists. His entire chest heaved as he glared at the two of them, rage rising from a simmer to a boil in his eyes and posture.

Dabi's nonchalance fell away, his entire posture changing as his own hands came up as he raised his defenses. Behind Shigaraki the rest of the league shifted, their gazes bouncing between Dabi and Shigaraki like they were watching a tennis match. No one made a move to get between them, though, so Izuku was taking that as a good sign at least.

Out of the corner of his eye he caught a flash of metal before a knife was entering his peripheral vision.

He would absolutely admit to the yelp of surprise as the knife slashed through the ties holding his arm to the chair, later. A delighted giggle sounded from just behind the chair before Toga stepped into his view and reached for the bonds holding his other hand in place.

A glance towards Shigaraki and Dabi told him that neither of them had heard, locked in their own little world at the moment. Izuku and Toga were hidden from sight behind Dabi's back. Neither of them seemed to notice Toga cutting Izuku loose.

The teen glanced back at the blonde girl and before he could voice his question, she raised a finger up to her lips and flashed him a demented smile.

“You’re betraying us for him. Sensei keeps talking about him and asking for him. Even that explosion kid was more focused on him than me! Deku this, Izuku that. What is so special about him that everyone is only paying attention to him?! I don’t get it.” Shigaraki snarled, hands coming up to scratch at his throat unhappily. “Useless. Stupid. I want to kill him and make all of you choke on his dust.”

In another world, Izuku would be smart and take this opportunity to disappear. He would let Toga lead him away while every eye in the room was on Shigaraki and his meltdown. Dabi could more than handle himself against the man and would probably follow him eventually. They could meet back up at the safe house later, after Izuku had called his dads and given them the location to pick him up at. Everything would be fine and he could go back to U.A and business as usual.

However, that was in a universe where Izuku had just a shred more self preservation. A universe where he was built with a little less chaos in his veins.

So Izuku did none of that.

Izuku, despite Toga’s hand on his sleeve tugging insistently, stepped up so he was peeking out from behind Dabi. One hand on the scarred man’s arm and the other waving Toga away behind the taller man’s back.

“That is the grossest thing I’ve ever heard you say, Shiggy. Which, you know, congrats because ewww.” Izuku could feel Dabi tense in front of him as Shigaraki’s eyes landed on Izuku and his face twisted into something terrifying.

Blue flames licked at Dabi’s hands as Shigaraki took several steps forward, advancing on them with hands raised. The sight of the flames gave him pause and his rage filled gaze trained solely on Dabi again with an intensity that Izuku honestly doubted the man capable of before today.

“Take one more step towards him and you’re going to become Barbecue, crusty.” Dabi drawled, letting his flames dance around his fingers to illustrate his point. “Consider this my resignation.”

“Mine too!” Toga chimed in, leaning out into sight on Dabi’s other side and giving a small little wave to the now growling Shigaraki. “I like Izuchan more than you. He’s cute and I might get to see him covered in blood again.”

Izuku couldn’t help the hysterical little giggle that left him as he caught sight of Dabi’s face after Toga’s declaration. It didn’t seem to do anything for Shigaraki’s temper but he couldn’t help it.

In the past twenty four hours he’d gone up against All Might and won, been kidnapped, and then been saved by the two least likely people in the building.

What else could go wrong?

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! Another short one but like I said, action is my weakest writing skill and Izuku refuses to work with me lol.

Next time, Erasermic and Bakugo to the rescue!

Let me know what you thought C:

I wish you'd come with me

Chapter Notes

> Merry Christmas to those who celebrate it! I hope you enjoy this chapter and have a wonderful holiday season!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Okay, so, I’m kinda tired and really done with this entire situation.” Izuku began, stepping out from behind Dabi and shoving his hands into his pockets. “I would like to go home, it’s been a really long day.”

His gaze jumped from Shigaraki to the rest of the League hovering around the rest of the room. None of them looked particularly like they wanted to jump into the middle of the situation unfolding around them. Vaguely, Izuku could make out the hazy form of Kurogi towards the back of the room.

It figured that he’d be waiting in the wings to step in if Izuku actually made a move towards Shigaraki.

Typical.

Next to him, Dabi shifted a little and Izuku glanced over to find the man staring at him. His brow was cocked and everything in his expression was questioning. It wasn’t the first time he’d seen the look and he doubted it would be the last. Dabi wanted to know how he thought he was going to progress forward in this situation and was understandably concerned about what Izuku was about to do.

Because while, yes, most of his plans went off without a hitch there were times like this where the situation called for a little…chaos.

Izuku let his lips pull up in a grin as he turned away from Dabi and addressed the room, fully ignoring Shigaraki’s existence for the moment. Something he knew the man loathed.

“So. I don’t know any of you personally but most of you have seen me before, yes? Good. I’m going to give you one warning here, ladies and gentlemen.” Izuku let his gaze bounce around to each of the members present before making a sweeping hand motion. “Get out. Leave this idiot behind. It’s in your best interests to vacate this shit show now because when I burn this little club to the ground, anyone who’s connected with Crusty the Assclown here is getting thrown on the pire with him.”

It felt like the temperature in the room dropped several degrees at his proclamation but Izuku's smile stayed in place even as Shigaraki began to snarl at him again, advancing towards him menacingly.

He had a point to make and by the gods was he going to drive it home.

"Good talk. Please be smart and don't ruin your life over a man child who only cares about destruction."

When Izuku finally looked at Shigaraki and acknowledged the man, he was closer than was comfortable. The look in his red eyes screamed murder and at Izuku's side, Dabi's flames licked up higher in response.

"Hey Toga, got a knife I can borrow?" He quipped, looking away from Shigaraki to the blonde girl who just cackled and reached into her pockets.

"Kid, you're fucking insane and I hate you. I want that on the record." Dabi grit out, stepping in front of Izuku again to block Shigaraki from advancing any further towards him.

Izuku didn't answer him, instead cackling to himself when Toga produced a knife and handed it over to him.

Vaguely he wondered how much of the building was going to survive after this.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

When Shouta, Hizashi, and Bakugo arrived at the address that Nezu had procured, there were a million possibilities for what they would find.

Every possible scenario flipped through Shouta's brain at full speed and he'd not even argued against Bakugo coming when the blond had practically kicked down the door to Nezu's office and demanded he be included in the rescue mission.

Given past experiences, if Shouta had said no he probably would have found half of the class at the address when they arrived. He didn't have the patience to deal with that tonight of all nights so he told the teen to suit up and be waiting at the gates.

As they raced across the city he tried his best to keep his mind clear and not think about every little thing that could be going wrong right now. His mind kept conjuring up the image of the hand shaped scar along Izuku's collar bone and throat and all of the implications that it provided.

Izuku hadn't been fast enough to evade the villain once, probably to near fatal results. Would he be fast enough now?

Would there be anything for them to find when the reached the hideout?

He couldn't focus on those thoughts, though, and tried his best to be logical.

Surely Izuku was smart enough to be able to stall for time. Surely he could use his connections in the League to his advantage.

Surely Dabi wouldn't let Shigaraki kill him, right?

Even Shouta knew his was desperately grasping at straws with that line of thought. Yes, Izuku had said the man had saved him but Shouta didn't have enough details there to be able to postulate what kind of relationship the two had.

All he could do was pray as they sped around corners and probably racked up a million speeding tickets as Hizashi blew red light after red light.

So when they pulled up to the address, he was not expecting the sight in front of him.

Nothing could have prepared him for the sight of the building on fire and Izuku sitting on the ground in front of it with Dabi and Toga standing next to him.

From inside the car he couldn't hear what they were saying but he watched in almost morbid fascination as Toga threw her head back to laugh as Izuku flipped Dabi off and gestured wildly at the building at the same time.

Shouta barely waited for the car to fully stop before he threw the door open and jumped out. The moment his feet touched the ground he was running towards the three of them at full speed, eyes locked on Izuku.

He knew the exact moment Izuku recognized him and realized what it meant. The teen practically jumped up off of the ground, stumbling a little to get his balance, before bodily putting himself between Shouta and the two villains.

"Dad, wait! It's not what it looks like I sw-"

The teen didn't get to finish his sentence because Shouta finally reached him, pulling him into a bone crushing hug and tucking the teen under his chin. Vaguely, Shouta could hear the kid sputtering a little before his arms came up to wrap around him and his fingers dug into Shouta's back painfully.

Behind him, he could hear Hizashi and Bakugo pause and take in the scene in front of them.

The building had obviously been condemned before tonight, the buildings around it just as run down and dilapidated as it once was. Now, though, it was engulfed in blue and red flames. The sound of the flames covered up the silence that fell heavily between the two groups as Shouta pulled back and held Izuku at arms length.

The kid looked a little worse for wear, his hoodie ripped and singed to the point that it was barely holding onto his thin frame. Injuries wise, though, at first glance he seemed to be okay. There looked to be some minor burns around his hands and face but that wasn't what drew Shouta's gaze.

It was the ring of bruises around his throat.

Bruises that were far, far, more along than they should have been if they were inflicted in the few hours that the kid had been with the League.

For a brief moment, Shouta regretted not slamming his knee into All Might's face.

However, his attention was pulled away by Hizashi who seemed to be pulled out of his state of shock and was wiggling his way between Shouta and Izuku to give the boy a hug. It was enough to pull Shouta back into the moment and he quickly snapped his gaze to the two villains standing a few feet away from them.

Toga was grinning, rocking back and forth on her heels as she watched Izuku and Hizashi. Shouta mentally cataloged her injuries, noting that her school uniform was disintegrated in several places and she seemed to be sporting minor burns as well.

No, the worst of the injuries seemed to have gone to Dabi. Blood was leaking down his face slowly, several staples having been either knocked out or pulled out during the fight. The lower half of the man's face was purple and red mostly and if the way he was holding himself was any indicator there were probably more injuries hidden by his coat.

The injuries, though, weren't Shouta's main concern at the moment. No, he was more concerned about the staring match that was going on between Bakugo and the villain. Both of them were tense and looked ready to leap at the other at the slightest wrong movement.

The tension was palpable enough that Izuku seemed to feel it as well, pulling away from where Hizashi was fussing over him enough to glance between the both of them nervously.

Bakugo broke eye contact first, surprising Shouta, after giving the fire quirked villain a short, sharp, nod. Seemingly done with whatever weird thing he'd initiated, the blonde teen stomped his way over to Izuku and pulled him into a bone crushing hug. Shouta didn't miss the way Izuku sagged into the other teen, either.

He was going to have to remind Izuku later, after everything had settled, about the 'no loud blondes' rule. And maybe make a 'no fire quirks' rule as well if the way Dabi was staring at the two of them was anything to go by.

Shouta could already feel the headache coming on from the soap opera levels of drama just waiting in the wings right now.

Izuku pulled away from Bakugo slowly, finally turning to face Shouta again with a determined look on his face. A look that did not bode well for his blood pressure, he was sure.

"This wasn't their fault. They broke me out and fought Shigaraki. The fire just…kinda got out of control." The teen's eyes briefly flickered over to Dabi who had crossed his arms over his chest and was glaring definitely at both Shouta and Hizashi.
Shouta would admit in the moment that he had no idea what to do about the man. The picture that as being painted of the man at the moment was far more than he'd anticipated and he wasn't sure he was comfortable with the light he was seeing the man in.

“We’re not assigning blame to anyone but The League right now, Izuku.” Shouta said after a moment, letting his shoulders creep up enough to hide most of his face in his capture weapon. “I’m willing to turn a blind eye to the property damage so long as I’m not given a reason to make any arrests from this moment forward.”

His words had the desired effect of draining the tension out of Izuku’s shoulders. The teen practically fell over, prompting Bakugo to reach out and steady him.

“Come on, let’s go get you some medical attention.” Hizashi said gently, making shooing motions towards the car at the teen.

Izuku’s head shot up again and immediately he was shaking his head and gesturing towards Dabi.

“I’m fine! He needs it more than I do!”

Hizashi glanced towards Shouta and then back towards the man who was currently trying to pull his jacket up enough to cover his face as if the two pro heroes hadn’t already seen the blood dripping down the bottom half of his face.

“Okay, Izuku. I’m sure Recovery Girl can do something…”

“Fuck that.” The man cut Hizashi off, dropping his jacket and scowling at the blonde. “I step one foot into U.A and I’m never going to be seen again. No thanks.”

Shouta and Hizashi exchanged looks again and Shouta was once again forced to feel a begrudging respect for the villain. Or whatever he was. Because he was right, honestly. Even with saving Izuku tonight the man had attacked the school once and taken a student. There was no way that Nezu was going to just let him walk out of the grounds scott free.

The rat could hold a grudge.

Izuku stumbled forward a few steps, shaking off Bakugo’s hold on him. His mouth opened and closed a few times, obviously trying to figure something out. He seemed to come to the same conclusion that Shouta had about the school, shoulders slumping again with the realization.

Then he started looking around. It took Shouta a moment to realize that he was trying to place exactly where they were. Whatever he saw seemed to perk him up a little as he turned back towards Dabi.

“Granny is still near here, right? She can patch you up.”

Dabi shook his head, shoving his hands in his pockets and rocking back on the balls of his feet.

“I used my last favor with her when your appendix burst, remember?”

The statement had the attention of the rescue squad, brows furrowed from the younger blonde and worried glances between the two adults. Izuku, though, didn't seem to be perturbed by the information, instead waving his hand dismissively.

"She owes me a few favors still from when I got those supplies for her last winter. Just use those. The last thing your musty ass needs is to get an infection." Izuku shot back, flashing a grin to show that he was joking at least a little bit.

The dark haired man seemed to think it over for a second before nodding. Shouta watched in almost horrified fascination as Izuku's grin grew wider and the teen seemed to stop himself from moving closer to the scarred and currently bleeding man. Green eyes met black and then darted away upon the realization that Shouta was watching his every move carefully.

Toga, however, broke the moment by bouncing up to Izuku and thrusting his phone into his hands with a wide grin. At the boy's confused stare she just giggled and reached up to poke her finger against his nose.

"I took it when I grabbed you because I didn't want Shiggy to dust it. I put my number in it for you so we can talk sometime." The girl bounced a little on her feet again before taking a step back and waving to the whole group. "Don't worry, I'll make sure he goes to see the Doctor lady. You go home and rest, m'kay?"

Seemingly off balance for the moment, Izuku let her shoo him away and didn't protest when Hizashi and Bakugo herded him back towards the car.

Shouta glanced back towards the two villains only to find the street empty. Now the only thing in the road were the shadows cast by the fire blazing.

Life was going to become way too chaotic for his tastes, Shouta mused as he followed his husband and student back to the car.

Chapter End Notes

Idk how I feel about this chapter but I couldn't stand to look at it any longer lol.

Let me know what you think lovelies and have a good holiday season!

Cat's in the cradle

Chapter Summary

Some comfort after Trauma

Chapter Notes

I hope everyone had a happy holiday season and an amazing New Year!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The drive back to U.A was a quiet one. Katsuki had gently guided Izuku to the car and slid in after him. The moment he settled himself down in the backseat, Izuku shuffled closer and carefully tucked himself against Katsuki's side. One of his hands reached for his and the blonde carefully intertwined their fingers.

It wasn't a long ride back but the longer the silence stretched on the more tension Katsuki could feel the body next to his tensing. By the time they pulled into the teachers' parking lot of U.A, Izuku was coiled tight as a spring. Katsuki rubbed his thumb gently over the back of his hand in an attempt to relax him and earned a tense smile in return.

Neither Mic or Aizawa said anything as they herded both of the teens gently into the dorms. Katsuki expected to be gently shooed towards his dorms but instead he found himself in the Aizawa-Yamada apartment. Two cats twined their way between Aizawa's feet, meowing loudly and causing the pro to curse under his breath and try and shoo them away. If he wasn't so wrung out Katsuki might be tempted to laugh at the sight of their grumpy teacher lightly scolding two very large cats and attempting to not get bowled over.

Izuku didn't seem to be paying attention to the bizarrely hilarious thing going on with his dad, instead pulling Katsuki over to the sofa and collapsing down on it heavily. Katsuki dropped down next to him, lifting his arm so the smaller teen could burrow into his side once again.

As badly as Katsuki wanted to pry into what was going on in his mind there was something in the other's face that made him pause. He'd seen a lot of the other's expressions over the last few weeks but this one was closed off but at the same time…fragile.

It left Katsuki at a loss for what to do to fix it. If it could even be fixed.

Both teen's gazes lifted when Mic sat on the coffee table in front of them. The man's eyes were soft as he leaned forward, elbows on his knees and his hair slipping down over his shoulders as he leaned down. All three of them had geared up so fast that the man hadn't even bothered to do more than pull his hair back in a low ponytail before they flew out the door.

Honestly, at this moment Katsuki felt like he was in the twilight zone with the night and day difference between the two heroes teaching personas and what he assumed was their actual selves.

"Hey little listener…" Mic started, reaching out to card his fingers carefully through Izuku's hair. The teen leaned into the touch like a cat, eyes slipping shut for a moment before aiming a small smile at the man.

Even if Katsuki was blind he'd be able to tell how much Izuku adored his new father figures. It made his chest ache a little. It was obviously something he'd sorely lacked not just in the last few years but in his life in general.

"I know you're pretty attached to it, bud, but can we get that hoodie off? It's not looking so great." The blonde man said gently, carefully reaching out to pluck at the fabric gently.

The look on Izuku's face revealed just how much he did not want to do that. He curled in a little tighter next to Katsuki and turned his head just enough to hide his expression from the two of them. For a long moment it seemed like he was going to ignore the request. The moment ticked by until finally the green haired teen carefully sat up and unzipped the hoodie, wincing as the fabric crumbled a little as he slid it off of his arms and shoulders.

Both blondes watched as he let the remainder of the fabric pool in his slap, fingers clenching and unclenching in the fabric before he took a deep breath and carefully handed it to Mic. To the man's credit, he took it as gently as he could and was careful not to touch the decayed or singed areas.

"I'll see if someone can patch thi-"

"Don't bother. I can…just get another one or something." Izuku's voice was rough and he tried to hide the lost expression on his face by covering it with his hand before he curled back into Katsuki's side.

The teen rubbed the other's back gently, meeting the older blonde's gaze worriedly over his head. The man just gave him a small smile before gathering up the material and putting it into a ziplock bag carefully.

The odd atmosphere was broken as Aizawa shuffled back into the room, cats no longer at his heels. He seemed to take in the scene in front of him, only seeming to pause for a moment before he shuffled forward to sit down next to his husband. The blonde flashed him a gentle smile and knocked shoulders with the dark haired man as he settled down.

Katsuki almost felt like he was intruding and forced himself to look away, instead turning his gaze to the way Izuku's hand was gripping at his shirt.

At this moment in time, he felt useless. Whatever had gone down in that building was something he was never going to be able to fix. The hurt of losing the one comfort item he'd been allowed for a very long time wasn't something that Katsuki could fix.

All he could do right now was hold onto him and let him take whatever comfort he could out of his presence. And as much as he hated not being able to blow the root of the problem up, he wasn't going to move from this spot unless Izuku himself set him away.

Aizawa seemed to sense this, if the contemplative look in his eyes was anything to go by when Katsuki finally lifted his gaze again. The man gave him a small nod before turning his attention back to Izuku.

"I know you probably don't want to deal with this right now but Nezu is on his way. A lot's happened in the last 24 hours that needs to be discussed and dealt with." Aizawa started, reaching out to lay a hand on Izuku's leg, gently shaking it a little to get him to look at him.

"All Might has been removed from his position and made a teaching assistant to Vlad King and 1B. If it wouldn't further destabilize the already shaky grip society has on itself we would have fired him outright." He continued, pausing as Izuku seemed to take in the information and nodded his understanding. The teen's body uncoiled a little, some of the tension easing in him.

Izuku blew out a breath and flashed the older men a shaky smile. Overall he seemed relieved at the news and just the fact that he had been so tense about All Might of all people had Katsuki clenching his jaw against the rage pounding against the inside of his rib cage.

The sludge villain brought back memories he wanted to forget, things that creeped into his nightmares even now after literal years of therapy. To think that Izuku had gone through that made Katsuki's skin crawl and his blood boil.

His blood boiled thinking about everything Izuku had gone through that day. Had All Might really been so callus? Obviously he couldn't have known the things Katsuki had said to him earlier in the day but a roof?

Just imagining Izuku standing on a roof after having his heart crushed by his hero? That made Katsuki want to throw up. What would have happened if Izuku had taken his advice and jumped from the roof of that building?

As awful as it sounded, the bridge had at least given him a fighting chance of surviving. A chance that had come in the form of a purple scarred villain. A building in the area he said they'd been in? Not so much.

A light knock at the door of the apartment door drew Katsuki out of his thoughts, turning his head just in time to see Nezu pushing open the door and smiling at them. The small principal closed the door carefully behind him before making his way over to them. They were silent as they waited for him to pull himself up onto the table, both of the adults scooting away to make room for him.

“Hello, Izuku, I know you’ve had an eventful night but you understand that I need to know what happened.” The principal said, folding his hands in front of him solemnly. Katsuki fought the urge to snarl at him as Izuku tensed up again next to him.

It wasn’t Nezu’s fault, he knew that the school needed to know if Dusty was plotting to attack the school again or whatever nefarious thing he had targeted Izuku for but it didn’t make it easier to watch.

“Do you know why he had you kidnapped?” Mic asked gently, eyes flickering between Izuku and Nezu nervously.

“No. He didn’t seem all there, honestly, so I don’t think it was premeditated. He kept asking why I was ‘so special’ and something about All for One talking about me constantly.” Izuku shrugged a little at the end of the statement like it wasn’t a big deal or bone chilling that the biggest boogie man in the underground was talking about him.

Katsuki could see the way the three adults exchanged glances that whatever that meant was not good news in the slightest. Izuku glanced between them before leaning heavily back against Katsuki.

“What’s going on? There’s something you’ve not told me..”

Nezu seemed to hesitate for a moment before he nodded, wringing his paws as he seemed to try and put his words together carefully. Whatever was going on was big and it made the hair on the back of Katsuki’s neck stand on end.

Something that made Nezu nervous was bad news.

“In the past week or so All For One has been asking for you to visit him in Tartarus. By name.” Nezu said after a moment, locking eyes with Izuku. The teen lifted a hand to drag through his hair, mind seeming to move so fast that Katsuki could swear he heard the gears turning from where he sat.

“That would explain why Shigaraki was so unhappy with my entire existence right now. He hated that his precious Sensei liked to talk to me more.” Izuku lifted his hands to rub his eyes with the palms of his hands, groaning a little.

“You said he’s asking for him by name?” Mic asked, frowning a little as he glanced down at the rat principal. “How does he know his name? Izuku went by a codename as far as we understood…”

Izuku shifted uncomfortably next to Katsuki, eyes darting from face to face.

“Uh….that last time I saw him he used my full name as well.” The teen said quietly, shrinking a little as four pairs of eyes pinned him in place. “He even knew my connection to Kacchan. Did…I not mention that before?”

Katsuki couldn’t help but sympathize with his teacher as Aizawa leaned forward to put his head in his hands, obviously not coping with that bit of news well. Especially so late.

“That would have been helpful information to have sooner, yes, but it does feed into a theory I have about this entire situation.” Nezu said after a moment, fingers twitching a little as he pinned Izuku in place with his stare.

Katsuki, Mic, and Aizawa stared at the rat for a moment, waiting for him to elaborate. The principal seemed hesitant to speak further but his need for information sooner rather than later seemed to win out. He clasped his hands behind his back and rocked forward on his heels a little.

“Tell me, Izuku, what do you know about your father?”

Chapter End Notes

A cliffhanger? In my fic? Can't be!

Seriously, though, I hope you enjoyed some soft family time and the beginning of a new plot line! As always, your opinions fuel me to write faster/better so let me know what you thought!

I wish I didn't know now

Chapter Notes

Enjoy some fluff, darlings!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It took a very long moment for Izuku to process what Nezu was suggesting with that question. It was almost laughable that he was even considering it because there was no way that All For One, the boogyman that most didn't even believe existed, was his father.

Right?

Surely Izuku would have recognized his own father sitting in front of him for the past three years.

"His old man? Ha. I don't even remember what he looks like he split so long ago." Katsuki huffed from next to Izuku, arm tightening around him a little as he stared down the adults.

Nezu's gaze bounced between the two of them before settling on Izuku again expectantly. Like this was one of the logic puzzles they played during their lessons.

"I don't remember much, honestly. He started working overseas when I was diagnosed quirkless. A few years later he cut all contact. I think he was still sending mom money for a little while but I'm not sure? She never wanted to talk about it." Izuku let his own gaze drop down to his own hands, one of them twisting the fabric of Katsuki's shirt between his fingers carefully.

The silence that once again stretched out between the adults was heavy and Izuku couldn't stand it.

This was ridiculous. There was no way he stood in front of his own father and didn't recognize the man. His memories were fuzzy, yes, but not that fuzzy.

Except the man had cut all contact when he was eight years old. Seven, almost eight, years ago. Right around the time All for One was presumed dead by All Might.

And it would be a little hard to recognize someone's face when they didn't even have eyes or hair to identify them with. Would be even harder to recognize someone's voice when for the majority of your life you only heard it through a phone.

"Fuck." Izuku ground out the word, pulling away from Katsuki. He swung his legs down over the side of the sofa and dropped his head into his hands. "This can't be possible. I stood in front of that man for three years, playing his stupid games and listened to him talk."

He could almost feel the look the adults were giving him and fought the urge to shake Hizashi's hand when it came down onto his shoulder, giving it a small squeeze. His mind was whirling a mile a minute as he tried to go over every interaction he'd ever had with All For One, desperately trying to make it make sense.

"Hey, hey, calm down. Take a breath for me, Izu." Hizashi's voice was soothing and Izuku couldn't help but lift his head to look up at him. "We don't know anything for sure right now so let's not jump to conclusions."

Nezu, deciding to jump in at that moment finally, nodded and rocked back on his heels again.

"He is correct. I am going to do some digging and see if I can discreetly get a dna sample from All For One. In the meantime…" He hesitated for a moment, the rat's gaze bouncing between Hizashi and Shouta for a moment.

"We're going to have to contact my mother." Izuku finished for him, dread seeping into his bones at the thought.

Shouta, from the corner of Izuku's eye, did not look happy at that prospect. Even Katsuki next to him was tense at the mention of Inko. Izuku didn't like the idea any more than the rest of them but outside of the man himself she was their best bet for information at the moment.

Izuku knew he wouldn't be able to play dead for the rest of his life. This moment was bound to happen sooner or later but he'd really, really, hoped it would be much later.

"That can be handled in the morning. I am sure you are exhausted. I apologize for the need to have the conversation we've had tonight." Nezu said after a moment before giving Hizashi and Shouta a small nod and jumping down from the coffee table. "Rest up. There are a lot of things that need to be handled soon."

No one said anything as they watched the Principal leave. The only sound for a long moment was the soft click of the door and the padding of his feet down the dorm hallway.

Finally Hizashi stood up and flashed the two teens on the sofa a small smile. He turned to offer a hand to Shouta to help him stand as well before turning back to the two teens.

"I imagine neither of you are going to sleep well apart so Bakugo can stay here tonight. I'll go grab him something to sleep in since I'm sure he's not going to want to leave." Hizashi said lightly, winking at the two and laughing at how red Izuku's face got.

"Keep the door open." Shouta cut in, frowning before turning to shuffle out away from the sofa.

Izuku couldn't help but smile a little at the disgruntled noise Katsuki made, instead gently pulling the blonde to stand up with him and following after the two adults as they made their way down the hallway.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Walking into Izuku's bedroom was a surreal experience to Katsuki. The last time he'd so much as stepped foot into a room that was Izuku's personal space both he and Izuku had been children.
And as a child Izuku had so much All Might and other hero merch lining his walls.

What he walked into this time was so far on the other spectrum that he stopped in the doorway to take it in fully. The walls were fairly blank aside for a lone Present Mic poster that looked like both Mic and Aizawa had signed.

Izuku's bed was pushed into the corner furthest from the door, covered in a dark sheets and blankets.

Honestly, the only interesting thing in the whole room was the desk.

It was piled high with notebooks and textbooks. Stepping up to it, Katsuki could see at least one analysis in progress in one of the open note books. It was for a hero that he didn't recognize but that wasn't a surprise. He hadn't really had the time recently to keep up with the rankings and all.

Behind him, Katsuki could feel Izuku hovering nervously. Tearing his eyes away from the notebook on the desk, Katsuki turned to raise a brow at the other teen.

Izuku flashed him a small smile and lifted his shoulders in a small shrug.

"I know it's not much but when I first got here I didn't think this setup was going to last very long, you know? And then by time I settled into the idea that I could stay long term shit kind of hit the fan."

Katsuki didn't have an answer for that, honestly. Luckily he was saved from answering by Mic poking his head into the room and holding out some clothes to him. It was still incredibly weird to see the domestic side of his teachers, honestly, but he wasn't going to look a gift horse in the mouth right now.

Especially when said gift horse had been completely correct. There was no way he'd be able to sleep in his dorm tonight. Not after the mental image of that building burning was seared into the back of his mind.

Katsuki mumbled his thanks and took the clothing from the man who disappeared back out the door. Presumably to wrangle his husband into bed as well.

Izuku grabbed his own clothes and quickly changed his back to Katsuki as he did so. And even while pulling on the oversized clothing, Katsuki couldn't help but catch small glimpses of Izuku's back as he changed shirts.

His gaze was pulled like a magnet to the handprint scar that peeked over his shoulder. There weren't many people who could make a scar like that on a person. As much as he tried, he couldn't help but imagine how a wound of that size must have felt to receive. And how difficult it had been to heal.

And how lucky Izuku probably was to even be alive right now.

Unaware of the spiraling thoughts of his companion, Izuku finished pulling on his sleeping clothes and turned to the bed to start pulling the sheets down and getting it ready for both of them to sleep.

Katsuki pulled himself out of his thoughts and moved to hover next to the smaller teen, earning a bright smile as the other noticed his movement.

Without a word, the other teen crawled into bed and scooted all the way to the wall to make room for Katsuki. It wasn't a very large bed, about the size of the beds in the dorms, and he could already see that Aizawa was going to threaten to skin him alive come morning time.

That thought, though, didn't stop him from climbing into the bed after the other teen and pulling the covers over both of them. Once Katsuki settled into a comfortable position, Izuku put himself firmly into Katsuki's space.

Not that he was complaining, though. The blonde was more than happy to tuck the smaller male underneath his chin and wrap a protective arm around his waist.

"It's okay, Kacchan. I'm home. Everything's okay." Izuku mumbled into his shoulder, nuzzling into him lightly.

All the response he got was a tightening of Katsuki's arm around him. He wasn't ready to use his words just yet, though he knew that was going to be something he'd have to do sooner rather than later.

He just wasn't ready to admit to the terror that coursed through every vein in his body when he'd found out that Izuku had been taken by the League. Nor was he ready to admit how much that fear ratcheted up when neither Mic or Aizawa argued with him about coming.

So instead of words, he settled for holding Izuku close and nuzzling his face into his hair.

Everything had turned out mostly okay, he reminded himself.

They had a lot to deal with in the morning, though, and it was far past his bedtime. He couldn't stay awake all night contemplating what was going to happen when Inko found out that Izuku was alive. Nor the consequences of their theory about All For One being correct.

No, there wasn't enough time in the night to dwell on any of that for the moment.

"Go to sleep, nerd."

Chapter End Notes

This wasn't a very long chapter but I've been so busy and exhausted this week that it's the best I could manage this week. I didn't want to leave yall hanging for too long, you know lol However I've spent the last week taking care of my grandparents who've been sick with the vid and I'm about ready to drop.

So I hope you enjoyed this chapter and next we'll be getting this new arc into full swing!

Who says you can't go home

Chapter Notes

Another short chapter! I promise there's a long one coming soon!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Sleep was difficult for Izuku on a good night and the last few nights hadn't been all that good.

It didn't take long to fall asleep, wrapped up and held close to Katsuki as he was, but it was difficult to keep hold of. He kept still the few times he drifted into consciousness, not wanting to disturb Katsuki.

The last time, though, Izuku blinked awake to find someone standing in the doorway of his room. By time he'd refocused his eyes, they were gone but he had a pretty good idea of who it had been anyway. He blinked the sleep from his eyes and glanced over at his alarm clock.

5:00 AM. Typical time for the household to start moving. Usually this was around the time Shouta was waking up from his post patrol nap.

It took him a moment to fully extract himself from Katsuki's grasp, pausing for a moment at the edge of the bed to murmur soothing nothings when the other began to stir a little.

Looking down at the blonde for a moment, he couldn't resist the urge to lean down and ghost his lips over his forehead before sitting up again. He smoothed the covers over the other's sleeping form before standing up fully and making his way out into the hallway.

He padded his way softly into the kitchen and paused when he met the dark gaze of his father. Shouta's hair was pulled up into a low ponytail at the base of his neck and he was wrapped in one of Hizashi's sweaters. The bags under his eyes were even more prominent and he got the feeling that the older man had slept just as badly as Izuku had.

Judging by the second cup of coffee sitting on the table in front of him, he'd known that Izuku would follow him out into the kitchen.

It wasn't a common routine for either of them but it was familiar enough.

Izuku slid into the seat across from the older man and pulled the cup of coffee towards himself, hands wrapping around the mug tightly. The warmth of the ceramic in his hands ground him to the moment as he glanced up at his dad from beneath his bangs.

He had a bad feeling where this conversation was going to lead and part of him wanted to just crawl back into bed with Katsuki and avoid all of this. But the sensible part of himself reminded him that Shouta deserved answers to whatever questions were plaguing him. It was only fair considering how much trouble Izuku being here had brought down on him.

Silence lapsed between the two of them as Izuku sipped at his coffee, letting himself relax little by little as the minutes passed. He watched Shouta over the rim of his mug, noting how the older man was doing the same to him. Part of him wondered if the man was determining just how much trauma Izuku was willing to unearth in this round of questioning.

He seemed to have his answer after a minute or so of their silent staring contest. The man nodded to himself before reaching out to pick up a file folder off of the chair seat next to him, sliding it across the table towards Izuku a moment later and making a motion for him to open it.

Not sure what to make of this, Izuku set his coffee aside and reached for the folder. He didn't hesitate to flip it open and start scanning the first page of the documents inside.

What he was looking at…wasn't possible. His eyes danced over the paper repeatedly and he fully focused on it as he began to quickly glance through the rest of the paperwork inside. The teen's mind raced as he finally tore his eyes away from the documents to look up at Shouta in disbelief.

"What….what is all of this?" He managed to stutter out, gesturing at the papers in front of him.

"It's insurance that no matter how this goes with your mother or All For One, you're not getting taken away from us." Shouta's voice was rough but firm as he leaned against the table heavily, a hand coming out to tap at the papers for emphasis. "If this is what you want, I'll drop it back off to Nezu and have him push it through with his contacts."

All Izuku could do was stare at the man, open mouthed, for a moment as his words sank in. This…wasn't possible. There was no way that….no

"These are….this would be a whole new identity and…adoption papers for that name…" He stuttered out after a moment, gaze dropping back down to the folder in front of him. "You… you want to….I don't understand."

Shouta reached across the table to lay his hand gently on top of Izuku's, giving it a small squeeze when the teen twisted their hands so he was gripping the older man's hand tightly as his brain whirled a mile a minute.

"Kid, 'Zashi and I weren't kidding when we said you're our kid. And as long as you want to be our kid, we're going to fight tooth and nail to keep you." The man's voice was so serious and so firm that Izuku couldn't stop the flow of tears that sprang into his eyes.

He brought his free hand up to scrub at his face, shaking his head as if to banish the emotion that was welling up in his chest. There was no way. Sure, they said all of that stuff but he

hadn't exactly expected them to go this far! Especially now that his own biological parentage was looking so….awful.

"But why?! You don't know what I've done! You don't know half of the things I've said and done….you won't want me if you did. You…" Izuku fought for breath against the sobs that clawed at his chest and throat, hand shaking as it frantically wiped at his eyes.

"I don't care, Izuku." Shouta cut in, getting up and moving around the table so he was kneeling down next to the teen.

His gaze was so intense that the green haired teen couldn't look at him for more than a second, curling in on himself as he tried to calm himself.

"Izuku, look at me. Hizashi and I don't give a damn about what you've done before you came to us, okay? There's nothing you could do that would make us let go of you."

The intensity and certainty in the man's voice, quiet and determined, was what finally broke the teen. He uncurled and threw himself at Shouta, catching the man off guard for a moment before he steadied the both of them and sank to the ground with the teen sobbing into his chest.

One of the man's hands came up to cup the back of his head while his other arm held the teen steady against him as he shifted the both of them into a decently comfortable position. He ended up sitting with his legs sprawled out in front of him with Izuku clinging to his chest with a vice grip on his sweater.

He whispered soothing words into the teen's hair, words that flew literally over his head as Izuku fought to pull himself together. It was several minutes before his breathing finally evened out and he could pull himself away from Shouta a little. The man only let him get far enough away that he could see his face properly, though, one of his hands still carding through the teen's green locks gently.

"You..really mean it, right? I don't have to leave?" Izuku finally asked after a moment, worrying at his lip as he let his gaze settle on Shouta's face finally.

Shouta rolled his eyes at him and used the hand in Izuku's hair to shake his head a little, drawing a small laugh from the teen before he let go entirely.

"No, problem child, you don't have to leave. We're keeping you."

Before Izuku could burst into another round of tears the sound of footsteps reached both of their ears, both of them turning towards the doorway of the kitchen in time to watch Hizashi walk in. The blonde paused in the doorway, taking in the scene in front of him before he threw his hands up in the air and a louder than usual whine.

"No fair, 'Sho! You said we could give him the paperwork together!"

Shouta rolled his eyes and carefully extracted himself from Izuku's hold, pushing himself to his feet with a groan and holding out his hand to help Izuku up as well.

“It was more logical to do it when he wouldn’t be as embarrassed about crying.”

“He cried?! Shooooo!”

Izuku watched his new parents bicker back and forth as Shouta picked up the folder and put the papers back in order, clearly only half listening to his husband whine at him. The teen couldn’t help the small grin that tugged at his lips as he watched them and let the idea fully settle into his mind.

Dads. He officially had two dads now that would probably burn the world down to make sure he was okay. It felt weird, he’d admit, to have a parental figure that seemed to care so much. But..it was definitely something he could get used to.

His attention was only pulled away from his dads when Katsuki appeared in the doorway of the kitchen, squinting unhappily at the two adults bickering back and forth with each other.

He’d clearly been woken up by the noise, hair sticking up even worse than usual with bedhead and his borrowed clothes rumbled. Izuku couldn’t help but want to commit the image to memory. He looked so soft and, dare he say it, cute at the moment.

Grinning, Izuku shuffled over to grab the blonde’s hand and gently pull him into the room. He got an eyebrow raise in return but the other didn’t fight him as he ushered him into a seat at the table and moved to start breakfast for the four of them.

It was a good start to his day, honestly. The best he could have hoped for.

Chapter End Notes

More fluff, I know, but I couldn't help it. I promise that chapters are going to get longer again I've just been so busy that I haven't had the energy recently. But not to worry, I have things planned and this next arc is going to be very exciting! C:

I hope you enjoyed and have a wonderful weekend!

(I'm also debating if I should have Dabi and Aizawa meeting one on one sooner rather than later. What do you guys think?)

Go tell that long tongue liar

Chapter Summary

Secrets come to light and Izuku takes the first steps to finding a new normal.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Breakfast went by quickly, both teens practically swallowing the food whole as they rushed to start getting ready. Katsuki left soon after to get dressed for class, red eared and blushing as both Shouta and Hizashi teased both teens mercilessly about the awkward goodbye hug they'd watched.

To escape, Izuku rushed to get ready himself and have an excuse to hide himself in his room for a minute.

It was going to be a busy day, he could already feel it.

For the moment, though, he let himself sit on his bed and look around the room and finally fully let the events of the last day or so sink in. It was amazing how twenty four short hours could turn his entire life on its head.

Finally getting at least a little justice for the worst day of his life so far was…something he never expected to get, honestly. It felt nice that everyone had seemed to believe him and actually be angry for him. Surprising, absolutely, but nice nonetheless.

He hadn't expected anyone to believe him. Or even believe that All Might was anything other than a shining beacon of peace.

Being related to the symbol of peace's greatest nemesis was not such a great feeling, though. Everything having to do with the idea that All For One could be his father still felt fuzzy and unreal. There wasn't likely to be any kind of change in that feeling any time soon, though, he wagered.

Not until he had the full picture and that probably could only come from his mother.

The teen huffed out a sigh and shook his head to rid himself of that train of thought. It wouldn't do much good to dwell on it till they had an actionable plan for dealing with…all of that.

He ran a hand through his hair and glanced at the bag sitting on the bed next to him. The disintegrated and burned edges of the fabric taunted him. Another example of something from his past crumbling away from him.

It wasn't salvageable in the least and part of him mourned for the one comfort item he'd been allowed for the past few years. The rest of him, though, was resigned to being uncomfortable for a period of time.

He'd get used to not having the coverage it gave him, eventually. He had better coping mechanisms, now. A better support system around him.

And wasn't that an interesting turn of events.

He had people now. His Dads, Katsuki, and seemingly the whole of class 1A. It was almost overwhelming to think of how many people just in this building alone seemed ready to go to bat for him. Hell, he had Nezu in his corner.

He'd never had this much backup in his life. It was such an odd feeling.

He tore his gaze away from his ruined hoodie and picked up his phone off of the bed instead, thumbing through his contacts quickly. He hovered over a contact, worrying at his lip as he stared down at the name.

Dabi.

That was a whole other conundrum to deal with. Once again, at great personal risk to himself, the man had stepped out of his way to very literally save Izuku's life.

There were no messages or calls from him, so he assumed that the old healer had agreed to use his favors for the man. That or he was lying somewhere in a safe house dying slowly from infection. With Dabi it was a toss up.

Hopefully Toga'd had enough fun with looking at all the blood that she'd actually gotten him to the healer.

Blowing out a breath, Izuku pushed himself off of the bed and stood up. He tucked his phone into his pocket and grabbed his bag from where he'd dropped it at the end of his bed.

He had classes to get to, after all.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Shouta and Hizashi had long since left the apartment, both had planning to do before class and things to take care of, so it was just Izuku bustling around the living room gathering his things for the day.

He'd be lying if he'd said he wasn't stalling, letting most of the class make their way to the school before he even ventured outside of the apartment. He knew he was going to be bombarded by the class at some point but he was hopeful he could postpone it a little bit.

Deciding that enough time had passed for the common areas to clear out, Izuku headed towards the door.

To say he was surprised to find Todoroki Shouto standing on the other side, leaning against the wall waiting for him, was an understatement.

He paused in the doorway, startled, and took in the way that the youngest Todoroki was standing. His arms were crossed over his chest and the line of his shoulders was tense. So this wasn't just a social call, then.

"Uh. Hi?" He kept his tone bright, hoping this wouldn't end up being a massive problem.

The tension in the dual quirked teenager's shoulders relaxed a little and he nodded his head a little as he pushed off from the wall.

"I hoped I could talk to you, privately." Todoroki stated, eyes flickering between Izuku's face and the apartment behind him.

Izuku nodded and stepped back into the apartment, motioning for Todoroki to come in. The other teen stepped inside and waited for Izuku to close the door. Still a little baffled, Izuku motioned towards the living room and followed the youngest Todoroki.

He could see the other teen's eyes taking in the room but couldn't get a read on what he thought as he sat down carefully on the sofa. The other teen's face was stoic as ever as he surveyed the room.

Izuku perched himself on the chair across from him and set his bag down on the ground. Whatever this was about was going to add to his stress levels, he could tell. He was careful to keep his face clear of the dread he could feel building in his gut, though. The last thing he needed right now was to spook the ever closed off Todoroki. This was a good sign of him finally opening up a little bit. Hopefully.

"What did you want to talk about, Todoroki?" He asked brightly, patting his knees nervously.

Todoroki tore his eyes away from the inspection of the room to settle on Izuku himself. He seemed to be deliberating his words. The silence stretched on for a moment longer than comfortable before he finally seemed to find the way he wanted to phrase his words.

"I wanted to let you know that I understand your feelings. With All Might." For the first time, as he spoke, Izuku could see some emotion in the other's face. He averted his eyes and his posture loosened enough for Izuku to see the weight of the story he wanted to tell sitting on his shoulders. "If you need to talk about it, I…would be willing to lend an ear."

Izuku was quiet, watching the way Shouto's posture unfroze little by little as he worked himself up to what he wanted to say. A story he wanted to tell that Izuku already knew by heart. Had known for years before Todoroki Shouto even knew who Izuku was.

Gosh this was awkward.

"I have a…similar situation to yours. A story that most people won't believe because Heroes are meant to be good people."

Izuku nodded along to his words, relaxing a little. This…was something he could handle. This would be fine.

He hoped.

“Your father.” He said after a moment, watching the way Shouto’s head jerked back in surprise.

He seemed to gather himself quickly though, nodding and plucking at an imaginary string of his uniform pants.

“Bakugo told you, then.” He said, voice quiet and reserved once more. “I…slipped up during the sports festival and used my fire. He took offense to me not using it in my fight with him and I felt…obligated to explain considering how the award ceremony went.”

Izuku could practically see the regret pouring off of the other teen. Which was understandable considering the mishandling of the blonde teenager during the awards ceremony. Izuku would have to remind himself to ask his dads whose bright idea that had been later.

For the moment, though, Shouto had given him the perfect out in this conversation. He could claim that Katsuki had told him the information and keep it moving.

But for once, he wanted to be honest. Shouto deserved that much.

Dabi might not agree with him but at this point if the man wanted to keep Izuku quiet he could come shut him up himself.

“Kacchan didn’t tell me, Todoroki.” He pushed forward before he could convince himself to back down from this. “Touya did.”

Surprise flashed across his face briefly before his expression closed off all together. Izuku wondered for a moment if he’d made a grave miscalculation.

“That’s…not possible. It’s not possible for you to even know that name.” Despite his closed off expression, the teen’s voice shook a little. Just enough to show just how shaken the other teen was by the entire conversation.

“It is. Because he survived. And he saved me.”

Izuku could feel the familiar lump in his throat that arose whenever he thought about that day, and the days afterwards. He cleared his throat and shifted so he was leaning his elbows on his knees, not meeting the piercing gaze of the teen in front of him.

“He pulled me out of that river and spent so much time and energy making sure I stayed alive. And I know you’re not going to like this but you’ve seen him recently.”

He could visibly see the confusion in the dual quirked teen when he glanced up to meet his gaze again. This needed to be done, he told himself. If he wanted any chance of getting close

to and helping the youngest Todoroki he needed to rip this bandaid off sooner rather than later.

Secrets were not advisable when trying to gain someone's trust. Especially not ones this big.

"Blue flames, Shouto."

And just like that, he could see the realization click into place on the other's face. He could also see the range of emotions that seemed to flicker over the teen's face quickly.

Disbelief.

Anger.

Confusion.

"Dabi. Dabi is Touya? You're sure?" He demanded, hands clenched into fists in his lap. It was the most emotional Izuku had ever seen the other teen.

"Positive. He told me the whole story himself almost three years ago." Izuku nodded, blowing out a breath. "I was trying to convince him to let go of his vendetta against your father before he got the stupid idea in his head that The League was the way to go."

Izuku let that information settle into the other's system, sitting back in his chair and letting the silence settle over the two of them like a blanket. He could practically hear the gears turning in Shouto's brain and felt a little bad for dumping all of this information on him like this.

Classes hadn't even started for the day yet and already it was a long day. Just like he thought it was going to be.

"So, you and he are close? Were close?" Shouto asked finally, expression settling once more into his usual stoicness.

"Yeah. He…actually saved me again last night. The league grabbed me when I was on my way back to the school and he defected." He hoped that information would at least be a little soothing to the other. Dabi wasn't a direct enemy anymore. Hopefully.

He could see Shouto digesting that information, the other looking a little lost as he tried to make sense of it all. Izuku felt bad for dumping all of it on him but this was important. Last thing he needed was for Shouto to find out his brother was alive on live TV or something. Taking pity on him, he decided now was a good time to give him some space to figure out his feelings on the matter. Or at the very least digest it in peace.

"Class is going to be starting soon, we should probably go or we'll be late." He said with a bright smile, reaching down to snag his bag against as he stood up. "Walk with me?"

"Of course."

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

By the time lunch rolled around, Izuku was tired and quite frankly a little cranky. Nezu had cranked up the difficulty of their lessons to the point where it was an actual challenge. Which would be nice on a regular day but today it was almost torture. On top of that, the rat refused to answer any of his questions about the process of getting a DNA sample from All For One.

Nezu must have noticed his mood and dismissed their lessons a few minutes early with the instructions to go straight to 1A. For once, Izuku wasn't inclined to argue. It would be easier to drop his bag there and not have to cart it around with him at lunch anyway.

He arrived to the classroom a few minutes before the lunch bell, sliding the door open and pausing in the doorway. It looked like Hizashi had wrapped up class early as well and was standing at the podium sorting papers. He looked up when the door slid open and flashed Izuku a bright smile.

He didn't get a chance to say anything, though, because the class noticed him in the same moment and the uproar of noise was something that even Present Mic's voice would be drown out by.

Izuku couldn't help but laugh a little, shoulders loosening as he waved and the tension bleeding out of him. It was so nice to see all of them. It felt like it'd been a million years since he walked through these doors even though it had only been a day.

"He returns! The slayer of All Might!" Sero's voice was distinguishable out of all of the nose and Izuku turned towards him and tilted his head questioningly.

"Dude! You got All Might fired from the Hero Course!" Kaminari crowed, slapping the desk as he leaned back to cackle.

The noise of the class' welcome died down as he made his way across the room and perched himself on top of Katsuki's desk. The blonde huffed at him and pulled his notebook out from under him with a grumpy look on his face. The green haired teen flashed a smile at him before turning back to the rest of the class.

"I didn't get him fired from the hero course! He's just…not teaching this class anymore." He said with a shrug, unable to hide the small smile tugging at his lips.

"Good riddance. He was a shit teacher anyway." Jirou snorted, twirling her jack around the finger and flashing Izuku a smug grin.

He loved these kids, he really did, he decided.

"Now, now, little listeners! Don't start any fights with All Might, okay?" Hizashi drew the attention of the class back to him, a small indulgent smile on his face. "That being said, if you happen to spot him causing trouble for our favorite teaching assistant here come get a staff member and we will handle it, okay?"

The class nodded in unison, every face so serious that it made Izuku's chest tight. As if he knew how overwhelming the feeling of being this supported was to the other teen Katsuki's

hand came up to gently rub against the small of Izuku's back. The green haired teen shot a smile at him before jumping a little when the bell for lunch sounded.

The moment was broken and Izuku blinked as the class began to move, everyone getting up and moving towards the classroom door in their various groups. Izuku laughed when Katsuki pushed him off of his desk with a grunt as he got up from his seat.

Izuku caught himself and held out his hand to Katsuki, grinning when the other teen interlocked their fingers together. They both turned to leave and were startled to find Shouto standing near the door waiting for them. Katsuki was already tensing for a fight but Izuku gave his hand a squeeze to divert his attention, giving him a small smile.

"Shouto, did you need something?" He asked pleasantly, mildly impressed that the other student seemed to be reaching out all ready.

"Ha? 'Shouto'?! What the hell, nerd?!"

Ah. That was going to be a problem. He had not counted on Katsuki's…jealousy?

"I was curious if I could eat lunch with you. I…am trying to be more social with my classmates." Shouto said slowly, blinking like it was still a foriegn concept that he was unsure of.

"Absolutely!" Izuku chirped, grinning widely as he heard Katsuki huff out a breath. "C'mon, then, before we lose out on good seats."

The silence between the three of them wasn't uncomfortable as they made their way to the hallway. The other teenagers walked on either side of him and he swung his and Katsuki's intertwined hands happily, unable to keep the smile off of his face.

That smile, though, faded as they got into the cafeteria and approached the tables that the class had collectively claimed for themselves.

There was some sort of ruckus going on, agitated voices raised in an argument.

"-kind of hoodlums must your class be that the greatest hero ever would abandon your education? Is the mighty class 1 A finally brought down to the level they should be?"

Next to Izuku, Katsuki growled and tugged them closer to the tables. As they got closer it was obvious that the situation was escalating with every second. Kirishima, Sero, and Uraraka were standing up and facing the blonde student who was spewing nonsense at them. It was obvious that they were ready to fight and Izuku didn't think that the student even knew what he was getting himself into.

"Excuse me, is there a problem here?" Izuku cut into the blonde's rant. Katsuki and Shouto flanked either side of the green haired teen, both of them stone faced and ready to back him up if needed.

"Oh! It's 1A's pet villain!" The blonde laughed like he'd made an amazing joke, turning to the other students that Izuku didn't recognize. None of them looked like they shared their

friend's glee. "Wonderful to finally catch sight of you. All Might had some good tips on how to deal with you. I mean, you're quirkless after all so not like it would be hard."

Izuku threw out a hand and caught Katsuki in the chest, holding him back from the lunge he had started in the other blonde's direction. Kirishima had to be held back by Sero and Uraraka at the same time and the antagonistic student took a step back, seeming to realize he was in a dangerous position.

"Go back to being second rate, Monoma." Uraraka growled, helping Sero pull Kirishima back down into his seat.

"Monama, was it? If I were you, I wouldn't take too much stock in what All Might has to say. He's rather old fashioned and biased in his views." Izuku said mildly, redirecting Katsuki into a nearby seat and nodding to Shouto to do the same. "He's also an awful teacher."

The green haired teen flashed the 1B student a smile before purposely turning his back to him and sitting down between Katsuki and Shouto. He could hear the blonde sputtering behind him and suppressed the urge to grin. It was always so much fun playing with this kind of person.

He glanced back at him and flashed him a serene smile, giving him a little wave.

"It was nice meeting you, though. Do let me know when you and your classmates start to fall behind, yeah? I'll be sure to add some joint study sessions between our classes to help catch you back up."

With that he turned back around and grinned widely at the rest of the class that was gaping at him. In front of him, Mina recovered first and didn't even bother trying to hide her giggles as she leaned forward to pound on the table.

The tension in the rest of the group broke, everyone breaking down into giggles and laughs as they returned to their food. Beside him, Katsuki rolled his eyes and knocked his shoulder against Izuku's carefully.

"I'll be back with our food. Stay here and out of trouble, yeah?"

Izuku just tilted his head and gave him a noncommittal shrug.

"I mean, I'll try but no promises."

Chapter End Notes

I really enjoyed writing this chapter! I've been looking for a way for Shouto and Izuku to bond and this way seemed perfect!

Next up, a chat between Dabi and Aizawa and they come up with a plan for talking to Inko Midoriya!

Izuku: I understand what you're going through.
Shouto: I'm now going to follow you around like a puppy. That's friendship, right?

As always, bribe me with your thoughts and I'll write faster C:

Ready as I'll ever be

Chapter Summary

Threats are made and plans are put into place

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Bit by bit as lunch went by, Izuku relaxed into the atmosphere of the entirety of class 1A. Sure, some people wouldn't exactly call the chaos going on around him as twenty teenagers talked and joked with their friends peaceful. Izuku, though? He was relaxed enough where he was sitting, leaning against Katuski, that he could fall asleep.

Katsuki, the good sport that he was, didn't complain when Izuku let his head drop against his shoulder. He didn't even pause his conversation with Kirishima, arguing about something or other to do with training.

Izuku let their voices wash over him, closing his eyes and drifting for a little while. He was safe. His friends were happy and rowdy. All was well.

Sure, there were still things lingering in the background that had to be dealt with eventually. The entire situation with All Might, his now uncertain parentage, the upcoming provincial licensing exam were all things that were going to ruin his peace but they could be dealt with later.

Now, though, he was going to bask in the comfort of the class being rowdy. It meant they were safe and free to be teenagers. It was a nice little bubble of chaos where he could put everything out of his mind and relax for the moment.

His phone, of course, had to ruin his happy place.

His alarm sounded from his pocket, the obnoxious ringtone cutting through his happy little bubble.

Katsuki paused his conversation and looked down at him with a raised brow as Izuku sighed and rolled his neck before grabbing his phone. Silencing the alarm that was beeping at him tauntingly, the put his phone back in his pocket and stretched carefully.

"Want me to walk with you?"

Izuku shook his head and gathered up what remained of his lunch.

“Nah, stay here and continue whatever argument you’re having about dumbbells. I’ve gotta go help set up for the extra training we’re doing this afternoon.” He laughed at the grumpy look on the other’s face, leaning up to press a quick kiss to his cheek before he got up. “I’ll see you in a few, yeah?”

Katsuki nodded before turning to glare at their friends who were snickering and making kissy faces at them. Izuku huffed out a laugh and headed back towards the classroom. Let them joke and laugh, now, before the training for the licensing exams started. From the plans he’d seen Shouta making, there wasn't going to be much time for relaxing or goofing off once they got started.

His mind wandered as he made his way through the halls, going over the list of last minute adjustments that needed to be made to the training they were doing today. He needed to bring up concerns with some of the pairings for the exercise with Shouta.

He also needed to have a talk with a couple of the students privately. Kaminari needed to be gently steered in a different direction from frying his brain and Hagaruke and Momo desperately needed to talk to support about their costumes.

There was a lot of work to do, still.

So lost in thought was he that he didn’t notice the one person he wanted to avoid standing in the middle of the deserted hallway.

He nearly walked into the skeletal man, stopping short a foot or so from him when he realized he wasn’t alone.

For a moment the world seemed to freeze around him, breath caught in his chest. The phantom sensation of fingers around his throat made his blood run cold and his legs lock into place. In that moment he wished for his hoodie so much that it added to the almost physical ache in his chest. It at the very least would have hidden the shaking of his hands as he stared down the former number one hero.

“Young Midori-”

“I told you to stop calling me that.” Izuku interrupted the man, words hissing between his teeth as he forced the air from his lungs.

The man’s jaw clenched, muscle in his cheek jumping as he seemed to tamp down the urge to snap back. Interesting. So the man did know what self control meant. Izuku would clap for him if his hands weren’t shaking so badly.

He couldn’t tell if it was fear or rage anymore if he was being honest. The longer he stood staring at the man, the harder it was to tell which emotion was filling his chest and stomach right at the moment.

“Young man, I still don’t approve of you having access to the future of heroics.” The man started, voice booming through the empty corridor. “I understand that you have a problem

with me, and that the position you are in is because I made many mistakes but that is not a reason to destroy these children and their futures."

Izuku forced himself to take a deep breath and take a large step back away from the man. The audacity that filled the former hero's whole body was pushing him closer to rage the longer he had to breath the same air as the blonde.

Vaguely, he wondered if Nezu had been alerted to this little meeting yet. Usually he was pretty on top of the goings on, especially when afternoon classes were about to start.

"You don't know anything about me. With all due respect, which is none by the way, I'm not going anywhere." Izuku managed to keep the words light, plastering a smile on his face to disguise the absolute rage simmering in his veins. "Now, if you'll excuse me, I have some things to get done before class."

He forced himself to walk at a normal pace past the man, heart hammering in his chest until he was out of the man's scarily large arm's length. His heart nearly jumped out of his chest when the man's voice boomed out from behind him.

"I will not let you do as you please. You may have Nezu and Aizawa convinced that you are harmless but I can't take that chance." The man's shoulders were squared and for a moment Izuku could see the shadow of All Might's former glory shining through. "If I have to go to the commission and have them scrub this entire year of heroes to keep whatever you're planning from coming to pass, then I will."

The words hung in the air for a long moment, Izuku's mind refusing to process the implications of what the man was threatening. Surely he wasn't even actually considering what he was implying. Not even he was that stupid.

The commission was not allowed inside the walls of U.A. Nezu was perfectly clear on that, his distaste well known. But if the number one hero insisted that there was something wrong going on inside of the walls…

Absolutely not. Not if Izuku had anything to say about it.

Izuku saw red. The only sound in his ears was the pounding of his own heartbeat. Before he even realized what he was doing, he had turned on his heel and was striding towards the former hero. He couldn't fathom what his face looked like in that moment but by the way the older man tried to step backwards and away from him it must not have been pretty.

He didn't get far, though, before Izuku reached him and snagged the front of his shirt. The teen pulled until the man was forced to bend to eye level, Izuku's gaze boring into his with a terrifying intensity.

"Listen to me carefully, Toshinori Yagi, if you so much as breathe in a way that hurts those kids careers I will make sure that there isn't a single bit of your legacy left untarnished." His voice was quiet, tone brokering no doubt that he was deadly serious. He waited for a moment

to make sure his message was perfectly clear before releasing the man's shirt and taking a step back.

He made a show of straightening his own clothes, eyes narrowing as he pinned the man in place with his gaze.

"One toe out of line and I will make sure that the entire world knows exactly who you are. You and that borrowed quirk of yours."

The man's face was pale and his entire demeanor screamed how absolutely rocked his world was by that last statement. His mouth opened and closed a few times but no words came out.

Izuku couldn't help the snort that left him as he took in the sight. The mighty All Might made speechless by a teengager. It was almost beautiful.

"Maybe next time don't threaten someone who knows more than you, yeah?"

The teen shoved his hands in his pockets and turned his back on the man, satisfied that his message was loud and clear to the man.

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Nezu had texted both Shouta and Hizashi after lunch to inform them that some kind of altercation had happened between All Might and Izuku between lunch and afternoon classes. The rat hadn't given much information, just a heads up to keep a closer eye on the teenager in case he needed something in the wake of what had apparently been a very intense conversation.

However, as the day went on, the teenager didn't come forward with any information about the incident. He instead seemed to withdraw within himself, spacing out during the afternoon exercises and barely noticing when any of the other kids tried to draw him into conversations or the usual shenanigans in the common area.

More than once Shouta had caught Bakugo watching the green haired teen worriedly. Not even the blonde's presence seemed to draw Izuku out of whatever thoughts were running wild in his mind.

It wasn't until dinnertime that they got a glimpse into whatever was going on inside his mind. And it was nothing close to what they were expecting.

Some angst over having been cornered by All Might again was expected, sure.

Anger over whatever the topic of discussion had been was a reasonable guess.

No, instead he decided to drop a bomb like it was nothing.

"I want to talk to my mom personally."

Both heroes exchanged baffled glances before turning to face the preoccupied teenager. He was flipping through the notebook he'd brought down to dinner with him like he hadn't just thrown them a curveball of sorts.

"Izu…you don't have to do that, you know that right? We can question her under the pretense of thinking he might be a villain. It isn't far from the truth anyway." Hizashi said, glancing over at Shouta who was letting his gaze bounce between their kid and his husband. "There's no need to even mention you to her."

The teenager finally looked up at them and shook his head quickly, hand pausing from where it had been playing with the pages of the notebook.

"And if she knows the truth about him? It's going to be really suspicious that you're sniffing around right after he was taken into custody." Izuku replied, fingers tapping against the paper nervously. He took a deep breath and pushed his plate away. "I have a plan that I think could work and leave it to where she has no way to find me after."

Shouta exchanged a look with his husband but motioned for Izuku to continue.

"I was thinking that Shouta, Kacchan, and I would go visit her. The story wouldn't be too far off from the truth, I got captured and charged with villain crimes after rescuing Kacchan and have been in custody. Only, we don't tell her that U.A technically has custody of me or that you guys want to adopt me." The teen's gaze bounced between the two of them nervously and the tapping against the paper grew a little faster, betraying his nerves with the situation. "I don't want to give her a way to stop the adoption or to find me after everything is said and done."

Hizashi reached out to lay his hand over Izuku's, giving it a small squeeze and a reassuring smile.

"Are you sure? We won't be upset with you if you want to go back to her." He kept his voice soft and Shouta reached out to mirror his husband's action, giving Izuku's other hand a gentle squeeze.

The teen shook his head vigorously, curls bouncing as he did. His eyes were wide and imploring as his gaze bounced between the two of them.

"No! I…I mean…the meeting will kind of determine if I ever want to see her again but there's nothing that can change my mind. I want to stay with you guys. I don't think I could ever live with her again. Not…not after everything that's happened…." His voice broke a little at the end, gaze averting as he blinked back whatever emotion he was feeling.

"Hey, it's okay little listener. We're going to follow your lead on this. In the morning we'll talk to Nezu and see if he has any ideas to fine tune your plan, okay?" Hizashi's voice was soft and soothing.

Shouta watched as some of the tension bled out of the teen's shoulders and gave the kids hand another squeeze before pulling his own hand back.

“Finish your food. I don’t imagine you had much time at lunch to eat between dealing with Monoma and All Might.”

The hero couldn’t help but huff out a quiet laugh at the teen’s indigent cry.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Shouta crouched down on the edge of the building he had scaled, eyes roving over the alleyway beneath him as he settled into his perch. He didn’t expect much trouble tonight, honestly, just the usual petty criminals and drunks out wandering the streets.

So he let himself settle on the ledge and his mind wandered to the issue at hand with his problem child. ‘There was no telling what kind of trauma the kid was going to dig up by talking to his mother face to face but it wasn’t like Shouta could really tell him no.

Not when he was so insistent that his plan was the best.

Not for the first time Shouta wondered if he and Hizashi had bitten off more than they could chew. He wasn’t going to take it back by any means, of course, but he was going to have to adjust how he went about dealing with his problem child.

He was abruptly pulled out of his thoughts as the sound of footsteps behind him reached his ears. Years of practice had him turning around and pulling at his capture scarf before he even registered what was happening.

When his mind finally caught up with his reflexes, he glowered at the scarred man tangled up in his capture weapon.

Dabi scowled right back, wiggling a little to try and free himself.

“Do you mind? I’d like to have a conversation.” The former league member drawled.

Chapter End Notes

I'm rather happy with how this chapter ended up! But I'm even more excited to have the conversation between Aizawa and Dabi to happen. Next time! Revelations! Feelings are had and talked about!

Let me know what you guys thought! As always, thank you for reading!

I loved her first

Chapter Summary

> Dabi is a little shit and Shouta is getting a good look at what his life is going to look like from now on.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Do you mind? I'd like to have a conversation." The former league member drawled.

Shouta scowled at him and pulled his capture weapon tighter, taking a little bit of satisfaction from the groan that came from the scarred man as he did so.

"I'd like to know how you found me." Shouta growled, tugging on the weapon again as he stalked forward.

Despite Izuku's wishes, the animosity Shouta felt deep in his bones for the fire-quirked man in front of him was not going to just disappear. Not when the phantom panic and horror of the training camp still lingered in his chest whenever he saw the man's face. Dabi had purposely made himself the face of that attack and the effect lingered long past the actual event.

The scarred man wheezed a little as the weapon constricted around him. Blue eyes shot him a dirty look before the man sank to the ground, crossing his legs as the fabric tightened around his upper half and restricted his movement even further. It was obviously a ploy to seem unthreatening. For some reason.

"Izuku." He said, rolling his eyes as the thunderous look on Shouta's face darkened. " He's had your patrol patterns memorized for years. He used to be a big hero fanboy."

Shouta rolled that information over in his head as he stood over the villain. The kid had told them that at one point he used to watch villain fights and wanted to be a hero. It would stand to reason that he'd look up to one of the few heroes around that fought quirkless considering his own goals.

How exactly the kid had found out enough information about him to predict his patrolling patterns was a little disconcerting. Especially considering the circles he and the villain in front of him ran in. That was certainly a serious conversation he was going to have to have with Izuku when he got home tonight.

"What do you want, Dabi? I can, and should, still arrest you for the training camp." Shouta ground out, watching the man twitch a little at the reminder.

Something nagged at the back of his mind. Something off about the way the man was behaving now versus that night at the training camp.

In the few minutes he'd been wrapped up, not once had the villain attempted to escape his hold or burn the fabric holding him in place. There had not even been a hint of his quirk. Which could be chalked up to knowing what Shouta was capable of but that didn't seem like the right assumption. The twitch was mostly in his face, lips down turning before his expression wiped clean and was a blank mask of indifference again.

“I have something to pass along to Izuku. I figured it’d be easiest to give it to you since he’s, you know, living with you.” The man rolled his eyes for effect but now that Shouta was watching him he could see the way his shoulders were tense and his posture deliberate.

He had a ton of puzzle pieces but he was not particularly a fan of the picture they were forming at the moment. Taking a deep breath he flicked his wrist and unwound the capture weapon from around the younger man and took a step back, still wary of an attack from the scarred man.

Said man pushed himself back up onto his feet before turning his attention back to Shouta. In his right hand, he clutched a large piece of black fabric. He seemed to hesitate for a moment before he tossed it underhand to the older man. Shouta kept his eyes on the villain for a moment longer before turning his gaze down to the fabric in his hand.

A hoodie.

A large, black, hoodie that was very similar to the one his son had insisted on wearing since the day he’d met him. The one that he’d looked absolutely gutted over being destroyed in whatever had gone down inside of the league’s former hideout.

Dark eyes met blue, the younger not backing down from whatever image was being painted in the man’s mind.

“It was yours.” Shouta’s voice was accusing as his hand closed around the fabric tightly. “Exactly what are your intentions with this? He is a child, as I’m sure you are very well aware.”

Dabi’s lip curled a little, as did his fists at his sides. Still no sign of his quirk, though, which made something twist in Shouta’s stomach uncomfortably.

“My intentions aren’t what you’re twisting them to be.” The younger man spat, seeming to restrain himself for a moment with a breath before continuing. “The sleeves give him something to fiddle with when he’s anxious. And a place to hide his knives. I know the last one was pretty much ruined and I didn’t want him to spiral.”

Shouta blinked, a little taken aback by the intensity of the other’s words and how quickly they were coming now. It almost, almost, reminded him of Izuku when he was nervous.

“It’s a little insulting that you think you know him better because you’ve known him for a few weeks. There is not a damn thing about that kid that I don’t know. Like the fact that if you continue to treat him like one of those goody two shoes hero kids then you’re going to fuck everything up.”

Shouta’s hair rose from his shoulders as his quirk activated and he took a step forward, the familiar protective anger rising in his chest whenever it came to Izuku.

“Care to repeat that? Because you’re already on some thin ice with me.” Shouta’s voice was deadly calm but his gaze was filled with fire.

That did not seem to faze the former league member, however, who stepped even further into Shouta’s space with a growl.

“Then why was he out on the streets without protection? Not once but twice.” Dabi snarled, hands lifting like he was attempting to use his quirk finally. “Toga never would have been able to grab him if he’d had his knives. You know. His way to protect himself?! You trying to declaw him and turn him into one of your students is only going to get him killed!”

Shouta blinked and fire sprang to life in the villain’s hands. The younger realized and dropped his hands, letting the fire die out. If anything, that action alone was enough to make Shouta’s mind race.

He had sent Izuku out into the world twice without protection. That much was true. Would the entire confrontation with All Might have gone differently if Izuku had a weapon? Would that have prevented him from fleeing the way he had and thus not been taken by the league in the first place?

Now was not the time to contemplate that particular oversight. Not with a villain acting oddly in front of him.

“What exactly do you want, Dabi?” He ground out, dragging a frustrated hand through his hair.

All he wanted was one normal night of patrol.

At the very least, though, he wasn’t the only one frustrated. From the posture of the man in front of him, he was feeling very similar things. He hadn’t answered his question yet, instead looking a little lost and wild around the eyes as his hands flexed at his sides.

“I want Izuku to be happy.” He said finally, after the silence stretched on for a few moments. He met Shouta’s gaze evenly. “You might not believe me about my ‘intentions’ but that’s all I want. And the last few times I’ve seen him? Not exactly inspiring confidence in you heroes.”

The last word was sneered and Shouta gave in to the urge to pinch the bridge of his nose and contemplate his life. This was his life now. Having to mediate between heroes and possible villains. Because honestly? The only actual crimes they could definitely pin to Dabi at the moment was the training camp attack and the kidnapping of Bakugo Katsuki.

Bakugo Katsuki who was sort of dating his son who was in…whatever this thing he had with Dabi was.

He stopped that line of thought before it could go any deeper because he honestly could not deal with that right now. To deal with that he’d need several bottles of very strong alcohol.

The things he did for his child(ren).

“I can’t exactly control what the former number one hero does, you know.” He finally ground out, grimacing as the younger man laughed out loud.

“You should have seen that problem coming, old man. The kid was with you for a few weeks before that incident.” Dabi scoffed, rolling his eyes as he moved to perch himself on a nearby ledge. Shouta inwardly groaned at the thought of this conversation being extended much longer. “He always gets quiet and jumpy when he’s even mentioned, I can’t imagine what he was like in the same room with the asshole.”

Dabi turned to look at him, brow raised. His gaze was met with the flattest look Shouta could manage in the moment, hoping the man could see just how much he hated this conversation. Hated that fact that he had to be almost civil right now. Because he needed answers to one more question before he could determine which way that this conversation was headed in.

“Are you still with the league?” He asked the question bluntly, very deeply enjoying the look on Dabi’s face. He almost looked like he’d sucked on a lemon at the mention of the organization.

“Yeah, that’s a no. Pretty sure I’m on Shigaraki’s ‘dust on sight’ list.” Dabi drawled, rolling his eyes sarcastically as he shifted so he was fully facing Shouta again. “He doesn’t take kindly to people betraying him.”

Shouta hummed a little at that. He had a point, after all.

“Is it too much to hope he burned with the building?”

That got a full fledged laugh from the younger man. The sound was mocking and rough as he threw his head back with it.

“Fuck no. Kurogiri got him out. The rest of the so-called league vacated the room before the big fight got started.” Dabi rolled his eyes as he said it and crossed his arms over his chest. “Do I pass whatever you’re testing me on?”

Shouta glared at him for a moment before shaking his head and tucking the hoodie into his belt. It was going to be a pain to keep it clean if he got into a fight but the last thing he needed was for it to get damaged or god forbid lost.

“We’ll see.” Shouta muttered, adjusting his capture weapon around his shoulders and glaring at the other. “It all depends on if the league starts causing trouble again.”

The other snorted and uncrossed his arms as he rose to his feet again.

“The ‘league’ at this point is Giran, Shigaraki, and Kurogiri. And I don’t know how much longer Giran is gonna be with them after Izuku’s threat.” Dabi’s voice was a little smug with a healthy dose of pride.

“What do you mean?”

“The kid basically told them that if they wanted to stay alive to run for the hills.” Dabi’s grin was vicious as he tucked his hands into his pockets. “He threatened to burn Shigaraki to the ground and anyone who stood with him was the enemy. Most of them ran as soon as the fight started.”

There was the headache building that he’d been anticipating. Right on schedule.

He hated that to get a straight answer about what exactly his son was running around doing that he was going to have to continue this conversation. Because obviously Dabi was the only one that had the answers he needed.

And he seemed to want to curry favor with him at the moment. Which he was very deliberately not looking at too closely right now.

One problem at a time, thank you.

“And he has enough of a reputation to back that claim up?” Shouta asked, really desperately not wanting the answer.

“More than that. Izuku’s made it a point to destroy anyone who tries to fuck him over just because they think he’s weak.” Dabi’s entire posture straightened out and the grin fell from his face. Everything about him screamed serious.

Shouta rolled that information around in his mind and had the realization that this was about to get so much more complicated.

Izuku had built a reputation for himself already. One that he was having a hard time wrapping his head around at the moment because the baby-faced kid that was currently at home wrapped up in a million blankets and watching a movie with Hizashi was hard to reconcile with that reputation.

What was even harder to picture was the very real possibility that a kid with that kind of reputation was the son of the most dangerous villain ever to walk the underground.

If that got out it would most definitely make Izuku someone who nobody would dare mess with.
But it would also probably make him a target.

Damn it.

He turned his attention back to Dabi and straightened up to his full height, one hand on his capture weapon and his gaze pinning the younger man in place.

“What I’m about to tell you stays between you, Izuku, and I. Understand?”

Chapter End Notes

This chapter isn't exactly how I wanted to this to go down but I'm pretty satisfied with it none the less.

Let me know what you think!

You can bribe more words out of me with more feedback :D

Please just listen, I don't ask for much

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Oh fuck no, old man. You’re not getting me in that kind of trouble.” Came Dabi’s immediate response, throwing his hands out for a moment and taking a step forward as if that would ward off whatever words were about to come out of the hero’s mouth.

At the older man’s annoyed expression, Dabi just shook his head and relaxed back into the ledge he’d been sitting on a moment before.

“You don’t know much about how Izuku operates and it shows. I don’t wanna know shit unless he tells it to me himself.” He said firmly, crossing his arms over his chest. “And a word to the wise? You shouldn’t go around telling his information so casually either.”

Eraserhead blew out a frustrated breath and dragged his hand through his hair, brows furrowed as he glared at Dabi.

He could be as pissy as he liked but Dabi was going to stand firm on this. The last time he’d learned more than he was allowed to, the younger villain had threatened to do unspeakable things to him. And at this point in time he wasn’t willing to risk the ire of Izuku.

Not even to gain the favor of his father.

And god wasn’t that both a hard pill to swallow and an uncomfortable truth of their situation.

He needed to be on Eraserhead’s good side if he wanted any chance of making things up to Izuku. Because whether Izuku admitted it or not, the man’s approval was important to him. It was probably why he’d been acting like an angel so far.

“This is important, Dabi. It’s something that will put him in danger if it ends up being true.” Eraserhead ground out, fingers tightening around his capture weapon.

“And you telling me will put me in danger with him.” He snorted and shook his head. “If I need to know, he’ll tell me. Not a moment sooner or later.”

No matter how much he wanted to know what had Aizawa so worked up, he absolutely could not break that rule. Not if he ever wanted to fix things between himself and Izuku.

Eraser rubbed his hands over his face, obviously frustrated with his refusal to let him do what he thought was necessary. Dabi had to begrudgingly respect the man for wanting to keep Izuku, a kid he’d known less than a month at his point, safe but in his haste to protect his kid he was forgetting one very important rule of the underground.

Knowledge is power, yes, but in the wrong hands it could be a weakness.

“Okay, fine. Has he told you that we’re going to visit his mother soon?”

A work around, then, the man was clever enough to know that this particular subject was going to be a sore spot.

He was on his feet again in an instant, ignoring the way the hero's hair rose and his quirk activated as he got in the older man's face. Rage simmered at the forefront of his mind at the mention of that woman. And the fact that they were all dumb enough to put Izuku anywhere near her.

"Are you fucking stupid?! You absolutely cannot let him anywhere near that woman." He hissed, hands coming up to fist the man's uniform and shaking him.

If there was one person in the universe that would set the kid back right at the start and ruin every bit of progress he'd made it was that woman. Dabi didn't think that there was anyone he could hate more than his father but Inko Midoriya was a pretty damn close second.

Half of the things that came out of Izuku's mouth in those first few months made his blood boil just thinking about. Neglectful was an understatement.

"It's his idea for him to go. Looking for information only she has." Eraser monotoned, forcefully removing the younger man's hands from his person and putting space between them. "Have you ever been able to stop Izuku from doing something he set his mind to?"

Dabi grit his teeth and stalked away from the man, suddenly wishing to set things on fire. Mostly because he was right and Izuku was a menace when it came to something he was determined to do. He also didn't like how the man had backed him into a corner.

It was either let Izuku do something stupid like sitting and takling to his mother or get in trouble for letting the hero in front of him spill Izuku's secrets.

"God damn it, Eraser I hate you." He growled, turning to face him again as his fists clenched and unclenched at his sides. "Start talking."

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

From inside of his cocoon of blankets, Izuku groaned as his phone buzzed on the coffee table. He cracked his eyes open and blinked blearily in the dimly lit room. He must have fallen asleep watching movies with Hizashi, then, and the man had left him on the sofa.

His phone buzzed again and he huffed as he extracted his arm enough to fumble for the device. Squinting at the device, he cursed the light as he tapped at the screen to unlock the device.

Toucchan 04:45
HATE YOU

Toucchan 04:45
HATE YOUR DAD

Toucchan 04:45
Dont you dare go to your moms without telling me so i can be nearby

Izuku squinted at the screen, trying to figure out exactly what the hell Dabi was on about. And how the fuck he knew about the plan to go visit his mother.

He struggled to sit up and extract himself from his blankets as the sound of the front door opening reached his ears. Shouta came into view, pausing when he noticed the teenager squinting at him warily from the nest of blankets.

The man sighed and dropped his keys and bag on the table next to the entryway before moving into the living room. He moved like he thought the teen was going to explode at him, carefully sitting at Izuku's feet at the other end of the sofa.

"I'm guessing you have something to do with Dabi blowing my phone up this early in the morning." Izuku grumbled, waving his phone at him crankily.

Shouta sighed heavily and leaned back against the sofa, slumping a little in exhaustion, and Izuku felt a tiny bit bad. Just a little. But mostly he was panicking because his dad and Dabi in the same place? Unsupervised? Fuck that.

"He sought me out, not the other way around." Shouta said, leaning his head back against the sofa and speaking the words to the ceiling. "Had something for you."

The man shuffled a little to pull something out of his belt and lifted it up and out to the teen. Izuku hesitated for a moment before taking the bundle from him, fingers curling into the fabric that was passed to him.

He didn't have to look at it for more than two seconds to know what it was.

Izuku hid his face in the fabric of the hoodie, trying to will the tears from his eyes. Because honestly? He should not be this emotional over a goddamn hoodie.

There was silence between the teen and adult while Izuku tried to pull himself together. It took several minutes but when he pulled his face away from the fabric and met his dad's gaze, his eyes were dry.

There was a pit in the bottom of his stomach, though, because of the look on Shouta's face. It was contemplative and Izuku knew deep down that the resulting conversation was not going to be something he wanted to talk about. But apparently it was something Shouta needed to know.

He wasn't going to break the silence on that, though. Shouta could ask what he wanted to know and Izuku wouldn't answer a moment sooner.

He was gonna be a tiny bit petty about him essentially tattling on him to Dabi. Sue him.

They stared each other down for several long moments before Shouta sighed and let his head fall back against the sofa.

“He’s an adult, Izuku, you’re a child. You have to know my stance on that.” He said finally, eyes closed.

Izuku bristled at his tone of voice, forcing himself to take a few deep breaths before he said something…rude. He counted backwards from ten in his head and forced himself not to react.

“I respect the fact that you’re just looking out for me, I do, but you don’t know anything about the situation. He’s never done anything inappropriate and never would.” Izuku started, balling up the hoodie between his hands to steady himself.

“Then explain it to me, Izuku, because from where I’m sitting there are hundreds of red flags waving in my face.” His father shot back, lifting his head once more to pin Izuku with a serious stare.

“It’s simple, Dad, he’s mine.” The teen growled, temper flaring before he could reign it in. “Just like Kacchan is mine.”

He took a steadying breath and forced himself to drop the stare down he had inadvertently started with Shouta. There wasn’t a better explanation in his mind but he had to try and make Shouta understand. He had to stop whatever twisted assumptions the man was making in his mind about everything because he refused to have to choose between his people if his dad put pressure on the situation.

“Honestly, I don’t know how to put it into words better than that. He’s very literally, up until recently, the only person who has ever had my back and cared. So yeah, I’m a little clingy and I’m not going to lie and say I don’t love him.” He could see the way his dad’s face hardened and he rushed to try and make him understand. His fingers twisted nervously in the hoodie and he thanked all the gods listening that Dabi had the foresight to send him a new one.

“I…I don’t..feel things like..what you’re thinking. I tried to once with someone age appropriate, calm down, and I just…can’t. It’s uncomfortable trying to force that kind of attraction…” He glanced up at Shouta’s face, trying to find anything in his expression.

The older man’s brows were pinched, puzzling out where Izuku was going with this. The teen took a deep breath and plowed on forward, hoping to make the man understand.

“I…thought I was broken, honestly, and Dabi talked through it with me.” He flashed his dad a small smile and saw the understanding dawn as he put the puzzle pieces together. “Do you understand, kind of?”

“Yes. Okay, yes.” Shouta rubbed at his face with his hands and heaved out a deep sigh. “I don’t fully like it but that’s a me problem. I’ll adjust.”

The older man seemed to be bracing himself as he got up and moved to the bag he’d brought in with him and retrieved it. He turned and walked back to the sofa and dropped the bag in Izuku’s lap. At the teen’s questioning stare, he motioned for him to open it as he moved to sit back down.

“I was very painfully reminded that you are more than capable of defending yourself if you have the right tools, tonight.” He sounded pained as he said it, eyes rolling skyward. “Declawing you is doing you a disservice.”

Izuku glanced between him and the bag before snatching it up and unzipping it quickly. He couldn’t help the happy noise that left him as he dived into the bag and started pulling out what looked like the majority of his knife collection.

“Do. Not. Throw any of these at All Might.” He warned, pinning the teen in place with a stare.

“Sure. Right. No throwing knives. I’ll just use the stabbing ones.”

“Izuku!”

Chapter End Notes

I'm sorry for the delay in this chapter! I was having a ton of trouble with this chapter and honestly I kinda hate it but I need to get it out of the way to get to the next part. Next up, Inko Midoriya enters into the chat.

Please please please let me know what you think!

Momma, just killed a man

Chapter Summary

The conversation with Inko begins on the wrong foot

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It didn't take long to put together everything they needed for the conversation with Inko Midoriya. In truth, there wasn't really much preparation that they could do. If Izuku's plan worked, the woman would be none the wiser for where her son went afterwards.

Nezu and Shouta spent the day before going over all the paperwork for Izuku's new identity and adoption. Nezu was going to push the paperwork through with his connections while they were visiting the Midoriya household.

If everything went smoothly, this whole thing would be behind them soon.

At the end of the paperworkathon Nezu leaned back in his chair and pinned Shouta with a critical stare, paws coming up as he steepled them in front of him.

"Have you given any thought to what you're going to do if what we suspect is true? What will you do if Izuku truly is the son of All for One?" He asked seriously.

Shouta pinned him with a bored stare and leaned back in his chair.

"Make sure no one ever finds out and keep him safe. I'm not going to abandon the kid, if that's what you're worried about. I'm a little insulted you'd even think it at this point." The man grumbled.

Nezu nodded and something in his posture relaxed a little. Shouta tried not to take offense to the suspicion, especially considering all he'd done so far to keep the kid happy and safe. Izuku was his kid now, he couldn't care less about the biological parents as long as they stayed away from his kid.

"I had to be sure, Shouta."

The man sighed and rubbed his hands over his face, slumping back as he nodded.

"I know. This isn't exactly known territory."

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

The next day found Shouta escorting Izuku and Bakugo up the stairs to the apartment of a one Inko Midoriya.

The man paused outside of the door before knocking, turning to Izuku who put away his phone and wiped his hands on his pants nervously. The teenager met his questioning look evenly, though and forced himself to take a deep breath.

“We don’t have to do this if it’s too much, Izuku. We can leave.” Shouta reiterated, placing a hand on the teen’s shoulder and giving it a small squeeze.

Said teen shook his head quickly, straightening up and squaring his shoulders.

“No. I need to face her and get an explanation.” He said, meeting Shouta’s gaze evenly. “Besides, Dabi’s already waiting nearby and if I got him out here for nothing he might actually skin me alive.”

Both Shouta and Bakugo rolled their eyes at that. He kept himself from retorting though by turning to face the door and lifting his fist to knock on it.

It only took a few moments for the door to swing open and reveal Inko Midoriya, blinking at them curiously. Shouta was struck by just how much Izuku took after the woman. There was no denying that this woman was his mother, biologically speaking. He could also feel from the way Izuku stiffened up next to him that this was going to be a long conversation.

Inko’s eyes moved across the three of them quickly, eyes wide as saucers as she took in her son.

“Ma’am, may we come in and discuss some things with you? It’s rather important.” Shouta said gently, bringing her attention back to him.

The woman nodded shakily and stepped out of the way for them to step inside. Izuku led the way down the hall into the living room, apparently still familiar with the layout of the apartment. The teen paused in the middle of the room, shoulders hunched and face carefully blank as his mother came to stand in front of him.

“My baby.” She murmured finally, lifting up her hands to cup his face before drawing him into a hug. “Izuku! You’re really here!”

Shouta watched the kid awkwardly hug her back before trying to wiggle his way out of her embrace. She let him go after a moment of wiggling and turned her tearful gaze.

“Let’s sit down, Mrs. Midoriya. There’s a lot to discuss.” Shouta said evenly, nerves on edge from how absolutely uncomfortable Izuku looked as he edged his way back around to his side.

From the corner of his eye he could see Bakugo shifting around to sit on the sofa and pulling Izuku down next to him. Shouta was going to have to have a talk with the teenager and praise his instincts.

Inko sat on the sofa across from the three of them, wringing her hands and dabbing at her eyes with a handkerchief.

“To begin, your son is in my custody at the moment until we sort out some things.” Shouta started, leaning forward so his elbows were on his knees and he was pinning the woman in place with his stare.

Hopefully that would keep her focused on him instead of the teen next to him.

“Custody? What’s happened? What’s he done?” Inko’s eyes flickered briefly to Izuku before bouncing back to Shouta.

Shouta’s gaze bounced over to Izuku for a moment, something in his gut hesitating with what they’d agreed on. The teenager’s gaze was sharp as he noticed Shouta’s hesitation, giving him a small ‘go on’ nod towards his mother.

Gritting his teeth, he turned his attention back to Inko who was still staring at him looking ever the picture of a grieving mother. Something nagged at Shouta’s mind, though. He couldn’t put his finger on it but something was…wrong.

He pushed it aside for the moment and got back to why they were here in the first place.

“He’s been accused of acts of villainy. However, as he did aid in Bakugo’s rescue we’ve kept him in custody.” Shouta recited the reason Izuku had presented, watching the woman’s face carefully.

Something flickered in the woman’s expression but Shouta couldn’t see what it was before she dropped her head into her hands and began to sob. Her shoulders shook and something in Shouta’s stomach twisted.

Logic said this is what a mother looked like being told her son was a villain and a criminal.

“Izuku! How could you? You were always such a good boy…” The woman sobbed, turning her eyes to Izuku now. Her eyes shined with unshed tears and the teen looked away from her quickly, sinking into Bakugou’s side in shame.

The woman wiped at her eyes and straightened up, giving a small nod to herself and turning her gaze back to Shouta.

“I will take responsibility for him, sir, I am truly sorry for all of the problems he’s caused.” She said, moving to stand up.

“That is not why we’re here, ma’am.” Shouta said quickly, holding out a hand to her and motioning for her to return to her seat. “We’re here because..”

“I’ve been with Dad the entire time, Mom.” Izuku cut in, voice trembling. When Shouta looked over to the teenager, he found unshed tears in the boys eyes as he stared at his mother. “Why didn’t you tell me?”
The woman froze in place, eyes wide and her hand halfway to her face to dab at her eyes.

“What…are you talking about, Izuku? Your father is in America…” The woman said slowly, hand lowering into her lap as she stared down the teen.

It struck Shouta now what was wiggling around in the back of his mind. The woman seemed…hollow. Her performance was good for the emotions she was supposed to be portraying but it didn’t ring true.

This reaction, though? This was the first genuine reaction she’d shown since she opened the door to them.

Izuku seemed to have clocked the same thing because he was on his feet in an instant, hands fisted at his sides as he stared the woman down. Both Shouta and Bakugo reached up to try and pull him back down onto the sofa but the teen shook their hands off.

“I said I’ve been with Dad this entire time! You know, the villain in charge of the League of Villains? All For One.” The teen spat the words, glaring down at the woman.

In an instant, her expression shifted from ‘the grieving mother’ to…something else.

“Izuku Midoriya, you’ve been with those people?! I taught you better than that!” She scolded, face hardening and tears disappearing in the blink of an eye.

“No you didn’t! You locked me in my room and looked the other way whenever something happened!” Izuku grit out, stomping his foot in frustration. “How much did you know about this? Were you aware the entire time that you’re married to a monster?!”

“How dare you?! I haven’t seen or talked to that man in ten years. He stopped sending me money after your quirk didn’t come in for sure.” She sniffed again, this time in derision and ran a hand through her hair. “He’d call to talk to you sometimes but even that stopped when he realized all you cared about were your stupid heroes!”

“That’s enough.” Shouta said, cutting off Izuku as he opened his mouth. “We’re here to talk about your husband, not Izuku.”

Inko’s gaze cut his way again, this time full of disgust. The woman shook her head fiercely and stood up.

“We will do no such thing. Get out of my house. My son and I have things to…discuss.” The way her eyes hardened when she cut her gaze back to Izuku made every protective instinct in Shouta rise.

It had the same effect on Bakugo, it seemed, as he rose to his feet as well and addressed the woman.

“He’s not staying here with you, old hag!” The teen’s voice was low and dangerous as he reached out to pull Izuku closer to himself as if she was going to snatch him up and put him out of reach.

“Katsuki Bakugo don’t you take that tone of voice with me.” The woman shot back, expression cold. “What would your mother have to say about you defending a..a…a villain!”

“My mother would punch you in your stupid fucking face, hag!” Bakugo shot back with a snarl, this time full on stepping in front of Izuku to hide him from his mother’s sight. “She’s even said he could come live with us if he wanted.”

The woman’s expression froze and she rocked back on her heels like she’d been slapped. Her grip on her handkerchief was so tight her knuckles turned white as she seemed to process what the teen had said.

“Excuse me? Mitsuki knows about all of this?” Her question seemed to be calm but the storm in her green eyes belied that entirely. “You’re telling me that she has known that my son was alive and did not tell me?!”

Chapter End Notes

It begins! I haven't fully figured out how I want this conversation to go fully but I know how I'm going to end it and I'm so excited for yall to see that.

Next time! The conversation heats up ;D

As always, let me know what you think!

The past echoes

Chapter Summary

The conversation continues

Chapter Notes

So, as we go into this I do have to say that this is just my headcanon of how Izuku's childhood went. We have no solid proof in canon if he experienced any bullying or descrimination beyond Katsuki telling him to take a swan dive. So, yes, I am aware I am exagerating but it's for the sake of drama!

Let the fun continue!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The silence after Inko's question was heavy and charged as she and Katsuki stared each other down. The blonde's hands flexed in front of him as he outright resisted the urge to pop off miniature explosions in his palms. He didn't dare do that in Inko's home, years of punishments and scolding lingering in the back of his mind.

From a better perspective Katsuki could now see exactly how things had gotten to the point where Izuku would rather be a criminal than come home to this woman. The skin on his arms crawled just thinking back to how much he admired this woman once upon a time. Thought she was so much nicer than his own mother.

Katsuki swallowed down the bile that rose up in his throat at the thought. How had he been so blind?

Izuku laid his hand on Katsuki's arm, giving it a small squeeze and shooting him a look that very clearly said he needed to stand down. Katsuki bit back a snarl and let the other teen step out from behind him and face his mother again.

"I told them not to." He said evenly, meeting his mother's gaze. From where he stood Katsuki could see his shoulders square as he prepared for whatever this confrontation would bring. "And that's not why I'm here right now."

"Oh? And do tell, Izuku, why you decided to grace your poor mother with the knowledge that you aren't dead." Inko's voice was cold as she stared down her son, crossing her arms over her chest.

“I wanted you to look me in the face and tell me my father isn’t a criminal.” He ground out and from Katsuki’s place behind him he could see the way Izuku’s hands flexed at his sides.

He glanced away from the mother and son in front of him to Aizawa, whose gaze was bouncing between the two of them quickly and very much looked like he wanted to jump in and try and control the situation. It was obvious that alarm bells were going off in the man’s head at the tone both of the Midoriya’s were using.

Inko throwing her hands in the air drew Katsuki’s attention back to the woman.

“I don’t know what you want from me, Izuku! He left and I did my best to take care of you. For all the good it did me.” She lifted her hands to her face again, pretending to wipe away tears as she turned to Aizawa. Her attempt at sympathy was met with a raised brow.

The woman’s mouth clicked shut around whatever she was about to say to the man. It was obvious from the look on his face he was not going to take her side in this conversation.

“You didn’t have to lie to me and tell me some story about him being in America!” Izuku mirrored his mother by throwing his hands up in the air before turning away from the woman and dragging a hand through his curls. “You could have handled this like a god damn adult instead of letting me walk into that man’s hands without even realizing!”

Inko rocked backwards like she’d been struck at his frustrated yell, brow furrowing as Izuku turned back to face her. The look on his face was pinched and upset and Katsuki wanted nothing more than to pull him away and leave. To avoid this entire conflict.

But that wouldn’t help anything. It wouldn’t bring Izuku the closure or the answers he so desperately seemed to want.

“What does that mean? I’ve been the adult in his situation. I’ve been here. I didn’t abandon you because you didn’t get a quirk.” Inko spat the word quirk like it was disgusting on her tongue. “God forbid I try and protect you from the truth of that hurt.”

The green haired teen didn’t even bother trying to stop the sarcastic laugh from bubbling up in his chest. His hand came up to cover his face as he attempted to bring himself back under control, shoulders shaking with the force of his laughter.

“Protect me? Protect me?!” Izuku dropped his hand, a cold kind of mirth dancing in his eyes. “You didn’t protect me from anything! Your favorite way of dealing with everything was to act like it didn’t happen!”

“I don’t have a clue what you’re talking about.” Inko scoffed and waved a dismissive hand in his direction. “I protected you from everything I possibly could.”

Izuku turned to face Katsuki, his face screaming for him to confirm what he’d just heard. It made Katsuki’s stomach clench and twist uncomfortably when he realized that Aizawa was watching him as well, lips turned down in a frown and brows furrowed.

Before he could answer, Izuku was turning back to his mother with a feral gleam in his eyes.

“I came home every day from school with torn clothes or bruises and you did nothing.” He spat, taking a step closer to his mother. “I cried myself to sleep every night because kids and teachers alike made it very clear that I was never going to be accepted by any of them.”

Inko opened her mouth but Izuku held up his hand and silenced her. Gone was the ‘helpless Izuku’ act that the teen thought his mother would eat up and he had donned at the beginning of the interaction. Katsuki couldn’t even tell you if the woman had noticed that it was an act at first, either, so wrapped up in her own little world and pity party.

No, the energy he was giving off was the same vibe Katsuki had seen in the other teen when he’d stood in front of the burning League hideout joking with Toga and Dabi.

There was no way Inko could mistake this for the same boy that had walked out of her home on that day almost three years ago. One some core level, the teen had changed and grown in ways that she probably couldn’t even fathom.

This Izuku was confident and sure of himself. Katsuki didn’t know what conclusion Izuku had come to in the past few moments but he could already tell whatever it was, Inko was not going to like it.

“First year of middle school, we both sat in that teacher parent conference where my homeroom teacher told you that you might as well get used to the idea of taking care of me for the rest of my life because I had no future.” Izuku’s voice was cold and closed off as he laughed, posture loosening as he purposely did not look at Katsuki and Aizwawa. “And you apologized to him for my ‘behavior’.”

The woman’s face and eyes hardened and she crossed her arms over her chest, obviously done with this conversation.

“I don’t know what you want me to say, Izuku.” She shook her head, heaving a sigh. “I did the best I could. It’s not my fault that you couldn’t wrap your mind around the realities of the world. All you had to do was be realistic and keep your head down.”

Something shifted in Izuku’s posture, all of the fight leaving him. Katsuki watched him warily as all of the tension drained out of the other teenager and his head cocked to the side. It set off alarm bells in his mind as the teen was silent for several long moments.

It seemed to unnerve his mother as she watched her son. She shifted a little while she waited for him to say something. Finally the teen lifted his head and smiled at his mom, head cocking even further to the side.

“I’m sorry, Mom. I wish things were different.” He said, a weird cadence to his voice like he was quoting something. “I’ll make sure you never have to deal with me again.”

SMACK

Both Aizawa and Katsuki jumped at the sound of Inko’s palm cracking against Izuku’s cheek, his head snapping sideways with the force of it. Inko’s entire posture was filled with furry as she raised her hand to repeat the action.

Immediately the two of them moved, Katsuki pulling Izuku back behind him and Aizawa stepping between Izuku and Inko.

Katsuki carefully turned Izuku's face towards him, rage building his gut as he took in the obvious handprint reddening across his face. The teen didn't say a word, just leaning into Katsuki with a far away look in his eyes.

A part of Katsuki wanted to take the green haired teen's phone out of his pocket and call Dabi himself. It was a tiny part that would revel in the destruction the both of them could cause to this apartment and wanted to go feral on the very place that held so many awful memories for Izuku. He was sure Dabi would love a chance to have a crack at the woman since he was the one who put Izuku back together. Or at the very least watched what had to have been a heart wrenching process for the green haired teen.

Instead, he was pulled out of contemplating giving in to his destructive tendencies by Aizawa turning to glare at him and motion towards the door with his head. The man was still blocking both of them from Inko's view.

Katsuki could still see the fury in her eyes, though, and it was something he didn't think he'd ever be able to forget. It was now one of the many things he was going to have to make fit with the new knowledge that this woman was not who he thought she was.

Not who his entire family thought she was. Gods. He was going to have to be the one to tell his mother about this.

"Go. Get him out of here." The older man barked, fully pulling the teen out of whatever he was contemplating.

"He is not going anywhere! He is my son and still a minor. He will be staying here with me where he belongs." Inko interjected, trying to step around Aizawa.

The hero, however, was not having it and blocked her path once more and Katsuki took that as his opportunity to carefully herd Izuku down the hallway and to the front door. He paused as Aizawa's voice floated down the hallway, angry and low.

"You just assaulted that child in front of a pro hero. What makes you think I'm ever letting him step foot back into this house?"

Chapter End Notes

:] Next time, Aizawa has some choice words for the woman who just struck his child.

I'm kinda of weirdly proud of how this turned out even if it's not that long? IDK.

Bribe me to write faster with kind words my friends! Let me know what you think!

Flies to a place where she's loved

Chapter Summary

Aizawa argues with Inko, Dabi enters the scene, Izuku has a moment of clarity.

Chapter Notes

The response to last chapter literally makes me want to cry happy tears. I'm so glad that everyone is enjoying this story this much!!!

I am so sorry that this chapter is so late! Things irl have been beyond chaotic and stressful so I struggled writing this chapter. I will do my best to be on schedule going forward!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“You just assaulted that child in front of a pro hero. What makes you think I’m ever letting him step foot back into this house?” Shouta’s voice was low and angry as he blocked the woman from following Bakugou and Izuku out of the house.

The green haired woman tried to push her way past him and he had to seriously reign in the urge to use his capture weapon on her. Instead, he stepped in her way once more. Gone was the grieving mother facade. Now there was a simmering rage in her eyes as she glared up at him.

On the surface, he could see how this woman was Izuku’s mother. Under the surface, though? Nothing of this situation made sense to him.

To treat a child like this just because of the lack of a quirk? How could she be so cruel? How could she look Izuku in the face and not help him?

Just thinking of the things that Izuku described happening sent Shouta’s blood boiling. How could she have looked that child in the face and told him that it was his fault.

Shouta couldn’t imagine Izuku at age four crying to him and not doing everything in his power to remove the boy from whatever was causing the pain and the tears. So how could this woman who claimed to love him just ignore all of that?

“That child is mine and you have no authority to make decisions in where he goes.” The woman snapped at him, voice sharp and gaze narrow. “If you continue to interfere I will have

you reported to your agency and your license revoked."

"If you do that, I can promise you that you'll do jail time." Shouta didn't bother keeping the ice out of his voice as he leaned down into the woman's space. "I personally just witnessed you assault him. And if the things he says are true, then you at the very least will be charged with child neglect."

He watched his words sink in her mind and the flip switch within her. She scoffed and turned away from him, crossing her arms over her chest as she did so.

"As if the courts would believe the word of a quirkless villain over his poor mother."

The words struck something deep in Shouta's gut. His vision washed out red and for a very brief moment he wasn't sure if his quirk had activated or not. Rage pumped through his veins and he had to take a huge breath to attempt to calm himself.

"That child is one of the brightest and most caring people I've ever met in my life. Are you really so blind that you can't see the amazing child in front of you?!." He spat, frustration and anger bubbling up and trying to close his throat. "He has been through hell and all you can do is blame him for something he literally has no control over?"

The woman turned to face Shouta again, face hard and eyes cold. Suddenly the resemblance between her and Izuku was gone.

"He ruined my life." She snarled, arms uncrossing as she gestured wildly. "All he had to do was have a damn quirk! The day that doctor diagnosed him everything was ruined!"

She turned away from him, then, pacing back towards the sofa as she continued to rant.

"My life was perfect! I had a decent career! My husband was home all the time. He doted on us until that brat couldn't even manage to manifest a quirk!" The woman's eyes were wild as she looked around the apartment.

"Hisashi stopped coming home after that. He'd send money but he always had more important business. At first I tried to spare Izuku's feelings but after a while what did it matter? All he did was cry anyway so I gave up."

The woman's voice was hollow as she turned to face Shouta again. Her eyes, though, seemed to implore him to understand where she was coming from. As if he could even picture blaming a child for something they literally had no control over. As if he could understand treating Izuku the way she had.

"Then why are you not happy that he wants nothing to do with you? From your logic, you should be happy to see him go." Shouta intoned, hands flexing at his sides as he tried to keep himself under control.

The woman glared at him, shoulders coming up around her ears.

"And have him running loose? He's already a damn villain! There's no telling what he's out there destroying right now." She gestured wildly to the hallway Bakugou and Izuku had

disappeared down, voice loud and tone cruel.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

Katsuki had barely closed the apartment door behind them when Izuku crashed into his chest, latching into him as his shoulders shook.

He very carefully shuffled to the side so he could lean back against the wall next to the door before wrapping his arms around Izuku. One hand swept over his back carefully while the other gently carded through his curls.

The teen made no sound, even though Katsuki could feel the wetness of his tears soaking into his shirt. He stayed quiet as the green haired boy fought to get himself under control. This breakdown was expected, honestly, considering the awful things that woman had said to him in the short time they'd been in the apartment.

Katsuki's own mother wasn't sunshine and roses before therapy but she had never said anything close to as awful as what Inko had spewed at her own son. If Izuku had grown up with a mother as resentful of his very existence suddenly a lot of things made sense.

A renewed sense of guilt bubbled up in Katsuki's stomach and he tightened his grip on the teen in his arms. Between his mother and Katsuki's bullying it was no wonder Izuku thought his only option was that bridge.

It took several long moments for Izuku's tears to slow and for his grip on Katsuki's shirt to loosen. He could feel the several deep breaths the teen took before lifting his head to peek up at the blonde, brows drawn and eyes red rimmed.

"None of that was your fault, Izu." Katsuki said quietly, answering the silent question in the teen's eyes. "Your mom is the one to blame. No one is going to judge you because of her prejudices."

Green eyes flushed with tears again, one hand coming up to try and scrub them away quickly.

Watching the teen attempt to pull himself together, something nagged at the back of the blonde's mind. Call it morbid curiosity.

"I…do have a question, though?" Katsuki started hesitantly, waiting till the boy mostly had himself together to voice his curiosity. He continued once he got a head tilt from the other, silent permission to go on. "That..thing you said in there, before she slapped you, please tell me that wasn't from your…you know…"

Izuku blinked at him, confused for a moment, before the understanding clicked in his mind and he very quickly raised both hands up and shook his head very quickly.

"Oh my god! No!" His voice rose a few octaves before he got a hold of himself again and dropped his hands and glanced away from Katsuki, not meeting his gaze again. "It…was something she said to me after I was diagnosed quirkless."

The teen's shoulders slumped again, still refusing to meet Katsuki's eye.

"I…was so upset that I couldn't be a hero that I watched that All Might video over and over again before…I asked her if I could still be like him. If I could still be a hero without a quirk."

Izuku pulled away from Katsuki a little, crossing his arms over his chest. His entire posture and stance closed him off from Katsuki and the blonde grit his teeth against the anger swelling in his chest once more.
If Inko thought Katsuki wasn't going to tell his mother about this in great detail later, she was a fool. They might not be able to physically deal with the woman without risking their licenses but Mitsuki Bakugo was a whole other story.

Katuski was drawn out of his rage filled fantasy of watching his mother beat Inko by Izuku's voice, the teen continuing on with his explanation.

"It was by far the nicest answer she ever gave me but somehow it still hurts the worst." Izuku's voice was small as he hunched in on himself a little. "When I said it in there I was just trying to provoke her to drop the act. I didn't think she'd actually hit me…"

"She's going to regret laying a single finger on you when I'm done with her." A voice growled, making both teens jump a little as they turned towards the new voice.

Dabi stood a few feet away, entire stance screaming rage just as clearly as the little flickers of flames that danced between his fingers as his hands clenched and unclenched at his sides. Those flames, though, disappeared as he stepped closer and raised them to carefully cradle Izuku's face. He turned the teen's face gently, fingers brushing over where Inko had slapped him checking for damage.

The green haired teen watched him with wide eyes as the flame-quirked man continued to scrutinize his face. Whatever Dabi found there, he apparently didn't like because he let out a frustrated little growl and tugged Izuku closer and into a hug.

Katsuki didn't miss the way that the green haired teen slumped into the other. He did, however, ignore the stab of something heavy and painful in his chest. There was no time or room at the moment to be worried about whatever was going on between Izuku and Dabi.

That would be something for later. Something he'd take out on either Kirishima or a punching bag in training and never, ever, talk about.

He was allowed some unhealthy coping mechanisms, okay.

Izuku, unable to focus on himself for more than five seconds, took a step back from Dabi after a moment and fixed him with a pointed stare.

"How did you even know about that? And what are you doing here?! If you get caught I don't think even Dad will be able to keep you out of jail." He huffed at the older.

Dabi just raised a brow at him, reaching out to snag his hoodie and pull it over his head before turning to Katsuki.

“I posted up on the building across the way so I could watch through the window. No one saw me come in, Izu, relax. But I am not letting you go back in that apartment without me in case she tries something like that again.” Dabi drawled, gaze bouncing back to Izuku for that last part.

Izuku opened his mouth to argue and was shot with almost identical disbelieving looks from both of his companions.

“...okay. I just need to grab something from my old bedroom if she didn’t throw it away.” He mumbled, suitably chastised.

“She didn’t.” Katsuki grimaced, glancing back to the door of the apartment. “My mom told me that she kept your room exactly the same, like some sort of weird shrine.”

Dabi snorted, arms crossed over his chest as he glared at the door as well.

“She probably enjoys the attention and pity she gets from having a dead kid.”

Katsuki was about to retort, the barbed words dying on his tongue as his and the others eyes were pulled in the direction of the apartment door once more as Inko’s voice raised inside once more.

“-him running loose? He’s already a damn villain! There’s no telling what he’s out there destroying right now.”

Her voice echoed in Katsuki’s mind for a moment before his gaze joined Dabi’s in swiveling towards Izuku.

The green haired teen’s fists were clenched at his sides and a muscle in his jaw jumped from how hard he was clenching his teeth. His face, though, was blank. It reminded Katsuki for just a moment of what he’d seen on the other’s face during the brief fight inside of the bar that was the league hideout.

When Izuku’s eyes raised, the rage that filled those green eyes rooted Katsuki in place for a moment. It took him a moment to follow when the other teen stepped forward and practically threw the door to the apartment open and stormed back down the hallway.

Both Dabi and Katsuki scrambled after the teen after sharing a worried glance.

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

What right did she have to call him a villain? What right did she have to make any kind of judgments on how he pieced himself and his life back together? She’d not once been there for him since he was four years old. So what right did she have to judge him?

Especially when she herself was married to the god damn original villain!

Izuku was seething as he kicked the door open and stormed back down the hallway towards the living room. Both adults turned to look at him as he stormed into the room, only one gaze holding any kind of emotion towards him.

He met his mother's flat gaze with a snarl, stepping forward and into the woman's space. He just barely registered that his dad was saying anything, the tone soothing and placating enough that he just ignored it.

"You do not get to call me a villain." Izuku hissed at her, barely resisting the urge to reach out and touch her in some way. He longed to lash out but resisted on the principle that he was not going to give her the satisfaction.

Her own gaze was starting to heat up as well, the anger and resentment shining through now that she'd been called on it. He cut her off, though, as she opened her mouth to speak.

"No! You don't get a say or an opinion on me or how I live my damn life. You may not have abandoned me physically but that's the only point in your favor." He snarled, enjoying the way she flinched at the words. "You don't get an award for doing the bare fucking minimum!"

His chest heaved as he tried to calm himself. She wanted him angry, obviously, so she could claim that he attacked her.

Whatever she was going to say, though, was washed away as she caught sight of Dabi. The burned villain was hanging back next to Aizawa, seemingly delighted at the chance to watch Izuku smackdown his mother verbally. He smirked at the woman as she paled and took a step back.

Her gaze jumped between Katsuki and Dabi, her mouth opening and closing as she tried to make the situation make sense in her worldview.

"Please. I am begging you to say something ignorant, lady, so I have an excuse to burn this place to the ground." Dabi grinned widely at her, flames dancing across his fingers as he waved at her cheerfully.

Izuku was probably the only one that saw the look his dad sent Dabi and the elbow he dug into his side the moment Inko wasn't looking. Dabi didn't look repentant, though, and that seemed to make his dad more exasperated than wrathful for the moment. It warmed something deep in Izuku's heart to see the two interact in such a..normal way. It cooled his rage a little and let his mind clear just a little.

He looked away from the two to turn his attention towards Kacchan who was now standing next to him with his arms crossed and glaring at his mother. The woman looked off balance, not used to people not buying her 'nice and sweet' routine and seeing her for what she actually was. She was also definitely not used to Kacchan actually standing up to her. Today was a day of firsts for her.

“I’m getting my notebooks and then I’m leaving, Inko.” Izuku said finally, letting the rage seap out of his posture.

He had something better waiting for him back at U.A. This visit hadn’t really been all that helpful when it came to the unanswered question about his father, not really, but it had been helpful in a whole other way.

Izuku could finally let go of the tiny little part of him that hoped that Inko would actually love him. That he would be something other than a burden to her. Sure, it wasn’t exactly a pleasant experience killing that part of himself but it was cathartic to watch people he loved stand up for him.

He didn’t wait for her answer, didn’t really need it, as he turned away from her and headed towards his old bedroom. Once this was done he could put all of this behind him. He could focus forward and let go of everything that was stopping him from finally reinventing himself fully.

Izuku Midoriya was dead and gone.

He was going to become someone better. Someone that could actually do something about the shitty lot he’d been given in life originally.

Now, the only question was if he was going to be Izuku Yamada-Aizawa or Izuku Aizawa-Yamada. He’d have to discuss it with his dads once he got home.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this chapter! I know everyone wanted to see Aizawa beat Inko but I honestly don't think he'd risk it. He's just trying to wrap his brain around her treating Izuku like trash when he is literally a damn ball of sunshine lol.

Someone asked for some softness after all of this and I thought I'd deliver a little bit of fluff there in the middle just for them~ Don't worry, though, there's definitely going to be some comfort after all of this hurt. We're going to be wrapping up Inko's stuff next chapter and I think, maybe, heading into the home stretch of this story!

As always, bribe me with your thoughts~

Bye, Bye, Bye

Chapter Summary

Soft, soft, comfort

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Footsteps followed Izuku down the hall but he didn't acknowledge the person until he'd already pushed open the door to his old bedroom and stepped inside.

Kacchan had been right when he'd said that his mother hadn't touched the room. To outsiders it would look like a grieving mother trying to keep the memory of her son alive. Not a thing in the room had been moved out of place from where he'd left it three years ago.

Everything was covered in a thick layer of dust that spiraled up into the air as he stepped further into the room. From every wall and surface All Might's face grinned at him mockingly and he had to take a deep breath to stop himself from tearing at the posters covering every inch of the walls just to be petty.

Behind him, Shouta let out a small hum of surprise as he followed the teen into the room. He paused right behind Izuku, gaze bouncing around the room and taking in the overwhelming amount of merch adorning the walls and shelves of the small bedroom.

There were a few non All Might pieces throughout the room, of course. Shouta's gaze was sure to be drawn to the Present Mic clock radio on his bedside table. Izuku had pondered over a very similar model for a long time when they'd gone shopping for his room in the apartment before apparently deciding against it.

There was a single Endeavor poster in one of the corners of the room. Even before finding out the awful truth about how the man treated his family Izuku had never really been that big of a fan of the man.

Call it an instinct he'd developed to avoid bullies.

Izuku pulled himself out of that depressing thought with a small shake of his head, heaving a small sigh as he made his way over to the long abandoned desk. He grimaced a little as he sank down into the chair, fanning the air around him in an attempt to push away the dust that was floating up into his face at the movement.

"Do you think it's a good idea to leave Kacchan and Dabi alone with her?" He asked idly, breaking the silence and the uncomfortable atmosphere between the two.

Shouta didn't even look away from where he was still assessing a shelf full of figurines, simply raising his shoulders in a small shrug.

"Probably not but I imagine they'll have some very colorful threats to make her think twice about opening her mouth about this visit once we leave." The hero said with a small hum, seeming totally unbothered in the moment.

Said teen just shook his head a little and reached out to open the small cabinet underneath the desk. He was careful as he pulled out the notebooks he'd poured his entire soul into as a child, fingers sliding over their covers reverently as he set them in his lap. He swallowed the lump in his throat, refusing to cry any more today. This was one of the few good things that this visit was going to give him.

Shouta moved silently as he padded across the room. He lowered himself down onto the bed as carefully as he could manage, trying not to kick up any more dust into the air. Izuku purposely didn't look at him for a long moment, knowing what the man was probably thinking right now.

It was a conversation he knew they needed to have. To help his dad understand him a little bit better. To help him understand why what the former number one hero had done that day had cut so deep even beside having his childhood friend tell him to take a swan dive.

He desperately didn't want to relive that conversation, though. It was bad enough typing it all up for the class that day, he didn't think he could fully do it again. Shouta seemed to sense this and stayed silent, waiting for Izuku to either broach the topic or come up with a diversion to delay it once more.

Let it be known that Izuku had never once faced an emotion head on if he could dodge around it. So instead of jumping head first into the explanation of what exactly had happened he turned his attention back down to his lap, adjusting his grip on his notebooks as he shuffled through them trying to find the one he was looking for.

He flipped open the pages of one of his earlier notebooks, glad that this one wasn't in crayon. It was still obviously a child's hand that wrote it but it was in pencil this time and not the bright green crayon of the first two or three of the notebooks.

Finding the page he was looking for, he twisted in his seat to fully face Shouta and held out the notebook to him.

The man reached out and took the object carefully, eyes falling on the sketch of himself with his capture weapon extended. Izuku watched the man's eyes skip around the drawing for a moment, taking in the detail of the pose and the way the scarf was drawn.

The teen managed to stay silent for a few moments before he began to drum his fingers against the other notebooks, eyes darting around the room to avoid looking at Shouta as he began to read the analysis his younger self had poured over for what felt like months.

It hadn't exactly been easy to find any information on the underground hero. He'd lost so much sleep during that particular analysis fixation that his grades had slipped and his mother had cracked down even harder on not letting him go anywhere. It'd been worth it, though!

Now? Now it was the perfect way to segue into the conversation that needed to happen. A way to brush right up against it with enough room to dance away if it was too much.

"I..uh…I saw you take down a villain, once, when I was younger. Maybe 8? I don't remember." Izuku started carefully, keeping his gaze down on his hands and picking at the cover of one of the notebooks to distract himself from the weight settling in his gut. "I'd been chased pretty far by some of the other kids and was hiding in an alley until I was sure they were gone…"

He'd been out there for hours and it was way past the time he'd supposed to have been home. The boy had stayed crouched behind that dumpster for so long that he was almost afraid of going home, honestly, to whatever panic his mother had probably worked herself up into.

"After I saw you, I went online trying to figure out who you were and found out that you fought quirkless…"

Izuku blinked back the wetness building in his eyes, refusing to give in to the emotions swirling in his gut. He could feel the weight of Shouta's gaze on him but he refused to meet his eye, instead turning his gaze back out onto his room and glaring at the All Might posters.

"Of course, being underground and all, I couldn't find any merch for you but you were one of my favorite heroes. You and All Might were kinda what kept me going, you know? Every time someone pushed me, or told me I was better off dead…."

He jumped a little as Shouta reached out to pull him into a hug, notebooks falling onto the floor as he let himself be maneuvered into his arms. His gripped the back of his jumpsuit for dear life and buried his face in the man's chest, shoulders shaking a little under the man's grip as he tried to pull himself together.

"I know I shouldn't have done it. I know it was stupid but I just had to ask him." Izuku mumbled, words almost muffled in his dad's chest. He knew Shouta could hear him, though, by the soothing rumble the man made as he shifted them into a comfortable position sitting on the bed.

Once the words started, he couldn't stop them. They flowed from his mouth just as freely as the tears were beginning to flow from his eyes once more.

"I adored him, dad. I mean, who doesn't, but I latched onto him when I was little as what a hero should look like, you know? I watched his debut rescue over and over again. Mom used to joke that all of the views on the video were mine." He pushed the thought of his mother and that video from his mind, though, and continued on.

Too many memories he didn't ever want to relive, there.

“So when he rescued me from the sludge villain it was my only shot at asking the one question I couldn’t ask anyone else. I…” He forced himself to breath, pulling away a little to wipe at his face quickly and a little aggressively.

“He didn’t live up to expectations?” Shouta intoned blandly. Izuku was relieved to see a small bit of mischief in his eyes when he peeked up at him.

Izuku snorted and flashed Shouta a small smile, shifting so he was sitting on the bed next to him instead of damn near in his lap.

“I…I just wanted so badly to be a hero. All I’ve ever wanted is to help, you know? I started these notebooks because I figured if I could break down heroes' fighting styles and strategies it would help, somehow…” Izuku trailed off a little as he leaned down to scoop the notebooks up once more and settle them safely into his lap.

Silence settled between the two of them, not uncomfortable but definitely heavy. Shouta could put the rest together, finally having all of the puzzle pieces to the teenager next to him. Izuku was sure that so much of him and his situation were clear to the man now but strangely he wasn’t worried that this was going to be the final straw anymore.

Maybe it was the constant back to back disasters that had befallen him since he’d come to U.A but there was a certainty in his gut now that said Shouta and Hizashi weren’t going to abandon him.

It’d been a major worry for him, in the beginning, when he’d seen just how kind and welcoming they were but now? No, they wouldn’t do that to him.

He’d finally found somewhere he belonged.

Izuku opened his mouth to suggest that it was time to go. That he was ready to put all of this behind him once and for all. He didn’t get the words out, though, because Shouta had shifted to face him, face serious as he made sure Izuku was looking at him properly.

“For what it’s worth, kid, you’d make an amazing underground hero if you ever wanted to try.” The man rumbled, voice and expression one hundred percent serious as he pinned the teen in place with his gaze.

For a moment Izuku floundered, mouth opening and closing as he tried to process the words coming out of the man’s mouth.

“I…” It honestly felt like his brain had shut down for a moment, completely unable to comprehend the words.

Shouta seemed to understand, though, and gently took the notebooks out of Izuku’s hand and stood up. Once he was stable on his feet, he held out his free hand to haul the teen up off of the bed with a small smile.

“Just saying. If you ever want to give it a shot, I’m sure Nezu would be up for taking a few swings at the commission for you.”

Numbly, the teen nodded and let the man steer him out of the room. He was pulled out of his circling, numb, thoughts by the click of the door behind him and the realization that the chapter of his life he’d lived in that room was now, officially, over.

If he could burn it to the ground without consequence he absolutely would just to make absolutely sure it would never hold power over him again.

But it was against the law and generally frowned upon. Especially by the man that was carefully steering him down the hall with a steady hand on his back.

Maybe later he could convince Dabi to come back?

Judging by the look on the man’s face as they reentered into the living room, the flame quirked man would probably be up for it.

Dabi’s smile was angry and closer to a sneer than anything else from his perch across from Inko on the sofa. Kacchan didn’t look all that happy, either, so Izuku was betting his mother had picked another petty little fight while they’d been in the room.

Inko’s eyes snapped to Izuku the moment he stepped in the door and he felt an unfamiliar annoyance settling in his gut as she glared at him, hands balling up in her lap like she was resisting the urge to strike out at him physically again.

“Izuku Midoriya I raised you better than this! Associating with this…disgusting trash villain.” She hissed, eyes bouncing between Izuku and Dabi in a way that the teenager didn’t care for.

“Well, you didn’t ‘raise’ me to do anything so I guess you are right there.” He snapped back, suddenly ready to be out of this situation and apartment.

He wanted to go curl up and sleep for a week straight and not think about anything that had just happened today.

“And that ‘disgusting trash’ is the one who saved my damn life so maybe shut the fuck up about things you don’t understand?”

He almost laughed at the scandalized noise the woman let out. Kacchan and Dabi both didn’t even bother hiding their amusement, Kaachan snorting loudly and Dabi out and out laughing in the woman’s face. Izuku could hear Shouta behind him heave a sigh before pushing at Izuku’s back and directing him towards the front door.

Time to go, then.

Dabi and Kacchan took the hint as well, standing up and not even looking at the woman as they moved towards the door. From behind the group, Izuku could hear the woman jump up and start to follow.

He turned to glance back at her, brow raised as posture tense. He wanted this to be over, for good.

“If you walk out of that door, don’t you ever come back.” Inko said after a moment, gaze dark and voice angry.

Izuku didn’t even look at the others or say anything as he turned back and opened the front door, stepping out and waiting for the sweet sound of the door closing behind them.

Chapter End Notes

I AM EXHAUSTED ;A; I've been working on this chapter all day and it just does not want to cooperate with me. I hope everyone enjoyed some Dadzawa time, though!

Next time: Izuku, Dabi, and Bakugou spend some quality time together and figure out wtf they're doing. Maybe some Mitsuki rage if we're lucky.

As always, let me know what you thought!

Smoke fills the lungs like a disease

Chapter Notes

> I'm not 100% happy with the way this turned out but I wanted to at least get the ball rolling on this little heart to heart.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

As soon as the four of them stepped out onto the street, both Katsuki and Dabi stepped up to flank Izuku on either side. The green haired teen didn't seem to notice the glaring contest going on over his head, instead happily reaching out to take both of their hands in his. It seemed whatever emotional epiphany the teen had gone through inside of his mother's apartment had maxed out his capacity to read a room. That or he was stubbornly refusing to acknowledge the tension rising between the two on either side of him as he happily swung their intertwined hands gently.

It was kind of adorable but Katsuki was never going to admit that in present company. It was embarrassing enough that Aizawa was usually present for most of the mushy moments Izuku managed to drag out of him. He wasn't going to give the man more material to judge him on.

And he certainly wasn't going to openly agree with Dabi on anything. The man seemed to agree with that sentiment as the glare over Izuku's head intensified.

Katsuki was pulled away from his staring contest with Dabi by movement out of the corner of his eye. Aizawa turned away from where he'd been obviously observing the three of them to pull his phone out, huffing quietly to himself.

It took Katsuki a moment to realize the man must be calling a car to come get them. Red eyes slid down to see if Izuku had noticed and winced when he saw green eyes on the hero. He couldn't miss the way the other teen's eyes glanced towards Dabi and his hands tightened around their hands.

As much as he hated to spend any more time than necessary in Dabi's company, it was easy to see that Izuku wasn't eager to part just yet. After the day he had, Katsuki couldn't blame him for it.

That thought in mind, he turned his gaze back to Aizawa and braced himself for an uncomfortable evening.

"Hey, my parents live a couple of blocks away." He called to the man, fighting back the urge to snap as the weight of two extra eyes settled on him. "They'll be happy to see Izuku and he looks like he's about ready to drop."

Katsuki ignored the indignant noise said green haired teen let out and found himself in a mini stare down with Aizawa. The man's gaze briefly flickered to Dabi and then back to Katsuki as he seemingly came to the same conclusion the blonde had. And if he didn't know any better, Katsuki would have swore the man rolled his eyes before he turned away.

"Fine. Just so long as they don't overwhelm him." The man grunted, putting his phone away and motioning for Katsuki to lead the way.

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When they arrived at the Bakugo household, Katsuki shooed the two of them up the stairs with a frown. Izuku had opened his mouth to argue and was met with a fierce glare from Katsuki.

"Go lay down, nerd, you look exhausted. Take scarface with you before my parents see him and freak out. I'm just gonna fill them in real quick and get us a snack." His tone brokered no room for argument so Izuku nodded and dragged Dabi up the stairs.

Even after so many years he knew the layout of the house by heart, tugging Dabi along with him into Katsuki's room and closing the door behind them. The bedroom didn't look the same as it did the last time he'd been here but he wasn't really expecting it to.

Ten or so years was a long time, after all.

The events of the day crashed down on Izuku all at once and he tugged Dabi after him as he made his way over to the bed and collapsed down onto it. The villain huffed out a laugh and sat down as well, shifting until he was leaned against the headboard. He seemed to consider something for a moment before reaching down to tug his boots off and set them aside. The villain pulled himself fully up onto the bed and stretched out, back against the wall. Once he settled he nudged at Izuku until he moved enough to curl up next to him with his head in his lap.

Izuku hummed happily as the man's hand carded through his hair before sliding down to cup the back of his neck. The teen sighed a little as the hand heated up and eased the tension he was holding in his neck, fingers tracing over the back of his neck and shoulders gently. He let his eyes drift closed, finally relaxing and letting the quiet wash over him.

Vaguely he thought he could hear Auntie Mitsuki downstairs yelling but for the moment it wasn't his problem. He knew he was dangerously close to falling asleep but the hand tracing patterns against the skin of the back of his neck and the softness of the bed did nothing to deter him from letting everything float away.

Sleep sounded really, really, nice.

And if he was leaving Kacchan and Dabi to figure out whatever issues they were having without him technically being a witness, then all the better.

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Katsuki pushed open his bedroom door, cursing under his breath as he turned to close it softly behind him. Aizawa could deal with his mother. Let the old man get yelled at for not telling her what had been going on with the whole Inko situation instead of him.

The cursing went from under his breath to louder when he turned to face his bed and found Dabi running his hand through an obviously asleep Izuku's hair. The man had his head tilted back against the wall, turning just a little to look at Katsuki as he paused in the middle of the room.

Izuku didn't so much as stir at the blonde's voice, face peaceful and relaxed. The bastard.

Dabi raised a brow at him, not looking too bothered by the fact that Katsuki was glaring at him.

"I thought you said you were bringing snacks?"

Katsuki growled and grabbed a protein bar off of his desk and threw it at the man's head. To his displeasure the man easily caught it and unwrapped it with his free hand. The teen made a face and flopped down into his desk chair with a huff.

Those protein bars tasted horrible and had been sitting on his desk since before he moved into the dorms. They were disgusting. Served the bastard right.

"I hate you." Katsuki announced seriously, spinning in the chair a little so he was facing the man.

All he got in response was a hum as the man let his head drop back against the wall again. Both of their gazes turned to Izuku, who snuffled in his sleep and seemed to curl up closer to the flame quirked man's side.

He wanted to throw something as he watched the man's face soften as his hand worked its way through Izuku's hair again as the teen settled again.

Katsuki's eyes lingered on Izuku for a moment longer, thoughts buzzing angrily at him. The other teen was rarely this relaxed outside of the presence of Katsuki or his dads, honestly. It said something that he was perfectly content to pass out on the villain like it was no big deal.

Who was Katsuki to take away one of the few comforts that Izuku had? It wasn't his place to police who the other teen hung out with, right? It wasn't like they were actually dating and even then he didn't have the right to tell him who he could and couldn't talk to.

So as much as he hated it, Dabi was going to be a fixture in his life for the foreseeable future. Because if he tried to pressure Izuku into dropping the man then he'd end up being the toxic little shit he'd always been and that would leave them right back at the start of this whole mess.

Something clenched in Katsuki's stomach at the thought of the start of this whole mess. No matter how much therapy he went through he was sure he was always going to feel guilty in some way about how he'd treated Izuku.

There were so many nights of sleep lost to the what ifs.

If he hadn't tortured the boy would he have jumped? If he hadn't put Izuku into that mental state, would All Might's callus dismissal of his dream have broken him like it did?

There was no winning with the what ifs, though. He had to do what he could in the moment to move forward. And moving forward right now was sitting in his childhood bedroom watching someone he loved cuddle with a man that haunted his nightmares with blue flames and his classmates screams.

So he might as well start the conversation with their shared history.

"Was it personal, the camp? Did you know what I did to him?" He asked, gaze finally leaving the two of them and finding an interesting spot on the wall to glare at.

He didn't catch the look of panic that flashed across Dabi's face but he didn't hear him choke on his own tongue for a moment. His words, though, were what drew the blonde's gaze back to him.

"Fuck no." Dabi said, coughing to clear his throat a little before he shook his head.

"Really? He didn't mention me or any of the actual reasons he didn't want to come home." Katsuki challenged, hands curling into fists against his legs.

"Oh, he talked about you all the damn time but he always used that dumb nickname." Dabi sneered, relaxing back against the headboard. "I didn't know your actual name until he burst into the bar that night."

Katsuki stared at him for a moment, jaw clenching and unclenching as he processed that information. It was..hard to believe that he'd continued to use that dumb nickname…

"Trust me kid, had I known I would have run the other way. Izu and I weren't on good terms at the time but I still wouldn't have invoked his wrath like that."

The blonde turned those words over in his mind and tried to make sense of them. Izuku had given him a little snippet of why he and Dabi hadn't been in contact at the time but it was missing something, even Katsuki could tell that. Izuku had been keeping some secret for the man that he wouldn't tell even him.

His hands unclenched and tapped out a nervous rhythm against his leg as he pondered over the situation. Looking at the man go back to petting Izuku's hair and keeping perfectly still as to be the perfect pillow it was a little hard to feel the fear that clawed at his throat that night.

It wasn't gone, and probably wouldn't be for a long time, but knowing that the villain could be literally intimidated by the teen sleeping on him made him a lot less outright scary.

There was still a missing piece, though. Something that was nagging at him…

“Why were you with the league in the first place? Why abandon Izuku after nearly three years?” Katsuki demanded, sitting up in his chair as the logic began clicking in place in his mind.

Dabi glared at the blonde teen for a moment before dropping his gaze back down to Izuku. Katsuki could practically see the cogs working in the man’s mind.

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Dabi looked away from the blonde teen and glared down at Izuku, frustration welling up a little. He couldn’t blame the explosive teen for wanting answers in the slightest. Dabi had been the one to pull him through the portal in a moment of petty revenge against Shouto.

It all lead back to that one word.

Revenge.

The more he actually had to sit with himself and look around at the mess of his life the more he realized just exactly he’d sacrificed for his revenge. What exactly was waiting for him if he managed to ruin or kill his father?

Damn near nothing.

He’d come dangerously close to losing the one person who gave a shit about him, though.

It wasn’t like that anger and rage had gone away, though. He doubted anything would really ever cool the fire that licked at his very blood at the thought of his father and what the bastard had done to him. To his family.

There was still the urge and need to watch the man bleed to ease the intense anger he felt at his very core.

However, the teen that was currently curled up next to him cooled the fire just enough for it to stop consuming his every waking thought.

And if he wanted to be allowed to stay close to him, he’d have to explain himself to the hero brat.

“Have you ever heard of quirk marriages?”

Chapter End Notes

So, I made a boo boo without realizing it. If you've been reading from the start you might notice that I had Izuku spill the beans to Katsuki about Dabi in passing. I've since

gone back and edited that out bc I want Dabi to tell him himself while Izuku is sleeping lol

Anyway, I apologize for how long it took to get this out! I'm planning for Katsuki and Dabi to talk and then Mitsuki and Aizawa to be having a conversation at the same time so that'll be fun.

As always, let me know what you think!

Much too young to feel this damn old

Chapter Summary

Trust goes both ways

Chapter Notes

I actually had a lot of fun writing this and I'm really excited for what's coming next! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Shouta watched the youngest Bakugo storm from the room and resisted the urge to roll his eyes at the teenager's dramatics. From across the coffee table, Masaru caught his eye and flashed a small smile at him in support. The hero figured the man must be used to it by now since his son and wife had such similar personalities.

The teen also fooled none of them with his attitude. Every adult in the room was very aware that the only reason he'd picked the fight and attitude with his mother was so he could storm from the room and go upstairs to see Izuku.

Teenagers.

Mitsuki huffed and dropped down onto the sofa next to her husband, arms crossed over her chest and a familiar scowl tugging at her lips as she stared Shouta down.

"Exactly how worried should we be that there's apparently a villain that's already kidnapped my son in our house?" She practically growled the words, posture tense.

"With Izuku present? Not at all." Shouta drawled, eyes drifting towards the stairs as he contemplated when exactly his life got this complicated. "They both have a soft spot for him so they'll behave."

Both of the Bakugo's stared at him like he'd grown a second head and Shouta sighed heavily, dragging a hand through his hair. This was his life now. Balancing and managing teenagers and their love triangles.

Hizashi was at home laughing at him, probably.

"Dabi is the one who's been taking care of Izuku since he disappeared." He said finally, shoulders slumping as he watched the emotions flash across both of their faces.

Grief, at the years of thinking Izuku was gone.

Confusion about how exactly that situation would work.

Masaru's face smoothed over first, seeming to accept the situation for what it was. The man didn't relax fully but some of the tension drained out of his shoulders as his eyes briefly flickered towards the stairs.

Mitsuki, though? Confusion made way for growing horror and anger, Shouta could see it in the way that her posture grew stiff and her gaze slipped away from him and into the middle distance. Whatever was going on in her mind, whatever worse case scenarios that were playing out in her mind's eye, were enough to have her hands trembling in anger as she uncrossed her arms and made a motion to stand up.

"If that bastard hurt Izuku I'm going to kill him." She growled, tugging her arm out of her husband's reach as he reached to try and get her to sit back down. Her gaze swiveled back to Shouta, red eyes alight with anger so similar to her son's. "Tell me you're not condoning this?! Shouldn't you do your damn job and put his ass in jail?"

The hero let his head drop a little and dragged a palm over his face, reining in the urge to snap at the woman. The urge to tell her that he knew how to raise his own damn kid, thank you very much.

That thought alone sent uncomfortable prickles down his spine at how similar they sounded to something Inko probably would have said in this situation.

"Dabi defected from the League for Izuku and has shown a quite frankly surprising amount of effort at playing nice with us so far." Shouta settled on focusing on one problem rather than the other for the moment. "For the moment he is not a threat."

"Not a threat?! He's a villain!" Mitsuki shrieked, throwing her hands up in the air and turning away from Aizawa and towards her husband, hands gesturing wildly at the hero as she lost her words in her anger for a moment. "You're just letting a villain do as he pleases around teenagers on blind trust!"

"I trust Izuku." He answered calmly, far too used to the Bakugo anger to give the woman a rise. His tone was bland and his face was blank. "I trust that he knows what is and isn't acceptable. I also trust that your son knows what to do if he were to do something threatening."

The woman stared at the hero, eyes wide and her mouth agape. It took her several seconds to form words but once they did they were still unhappy, her lips curving down in a scowl again.

"Izuku is a child, Aizawa. You can't possibly trust him to make decisions like this." She said finally.

Shouta could feel the blank mask of indifference on his face slip at her words and he had to take a deep breath to stop himself from being harsh. From the way she twitched he could tell that his gaze wasn't exactly the friendliest but a part of him didn't care. This woman was important to Izuku, was someone he was going to be interacting with a lot in the future and he needed to knock this notion out of her head now. Before she ruined every bit of progress he'd made with Izuku.

"Do not ever repeat that thought in front of me again or let him think you're even thinking it." He said firmly, tone and face stone. "That child has been through more than most adults go through in an entire lifetime. You will respect that and his ability to decide what is best for himself."

He plowed on forward, even as the woman opened her mouth to argue. This was important and there was absolutely no way he was letting it go without her understanding exactly why she was wrong. This was a delicate balance they'd reached and he'd be damned if he let anyone break the trust he'd put so much work into building with Izuku.

"I understand you want to protect him but at this point, it's too little too late.There's very little at this point that he hasn't already seen, trust me on that." He kept Mitsuki pinned in place with his glare, trying to will her to understand the situation. "If we try and impose what we think he should be doing with no regard to what he's gone through then we'll be just as bad as Inko and he'll most likely disappear for good this time."

The blonde woman sank back down onto the sofa like her strings had been cut at his words and Shouta heaved a small sigh of relief. He almost felt bad as Mitsuki dropped her head down into her hands, shoulders shaking under the weight of her emotions.

Almost.

She had to understand and he wouldn't regret doing what he had to.

"What did she do to him?" Mitsuki broke the silence finally, lifting her head to meet Shouta's gaze once more.

The look in her eye was a little concerning but if he was being honest, he wasn't going to think too hard about it.

He wanted plausible deniability for whatever she was planning.

"She blamed him for being quirkless." He said slowly, not even trying to keep the disdain from coloring his tone. "I didn't see any sign of physical abuse. She seemed to prefer to ignore what Izuku was going through as a form of punishing him. I think she believed he deserved the abuse brought down on him from his peers and teachers."

He let that absolutely disgusting thought hang in the air for a moment before leaning forward, planting his elbows on his knees as he let his gaze bounce between both of the Bakugo's.

"When we get back to U.A, I'm finishing the paperwork to adopt Izuku under a new identity." He informed them. "She has no proof that he's still alive and no way of finding

him. Nezu and I are making sure she can never ever hurt him again."

Mitsuki's mouth hung open again for a moment before she collected herself and glanced towards her husband, who smiled very genuinely at the underground hero.

"Welcome to the family." Masaru said with a small laugh as his wife swatted at his arm lightly. "Would you like to get in on the bet on if Katsuki proposes before or after graduation?"

"Masaru!"

"It'll be before, I'm sure."

Before anything else could be said, three pairs of eyes turned towards the stairs at the sound of Katsuki's rapid-fire mini explosions.

"YOU HAVE GOT TO BE FUCKING KIDDING ME"

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"YOU HAVE GOT TO BE FUCKING KIDDING ME."

Dabi blinked at the blonde slowly, taking in the mini explosions in his palms and the shade of purple the teen's face was taking on. At some point, the other had jumped out of the chair he was sitting in and now was pacing around the room like a caged animal.

"That's a rather…strong response. I didn't even get into the stuff my old man did besides the unethical eugenics project." He drawled, brows raised as the teen turned to him with a snarl, the popping in his palms coming faster now.

"Shut the fuck up." Bakugo growled, eyes a little wild. "I really don't want to listen to you go over what a bastard Endeavor is. I got it the first time."

The man blinked again, mind screeching to a halt for a split second. Because yes, it was nice to hear someone else call his father a bastard but also…

"I didn't even mention his name…" He said slowly, brows furrowing as he took in the way that the blonde was glaring at him like he'd just run over his dog or something.

"No, your god damn brother already told me this story." The blonde spat, the small explosions fizzling out as the explosive teen froze in place.

His gaze swiveled to him, eyes wide as some sort of realization settled in.

"You taunted him right before you pulled me into that portal." He said and Dabi had to look away, eyes dropping down to where Izuku was sleeping. He took in the way the teen's brows were pinched together at the growing noise and smoothed his hand through his hair again in an attempt to settle him again.

“Not my finest moment, I’m now realizing.” Dabi admitted lowly, glancing back at the teen to try and gauge the rage level of the other.

Bakugo was standing next to the bed now, brows furrowed and hands flexing at his sides as he tried to work through whatever was going on in his mind.

He didn’t get a chance to voice his thoughts, though, because between one breath and the next Izuku moved. The green haired teen reached out and grabbed the blonde by one of his arms and tugged him down onto the bed with a low grumble.

Luckily the explosive teen had enough flexibility to twist so he didn’t land on top of both Izuku and Dabi, instead of crushing them he rolled off to the side and settled behind Izuku with a small grunt as he landed.

“Sleep time.” Izuku mumbled grumpily, stretching out between the both of them before settling again. He still had his head on Dabi’s lap but he was now stretched out so his legs were over Bakugou’s. “Yell later. ‘M tired.”

Silence settled over the three as Izuku seemed to drift back to sleep, content to be pinning the both of them down. Neither of them moved or dared to breathe too loudly for a long while, retreating into their own heads for the time being.

It was only when they were absolutely sure that Izuku was asleep that Katsuki dared to speak again, voice hushed and strangely devoid of the anger Dabi had come to associate the blonde with.

“I’m not going to be fully okay with you overnight.” It was a simple thing to say but it held weight behind it. Weight of a history that most people wouldn’t even try to move past. As if Dabi even deserved anyone overlooking the shit he’d done. “But we have to at least tolerate each other for his sake. We’re going to make him miserable if we can’t at least be civil.”

“That’s surprisingly mature for the human equivalent to an unpinned grenade.” Dabi drawled, unable to help prodding at him a little. He chuckled lowly at the glare the other sent his way, raising his free hand in surrender. “I’m just saying.”

The blonde was silent for a moment, sulking, as he glanced away from the flame quirked man.

“...therapy will do that.” Came the mumbled reply a few moments later, almost too quiet to hear.

Dabi hummed in reply and let his head fall back against the wall again. The silence that fell over them wasn’t awkward, at least. It wasn’t comfortable either but in it Dabi could feel a middle ground starting to form. For Izuku’s sake, they could do this much.

Maybe later, they’d be able to do more than tolerate each other but that would be a long ways down the road. There were bound to be things that the kid needed to work past in regards to Dabi’s involvement in the training camp attack and everything else that went down.

There was a lot still that Dabi himself had to work through to find out if he was even worth being forgiven for everything he'd done. Izuku would probably argue with him on that but he wasn't stupid. He'd hurt a lot of people in his blind quest for revenge on his father. It was unlikely that he'd ever be able to wash his hands clean of everything. But he could try.

For Izuku's sake.

To be able to keep what little slice of joy he'd managed to create, deserved or not. He was too selfish to want to let go of the one person that made everything just a little bit easier to deal with. He couldn't let the first person not look at Dabi and write him off as a failure walk out of his life. Not again.

"So. Little Shouto just trauma dumped all over you, I'm assuming?" He asked, distracting himself from that line of thought by prodding at an obvious subject.

The string of curses the blonde let out under his breath answered the question well enough, drawing a dry chuckle out of him.

"I hate all of you." Bakugo grumbled, shifting so he was facing Dabi with a glare. "But yes. He said he felt he owed me an explanation as to why he refused to use his fire against me."

Dabi couldn't help the snort that thought brought out of him.

"Spiteful, we Todoroki men are, aren't we?" He couldn't help the humorless laugh that left his lips, the rage simmering just under the surface of his skin again.

The silence that lapsed between them for the moment was charged and a little uncomfortable as red eyes bored into him as if they could force him to talk just from their weight alone. Part of Dabi wanted to rage against the blonde but the part that sounded suspiciously like Izuku whispered that the teen was just trying to understand.

As if the madness caused by his father that lurked in the back of his mind was something that could be understood.

"I watched that sports festival." He admitted quietly, eyes focused on the hand that was carding through Izuku's curls instead of the blonde that was trying to bore holes in him with his eyes. "I saw him refuse to use his flames and it just made me even more resolved to ruin my father. If the golden child was another failure, like the rest of us, then what even was the point of everything? All of the shit he put us through was for nothing."

The words felt like acid on his tongue, bitterness welling up beside the anger now inside of his chest. He'd choke on it if he wasn't careful.

"It wasn't long after that that I joined the League. Izuku and I fought about it and I was so blinded by bitterness and the thought of ruining my father that I pushed him away." Dabi finally lifted his gaze to meet Bakugo's gaze, not sure what the teen was seeing in his face. "So again, no, it wasn't personal. A little petty, yeah, but it had nothing to do with you."

Bakugo didn’t say anything, just watched him for a long moment before breaking eye contact. Dabi blinked, once again surprised as he watched the teen wiggle around trying to get his phone out of his pocket without waking or dislodging Izuku from where he was draped across him.

“What are you doing?”

“Texting Aizawa and telling him to come get us in the morning. Izuku’s gonna be knocked out for a while and I don’t particularly want to move.” Bakugo replied, face illuminated by his phone as he sent off the text. “Get comfy. And prepare exactly how you’re going to convince my mother not to gut you in the morning.”

Chapter End Notes

This was an emotional rollercoaster to write because I genuinely had no idea how it was going to go. I kind of knew what I wanted Aizawa and the Bakugo's to discuss but the entire conversation between Dabi and Katsuki was..kind of really like stepping back and asking them what they wanted to say, honestly.

I'm also realizing just now that we're in the final few chapters of this story, now. If everything goes to plan then we have maybe three more chapters before it's done? Never fear, there's already a sequel in the works but the ending of this just kind of snuck up on me haha

But as always, bribe me with your thoughts! I hope you enjoyed the feels of this chapter as much as I enjoyed writing it!

If I could write a letter to me at 16

Chapter Summary

Trust feels a lot like falling.

Chapter Notes

Enjoy the chapter!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

There were very few things in life that Dabi could say he was genuinely scared of. Most of them were abstract and could be ignored. Like Death or the madness that lingered in the back of his mind.

The woman standing over the bed with the knife in her hand and a manic smile? That absolutely could not be ignored.

Dabi blinked up at her, trying to decide if he should just burn everything or if he was hallucinating. It took him several long moments to realize he'd fallen asleep in Bakugo's bed and that the woman who looked scarily like the teenager was probably his mother.

Which, you know, presented its own set of issues considering he could feel Izuku's weight against his side and the arm draped over his stomach absolutely did not belong to him or the green haired teen.

The woman must have been able to sense the panic growing in the villain because her smile took on an even sharper edge.

"Good morning. Don't we look awfully cozy?" Her voice was syrupy sweet but it sent chills down Dabi's spine. Historically, he and parents did not get along. Let alone the parent of a living grenade who had to have learned his attitude somewhere.

Dabi, thankfully, didn't even get a chance to formulate a response because the arm that was not his or Izuku's lifted up to flip the woman the bird, directing the woman's attention to her spawn rather than him.

"Stop trying to scare him, hag." Bakugo grumbled somewhere off to the right.

Dabi shifted a little to see the blonde laying practically on top of Izuku, hair even crazier looking than usual as he squinted and glared up at his mother. The woman just smiled

sweetly back, the knife disappearing somewhere behind her back like she hadn't just silently threatened to gut Dabi with it.

"Breakfast is ready, start getting up brats." The woman said finally after a staring contest with her son, eyes briefly flickering to Dabi before she turned and exited the room.

So there was no way of getting out of whatever awful and awkward situation was about to occur. Great.

The room was silent for a moment before the teen pressed against Dabi's side began to giggle, burying his face in Dabi's shirt to try and smother the noise. Very briefly he considered smothering the giggling teen for letting him go through that very, very, traumatizing wake up call.

"Oi! Why didn't you save me from the psycho you little…!" Dabi growled, turning to try and grab the teen as he wiggled away from him still laughing.

"Because! Auntie likes me best and I have to keep it that way so she doesn't murder you at breakfast." Izuku squealed as he crawled over Bakugo and hid behind the scowling blonde.

"Why do you get me into these situations?" Dabi groaned and flopped back down onto the bed, covering his eyes with hand like that would block out the ridiculous situation he'd found himself in.

It couldn't block out the renewed giggling of the green haired teen and the snort the explosive blonde let out.

"You love me~"

And damn him, he did.

Almost enough to stop him from contemplating just jumping out the window and booking it before the demon woman downstairs figured out he'd left.

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Hizashi pulled the car up in front of the Bakugo household and was surprised to see Izuku and Bakugo waiting for them. The green haired teen was smiling wide as Bakugo said something, the blonde boy wrinkling his nose and pouting at how hard the other teen laughed at him.

Neither of them noticed the car at first and it gave Hizashi a moment to really take in the sight of his kid completely relaxed and carefree. He glanced over at the passenger seat and smiled softly at his husband, who was watching the same scene with a small frown.

"Aww, lighten up Sho. Loud blondes run in the family, apparently." He teased lightly, chuckling when Shouta shot him a glare.

Hizashi's smile softened, though, as he turned his gaze back to the two teenagers who seemed to be wrapped up in their own little world.

It was amazing the progress that had been made in regards to the boy in front of them. Never in a million years would Hizashi have believed that the jumpy teenager they'd brought into their home would be able to smile that brightly.

When Izuku arrived into their care he was closed off and distrustful. He jumped at the slightest noise and was so reserved. Hizashi had wondered in the beginning if they'd be able to reach past the layers and layers of walls the teen had built between himself and the world.

Now, he couldn't help but feel warm and happy at the changes in their kid.

"I'm so proud of him, Sho."

His husband nodded, face softening as well.

Hizashi watched as the man leaned forward and slowly reached towards the steering wheel. He couldn't contain the noise that left him as Shouta hit the horn and both of the teens jumped about a foot in the air at the sudden noise.

"Let's go. I want a nap." Shouta called, leaning his head out the window.

The look on both of the teens' faces was so funny to the blonde hero that the car practically shook at the pitch of his laughter. It was only his husband's hair rising slightly in threat of him activating his own quirk that made him suppress his laughter into quiet chortles.

"Cmon, little listeners! We don't want to be late to classes!"

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Izuku walked Katsuki and his dads back to the dorms, blushing furiously when Hizashi wiggled his eyebrows at him as the green haired teen pulled the blonde aside. His dads were going to be the death of him with this. Hizashi especially took great pleasure in teasing him.

Izuku was going to retaliate one of these days, though, and the war would be on.

Katsuki raised a brow at him but stayed behind outside the building as Izuku's dads went inside. It was only once the men were out of sight, and hearing range, that Izuku relaxed a little.

It wasn't like he had anything important to say but gosh he didn't want an audience for once.

"I have to go see Nezu early today but I wanted to ask if you'd like to come watch movies with me and my dads tonight?" Izuku laughed softly at the way Katsuki's face twitched a little at the mention of his dads.

His dads were going to give him hell about it later but Izuku was quickly becoming addicted to all of the easily accessible affection that was being offered to him.

Sleeping in the same bed as both Katsuki and Dabi? That was the best sleep he'd gotten in maybe his entire life. It was going to be hard to recreate but he was going to try his damndest to make sure he had at least one of them nearby for at the very least cuddles.

He was pulled out of his musings about how to get Nezu to approve Dabi being on campus by Katsuki laughing a little and leaning in to drop a kiss to his forehead.

"You spaced on me for a second there, nerd." He mumbled before pulling back and rolling his eyes at the sappy smile on Izuku's face. "Yeah, I'll be there tonight to subject myself to your dads teasing."

"You're the best!" Izuku chirped, grinning widely up at him.

His phone in his pocket chirped, reminding him he had to get moving. The teen made a face at it and let go of Katsuki's hand.

"I'll see you in heroics this afternoon!" He turned to walk away but doubled back for a moment to press a kiss to Katsuki's cheek before scurrying away.

The sound of Katsuki's flustered mini explosions followed him and he couldn't wipe the grin on his face as he set off towards the school building with a grin on his face.

If you had told him a year ago that he'd be where he was now he probably would have had a breakdown. Being at this school, having parental figures that actually cared about him and his well being, and having so many people around him that genuinely cared was something he never, ever, thought he'd actually have.

Katsuki and Dabi getting along and the possibilities that were opening up, there? Icing on the cake.

That thought carried him through the halls of U.A, waving to teachers and the few of 1A that were lingering in the halls this early before class.

It didn't take him long to reach Nezu's office, the door sliding open as he approached. The principal smiled at him from behind the computer and motioned for him to sit down.

"Good morning, Izuku! I'm glad to see you in such high spirits after yesterday!"

The teen sank into the chair across from his mentor and nodded, smile fading just a little at the reminder of what had transpired during his visit to see his mother.

It didn't hurt all that much, though. She hadn't wanted or loved him for many years now and she'd just confirmed his suspicions on the matter during the visit. Besides, Shouta and Hizashi were better than her in every way so he wasn't going to dwell for too long on everything.

"It was rough, I won't lie but I'm glad to have it behind me. Dad said you needed me to sign some papers for the adoption, right?" Izuku asked, leaning over to dig through his bag and pull out his materials for the lesson.

Nezu nodded to himself and dug through a file on the desk next to him before pushing said papers across the desk to the teen.

“Yes, I just need you to sign this and you will be Izuku Yamada-Aizawa.” He said brightly, grinning.

As Izuku hummed and reached across the desk to pull the papers closer to himself, the bear’s smile shifted into something more serious and as Izuku glanced up at him he felt the mood shift to something unknown.

“I also wanted to talk to you about something now that your new identity has been set in stone.” Nezu began, leaning forward in his chair and clasping his hands in front of him as he leaned on the desk.

Izuku set the pen down on the table, signature done, and watched the bear very carefully. His gut didn’t tell him that this was a bad thing per say but it was never anything light when the principal had this kind of energy.

“I reached out to some contacts of mine in America and if you want it there is a position open in a underground hero agency there.”

The words washed over Izuku and he blinked at the bear, mouth hanging open a little as he tried to make sense of the words coming out of his mouth. Nezu seemed to sense his confusion and softened a little with a smile.

“We’ve talked in length about the fact that we’re not ready to go toe to toe with the commission just yet so it wouldn’t be possible here for you.” He said slowly, knowing that the shock was slowing Izuku’s understanding down at the moment. “My contact in America would be willing to take you on as an apprentice until you’re able to get your license there. At which time you could operate here without the commission’s say.”

Izuku let that wash over him. Let the idea of finally being able to achieve the dream he’d held since he was four years old sink into his mind.

He could do it. Nezu was giving him a once in a lifetime opportunity to seize everything he’d always said he wanted, here.

But…

America was so far away. And he’d just established a family here. He’d just gotten Dabi and Katsuki to the point where they could relax in a room together and not want to murder each other.

He literally just signed papers to cement Hizashi and Shouta as his parents.

Izuku lifted his eyes and met Nezu’s knowing gaze with a troubled one of his own.

“I can’t just leave, yet. This is for after the Shigaraki situation is figured out, right? That’s the whole reason you brought me here…” He stumbled over the words, still trying to wrap his brain around what Nezu was offering to him.

The rat-mouse-bear just smiled at him over his folded paws, head tilting a little.

“Izuku, Shigaraki was always just an excuse to give to the police and commission. We never expected you to fight him all by yourself, you know that right? If you want to go to America, you are free to do so.”

“Can…I give you an answer later? I need some time to think about it…”

“Of course, my boy! I wouldn’t expect anything less.”

* * * * * * * * * * * * *

After lunch the class filled in slowly, sluggish and tired from a long morning of tests. The idiot squad was even quiet for once, talking amongst themselves quietly as everyone filed in. There was still a few minutes left before class would begin so Katsuki took the opportunity to relax.

Izuku had been in the classroom when he’d arrived, perched on his desk as usual. The blonde didn’t hesitate to slide into his seat and wrap his arms around the green haired teen’s midsection and drop his head down into the other’s lap. Izuku laughed softly and carded his fingers through Katsuki’s hair gently.

The teen hummed happily, content, as he tilted his head to glance up at the other teen. The contemplative gaze the teen was giving him made something in his stomach twist a little, unease crawling up his spine.

“Everything okay?” He asked softly, drawing Izuku out of whatever thoughts were spiraling in that green head of his.

Green eyes focused once more with a blink, a small smile tugging at Izuku’s lips as he came back into reality. The unease in Katuski’s stomach twisted again when instead of answering him, Izuku’s gaze swept over the classroom. Something was wrong, his gut screamed over and over.

“Yeah…I just…had a conversation with Nezu that messed my brain up a little bit.” Izuku paused, biting his lip as he tried to find the words to whatever was going on in his mind.

“He found an agency in America that would help me become a Hero now that my new identity is in place…”

Katsuki’s breath froze in his chest as the other’s words sank in. Izuku’s lips kept moving but the blonde couldn’t hear a word he was saying as everything seemed to freeze around them.

America.

A hero agency willing to help Izuku make his lifelong dream a reality.

America

Katsuki wouldn't be able to follow him, he realized dully as the rest of the situation settled in around him. He was well and truly stuck where he was. If he wanted to gain any trust back from the general public of Japan he was going to have to stay at U.A and prove that his experience with the League hadn't swayed him to villainy.

If he left the country then he would never become number one in Japan. If that was what he wanted he'd have to stay and prove it over and over again that he was more than the group that thought he was a Villain.

That he was more than the teenager who had ended All Might's career.

His mind began to race now, dread settling in his gut as his thoughts sped past him at a mile a minute.

How was he going to protect Izuku if he was in America? Shigaraki was solely focused on Izuku now as a target because of the whole situation with his father. Who was going to watch the teen's back in America?

His mind settled on the only possibility.

Dabi.

Dabi would have to go with Izuku. He wasn't wanted in America, too small time even in Japan to garner that kind of attention. It would probably be a good thing for the villain as well. A new start where his father's face was plastered on every TV and magazine throughout the entire country.

Maybe he could focus on healing the wounds his bastard father had inflicted. Surely there was a healer there that could help with the scaring as well, right?

It'd be fine. Everything would be fine.

Their relationship would be mended from the whole League situation and everything would be fine.

That's what Katsuki kept telling himself as his chest grew tighter and his breathing hitched.

"-cchan? Kacchan!"

Katsuki blinked as Izuku's face snapped back into focus, the teen's eyes worried as he turned to fully face the blonde now.

"Huh?"

"I asked if you're okay, Kacchan. You're squeezing me really tight and you look like you're about to have a panic attack.." Izuku's voice was soft and worried and Katsuki now had guilt churning in his gut.

He couldn't ruin this for Izuku. It would be cruel to put his own feelings and thoughts above the fact that this was Izuku's dream. The one thing he'd been denied in his life that led to the

ruin of everything else.

Katsuki forced himself to smile up at the green haired teen. He could do this.

“I’m fine, just excited for you. You and scarface are going to have to keep me updated and I’ll visit every break. We’ll make this work.”

Understand dawned across Izuku’s face and Katsuki frowned in confusion at the laugh that bubbled up out of the other teen.

“Oh, Katsuki, I love you for trying to pretend like you’d be okay with that but it’s okay. I’m not going.” Izuku chuckled, face and posture relaxing as he swept a hand through Katsuki’s hair.

There were several things that basically blue screened Katsuki’s brain in that statement and it took a moment to scrape enough of it back together to respond.

“You’re not?! Why? This is your dream?!” His voice raised to a level that several pairs of eyes turned towards them.

Both of them ignored that, though, and Izuku’s smile stayed in place and if it was possible grew softer.

“That was Izuku Midoriya’s dream and it died with him when he jumped from that bridge.” Izuku broke eye contact with Katsuki to glance around the classroom again with a small smile. “Izuku Yamada-Aizawa, though? He gets to make a whole new dream.”

The blonde stared up at him for a long moment, brows furrowed as he searched the other teen’s gaze for any sign that this wasn’t what he wanted. All he saw there was raw, unfiltered, adoration and contentment.

“Are you sure? I don’t want you regretting this ten years down the road.” He asked seriously, watching as Izuku’s eyes crinkled a little as he leaned down into his space. Their foreheads bumped together for a moment as Izuku stared into his eyes.

“I won’t regret staying with my family, Kacchan. Not even in a million years.” He said softly. “I trust you to catch me if I fall, this time.”

The moment was broken, both boys jumping a little, as the classroom door opened and Aizawa’s gruff voice drew them out of their little bubble.

“Everyone settle down, there’s a lot to cover today to get you ready for the provisional license exams.”

Izuku flashed him another smile as he slid off of the desk, getting ready to join Aizawa at the front of the room to explain their training for the day. Katsuki caught him by the hand before he could get too much further away and pulled him back close with a small smile.

“I love you too, nerd.”

Both boys were startled out of their little bubble by the wall of noise that came from the class, cheering and wolfwistles making both of the teens turn bright red as they separated quickly.

At the front of the classroom, Aizawa rolled his eyes before flashing his quirk to get the attention of the class again.

“Yes, yes, very sweet. If any of you want to actually be heroes we have a lot of work to do.” Aizawa drawled.

The class settled down and Katsuki still only had eyes for Izuku as the other teen moved to lean against the podium that his father was currently giving orders from.

He could see the way that the teen relaxed and surveyed the room, smiling a little as he caught his eye again.

Things were going to be okay.

Chapter End Notes

First off, I am so blown away but how well this fic has been received and I thank every single one of you that have read and enjoyed this fic! This is literally my first fic in this fandom and the first fic I've ever finished. So thank you for sticking around with me as I figured this writing thing out!

The first chapter to the sequel should be posted next week or the week after, though! So make sure you subscribe to the series so you'll be updated when it gets posted! I'm really excited to get started on that and bring these characters into the next stages of their lives!

Let me know what you thought and especially if there were any scenes missing that you really wanted to see! I'm going to be writing some other small things in this verse and also possibly writing an alternate version of it so ;D

Love you guys!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!